WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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बिहार है तैयार

प्रकृति और गौ-माता के प्रति
प्रेम के प्रतीक

गोवर्धन पूजा

कर्म, न्याय और लेखनी के आराध्य

चित्रगुप्त पूजा

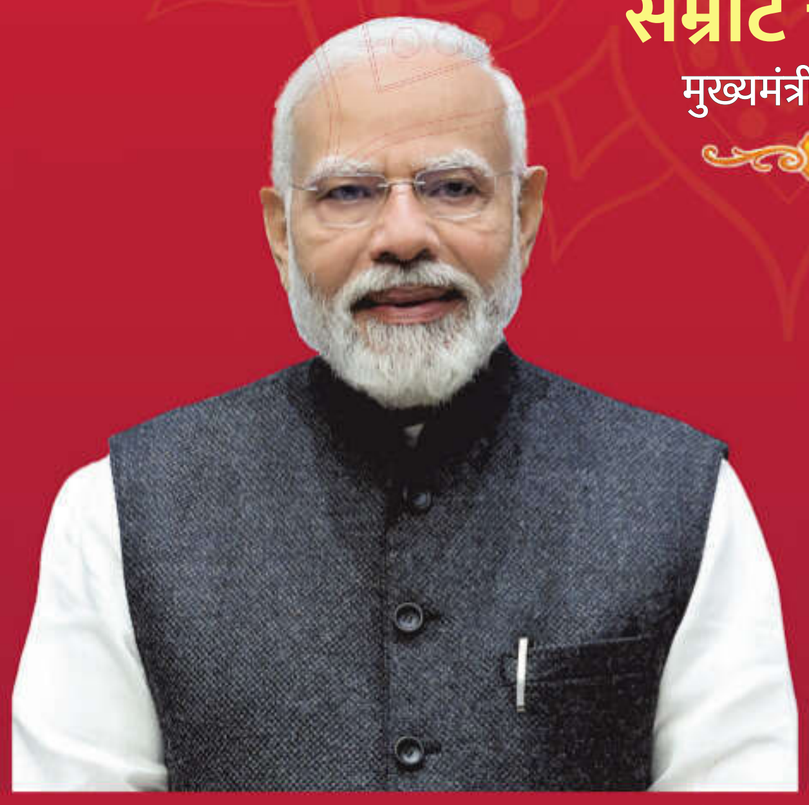
तथा

भाई-बहन के अटूट प्रेम व विश्वास के पर्व

भाई दूज

की आपको
हार्दिक शुभकामनाएं

सम्राट चौधरी
मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार





सूचना एवं जन-सम्पर्क विभाग, बिहार

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THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

Iran war militarily 'effectively over', says Trump after meeting Qatari PM

Aamer Madhani
Washington, November 10



> **The military action doesn't seem to be a very necessary thing, but we're locked and loaded, ready to go for any reason that changes"**
> **DONALD TRUMP,**
> PRESIDENT, UNITED STATES

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump on Monday told reporters he believes the war in Iran "militarily is effectively over," suggesting that — at least for now — he's not prepared to resume the bombardment that has devastated the Islamic Republic and caused reverberations across the global economy.

The president made a surprise visit to the White House briefing room after meeting earlier in the day with Qatar's prime minister, Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman bin Jassim Al Thani.

"Iran militarily is effectively over," Trump said. "We're just keeping it the status quo."

He added that Iran has been "decapitated" but said he is still looking to make sure there's a long-term solution to ensuring that Iran's nuclear program is defanged. It was some of Trump's most definitive comments about moving away from his threat to resume strikes on Iran after the US midterm elections had passed.

Trump, over the course of the conflict, has repeatedly said he is on the cusp of ordering US forces to escalate attacks if Iran's leaders don't quickly agree to US terms to end the war, only to back down. In earlier cycles, he has also edged away with a last-minute declaration, sometimes at the behest of Gulf allies, that he's going to give diplomacy more time.

In a posting on social media shortly before speaking to reporters, Trump once again asserted that Middle East allies — Qatar, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Bahrain, Kuwait and others — "would prefer the status quo." Minutes later, in his exchange with reporters, he sought to assure war-weary Americans that there was "positive momentum" and that he saw a "good chance" that the war "could get ended."

"They're talking to us, and they're talking very politely, And we'll see what happens," Trump said. He added, "The military action doesn't seem to be a very necessary thing, but we're locked and loaded, ready to go for any reason that changes."

Trump, however, gave no hint of a drawdown of the thousands of US troops who have been shifted to the waters off of Iran and maintain a naval blockade to stem the flow of Iranian oil into the global market. **AP**

U.S. DEFENCE SECRETARY IS ACCUSED OF VARIOUS ABUSES OF POWER IN OFFICE

Defiant Hegseth slams efforts to impeach him

He could be the first US defence secretary to be impeached

Phil Stewart
Washington, November 10

DEFENCE SECRETARY Pete Hegseth on Tuesday blasted efforts to impeach him as a farce that would embolden US adversaries, as he lashed out at his political opponents in Congress and the media in an unapologetic defence of his record.

Striking a defiant tone at a Pentagon news briefing, Hegseth thanked President Trump for his continued support as the House of Representatives scheduled a procedural vote for late Tuesday that will test support for his impeachment.

Hegseth said past impeachments of Trump had failed, and added: "Both times he came back stronger, and the American people sent him back to the White House. Now they're trying a third time. This time against a member of his cabinet."

US Representative Thomas Massie, a Kentucky Republican, introduced eight articles of impeachment against Hegseth on Monday.

Congressional sources say the resolution may have the votes to pass even with Trump's Republicans still controlling the House until Democrats take over on January 3. Conviction appears unlikely in the Senate, however, where a two-thirds majority is required and Republicans hold 53 of 100 seats.

Hegseth is accused of various abuses of power in office, including issuing orders to go to war with Iran without an imminent threat or approval from Congress. Vice President JD Vance has publicly questioned the war. Hegseth declined to be drawn into responding to Vance, but defended the conflict, calling Trump courageous and saying Iran's military has been left in ruins. "History will judge the Iran war quite differently than the conventional wisdom right now," he said.

Hegseth cited US Secretary of State Marco Rubio as saying of the war: "It's not necessarily popular, but it may have been necessary, and that's certainly how I feel. It was a necessary undertaking." **REUTERS**

IMPEACHMENT ARTICLES AGAINST PETE HEGSETH

Here are the "high crimes and misdemeanors" in the unusual Republican-led impeachment effort against a Republican official



HEGSETH DENIES wrongdoing, and Trump has criticised Rep. Massie and pledged to stand by his Secretary of Defence

IRAN
Three charges are related to Iran war. He is accused of allowing actions beyond a 60-day limit without approval by Congress
He is accused of ignoring laws requiring forces minimise civilian casualties

VENEZUELA
Hegseth is accused of directing the kidnapping of a sovereign foreign leader (Nicolas Maduro) and authorising lethal strikes in the Caribbean and Pacific that have resulted in more than 220 deaths

YEMEN
He is accused of directing and executing unlawful military strikes and operations in Yemen, specifically "Operation Rough Rider," a 2025 US and British air and naval campaign against Iran-aligned Houthis

FREE SPEECH
He is accused of retaliating against Democratic Senator Mark Kelly of Arizona, despite legal protection of his speech.
He sought to prosecute Kelly after he urged US troops to refuse illegal orders



Flying Lap

Seven-time Formula 1 world champion Lewis Hamilton at Egypt's Rafah on Tuesday to see humanitarian aid for the war-torn Gaza Strip. Hamilton has spoken out about humanitarian crises and conflict zones in the region, calling for peace. AP

• BRIEFLY

ARGENTINA

Pope meets survivors of clergy abuse amid ongoing hearings



Pope Leo spent about an hour meeting with the survivors. FILE

POPE LEO XIV met survivors of clergy abuse on Monday during his visit to Argentina, a country that has been reckoning with the Catholic Church's legacy of sex abuse and cover-up, including in cases in which the Argentine Pope Francis intervened. The Vatican said Leo spent about an hour meeting individually, and then as a group, with five victims of abuse by clergy and "church institutions" who were chosen by the local church. The meeting took place before Leo left for an event at the Catholic University of Argentina. Leo listened to their "painful stories and proposals to consolidate paths of healing in the church," said a statement from Vatican spokesman Matteo Bruni. AP

CAMBODIA

5 schoolgirls killed as bus skids into pond

FIVE GIRLS died on Tuesday morning in Cambodia when a bus taking them to school veered off the road and plunged into a deep pond, police said. The crash took place in Kandal province, about 40 km north of the capital, Phnom Penh, said a statement posted on Facebook by the provincial police. It said witnesses reported that a motorcycle suddenly crossed in front of the fast-moving bus, causing its driver to slam on the brakes and making the vehicle skid into the roadside water. AP

INDONESIA

V-P offers to resign over eligibility row

INDONESIA'S VICE president offered to resign during a meeting with President Prabowo Subianto on Tuesday, according to officials, adding to the turmoil at the highest levels of the country's leadership. Vice President Gibran Rakabuming Raka, the 39-year-old son of former President Joko Widodo, held over two hours of talks with Prabowo, according to State Secretariat Minister Prasetyo Hadi. It was not immediately clear whether Prabowo accepted the resignation, Hadi said. AP

At least 12 killed, 50 injured in Bulgarian motorway pile-up

Associated Press
Sofia, November 10

THICK FOG on a motorway in eastern Bulgaria caused two major crashes that killed at least 12 people and injured dozens on Tuesday, a government minister said.

Dense fog on the motorway linking the capital Sofia with the Black Sea port of Burgas led to two pileups. The accidents forced the closure of the road in both directions, Health Minister Katya Ivkova said.

Ivkova said 10 people died at the scene and two others died while being transported to the hospital. She said 50 other people were transported to medical facilities for treatment.

Some 86 vehicles, many of them heavy trucks, were involved in the crashes, which occurred on opposite carriageways in the same place at 7 am local time.

Regional governor Mihail Kasherov told reporters at the site of the mass crash that the scene defied description and he had never seen anything like it.

Police launched an investigation but said initial assessments point to "reduced visibility due to fast-forming dense fog, wet road surface and speeds unsuitable for the conditions." European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen, who was on a working visit in Bulgaria on Tuesday, had to change her schedule after her host, Prime Minister Rumen Radev, left her to head to the scene of the accident.

President Iliana Yotova is also cutting short her participation in the Paris Peace Forum and is returning to Bulgaria, her press office announced.



Damaged vehicles at the site of a highway pile-up near Yambol in Bulgaria on Tuesday. REUTERS

Judge sets 2028 summer for trial of Charlie Kirk's murder accused



Kirk was shot dead at Utah Valley University on Sept 10, 2025

Associated Press
Utah, November 10

THE MAN accused of assassinating conservative activist Charlie Kirk will stand trial in the summer of 2028, a Utah judge ruled Monday.

Attorneys for defendant Tyler Robinson, 23, proposed a trial starting in 2029. But District Judge Tony Graf faced pressure from Kirk's family and supporters, including President Donald Trump, to speed up court proceedings that already have lasted more than a year.

Robinson has pleaded not guilty to aggravated murder in the killing of Kirk, 31, as the activist spoke to several thousand people at Utah Valley University on Sept 10, 2025. Robinson could face the death penalty if convicted. Graf allocated 105 days for the trial, beginning with jury selection on June 21, 2028. He said the dates balance Robinson's right to prepare his defence with the rights of Kirk's widow, Erika Kirk, to a speedy resolution.

Erika Kirk's attorney disagreed with the schedule but said there is no choice but to accept it. "A trial in the summer of 2028, three years after Charlie's assassination, does not feel very speedy to the Kirk family," attorney Jeffrey Neiman said.

US evacuates tankers from base in England due to threat from Iran

Danica Kirka
London, November 10

THE US Air Force has evacuated air refueling tankers from their base in eastern England due to a threat from Iran, the *Wall Street Journal* reported Tuesday.

Two tankers stationed at RAF Mildenhall were diverted to Germany on Monday, and several other tankers were relocated to other bases in Europe later in the day, the newspaper reported, citing people familiar with the decision. US officials decided to redeploy the aircraft after being alerted about the new threat on Monday, the Journal said.

A European Command official said they were aware of the reporting when contacted by *The Associated Press*, saying only that the service rotates aircraft between locations "for a variety of reasons including training and real world requirements."

"US military aircraft are hosted in accordance with access, basing and overflight agreements with our allies and partners," the official said while speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to speak on sensitive military matters.

"Due to operations security, we will not provide further information on movement of assets.

"For operational security reasons, we do not discuss specific force protection measures. Our installations remain vigilant and work closely with our host nation counterparts."

RAF Mildenhall, a British base operated by the US Air Force, hosts the 100th refueling wing, the only permanent refueling wing in the European region. It operates the KC-135 Stratotanker, a four-engine jet aircraft with a wingspan of 131 feet that can carry up to 83,000 pounds of cargo.

The report comes less than two months after the Air Force withdrew its bombers from another US-run base in Britain, RAF Fairford, as police investigated a suspected terror plot linked to Iran. Bombers flying out of RAF Fairford had been used to strike Iran during the U.S.-Israeli war against the Islamic Republic.

Five men were detained on Sept. 27 after three suspicious vans were spotted traveling toward RAF Fairford. The UK-owned base has been used by American bombers during decades of conflicts in the Middle East, including the ongoing Iran war. **AP**

France summons Iran envoy over fridge hack, warns of response

John Irish
Paris, November 10

FRANCE SUMMONED Iran's ambassador on Tuesday after accusing Tehran of a cyberattack that disabled refrigerators in hundreds of supermarkets, with Foreign Minister Jean-Noel Barrot warning Paris could respond with cyber measures of its own.

French officials said on Monday that Iran's Revolutionary Guards were behind the attacks, which disrupted commercial refrigeration systems across France in October.

"The summoning of the Iranian ambassador, announced by the minister yesterday, took place this morning," the foreign ministry said in a statement.

Iran's foreign ministry rejected as "baseless and hostile" accusations that its Revolutionary Guards were behind the attacks. Barrot, speaking on France Info television, said France would push for EU sanctions in response to what he called an "attack of unprecedented scale and aggression in our country".

He said there could be further action that would not be disclosed. "We will take whatever measures are necessary, including some that we will not discuss publicly, if we judge them proportionate and necessary to deter any new attacks and punish those responsible for this unacceptable aggression," Barrot said. **REUTERS**

Bangladesh: 1 killed as violence flares over Hasina's return plan

Press Trust of India
Dhaka, November 10

ONE PERSON was killed and at least eight vehicles were set ablaze in separate incidents across Bangladesh overnight amid escalating tensions over ousted prime minister Sheikh Hasina's planned return next month, police said on Tuesday.

Unidentified people torched the vehicles, including several buses, and set off crude bombs at multiple locations. A bus driver died of smoke inhalation after a parked bus was set ablaze in southwestern Faridpur while he was sleeping inside it, police said.

Police blamed activists of the Awami League, whose activities have been banned, and its affiliated organisations for several of the incidents.

The incidents came after Bangladesh's government said it was examining reports that Hasina had applied for a new passport and national identity card. Minister for Foreign Affairs Humaiun Kobir on Monday ruled out issuing her a passport.

Police said hundreds of activists of the Awami League and its affiliates staged a demonstration at the southern toll plaza of the Padma Bridge in Shariatpur district early Tuesday. They exploded crude bombs and vandalised several vehicles, temporarily disrupting traffic on the bridge.

• HARRISON BEAT FIVE OTHER FINALISTS, INCLUDING PREVIOUS WINNERS DOUGLAS STUART AND MARLON JAMES, WHO HAD BEEN THE ODDSMAKERS' FAVOURITES, AND PULITZER PRIZE LAUREATE ELIZABETH STROUT

Sci-Fi breaks Booker barrier as M John Harrison wins prize for 'The End of Everything'

Jill Lawless
London, November 10

BRITISH WRITER M John Harrison won the Booker Prize for fiction on Monday for "The End of Everything," a satirical dystopian novel whose themes of "catastrophe and apocalypse" chime with our uneasy times.

It's the first work of science fiction to take the prestigious 50,000 pound ($67,000) literary award, but 81-year-old Harrison said he doesn't want to be hemmed in by the sci-fi label.

He said Booker recognition after six decades as an author shows that the era of "genres as fences and boxes, pigeonholes, is over."

"I think this book shows, and the prize now shows, that it is very possible to write a book that mixes not just two genres, but three or four," Harrison told reporters at a post-ceremony news conference.

Harrison beat five other finalists including previous winners Douglas Stuart and Marlon James, who had been the oddsmakers' favorites, and Pulitzer Prize laureate Elizabeth Strout.

"The End of Everything" is set on England's Channel coast in the near future, after an unspecified calamity has shattered society and brought an influx of enigmatic alien entities to Britain. It centers on a beachcomber who lives with his gun-toting aunt and discovers a puzzling, shape-shifting artifact on the shore.

Asked what he wanted to convey to readers, Harrison said: "It's a grim world, and it'll keep on being grim. And it's weird. But at the end of things there may be some kind of — I wouldn't say hope, or closure, but there might be some kind of relief."

Critics have praised the book's dark humor, though some have been confused by its elusive narrative.

Historian Mary Beard, who chaired the judging panel, said the book is "the politics of now seen through the lens of the future," and about a society "undergoing a catastrophe that they don't really understand."

"What he does is to say, when the catastrophe comes, you won't know what's happening," Beard said. "And there are bits where you, the reader, are with the characters in not fully understanding. Now, I think that's fantastically exciting."



M John Harrison poses with the trophy in London on Tuesday. AP

Harrison spent years working for the speculative fiction magazine New Worlds, and he won the Arthur C. Clarke science fiction award for a previous novel, "Nova Swing." Although borders between publishing genres are increasingly blurred, it's still rare for a work of sci-fi to win a major literary prize.

Harrison said before he won that he had been "working for 40 to 50 years to shift the balance, both as a novelist and as a critic. Why shouldn't a well-written (work of science fiction) be considered to be literary fiction?"

He said after winning that the publishing industry had done nothing to break down barriers between categories.

"There's almost no point these days in writing your own book, because it will be framed as something else to sell it," he said. "To a degree, that's quite offensive" to the author.

He said the validation of the Booker Prize "gives you permission to be what you are, without a label stuck on your forehead." Booker Prize Foundation chief executive Gaby Wood noted that the prize has removed references to "literary fiction" from its materials, because "all fiction is literary."

Beard said Harrison's win was "recognition of what some people would see as the blindingly obvious, that you find great books in every genre."

Founded in 1969, the Booker Prize is open to English-language novels from any country published in the U.K. and Ireland and has a reputation for transforming writers' careers.

Its winners have included Salman Rushdie, Ian McEwan and Arundhati Roy. Last year's winner was "Flesh" by Hungarian-British writer David Szalay.

Harrison is the oldest writer to win the Booker, two years older than Margaret Atwood when she won in 2019. "The End of Everything" is his 13th novel. But Beard said the prize was definitely "not a lifetime achievement award." **AP**

The Editorial Page: Court dismantles unconstitutional buffer zone between detention & arrest 8

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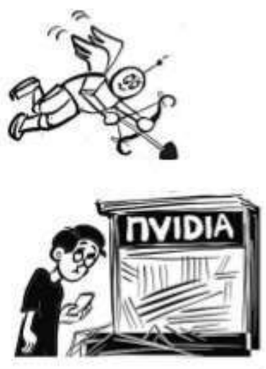
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Happening today

PRESIDENT DROUPADI Murmu will confer the Swachh Survekshan 2025-26 awards.

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



RUSSIA, UKRAINE AT U.S.-BROKERED TALKS IN ABU DHABI

Ukraine talks begin, India pushes for safe Black Sea, quick end to war

In touch with both sides to contribute towards return of peace in region: MEA

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, November 10

AS US-BROKERED talks between Russia and Ukraine began in Abu Dhabi Tuesday to try and end the nearly five-year war, India said it was "in touch with both sides" and other "interested parties" to "contribute" towards the "return of peace" to the region.

Ahead of the talks, which were last held in February this year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy who said India was ready to "mediate in establishing food

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THE IDEAS PAGE P 9
AT ABU DHABI, NEW DIPLOMATIC PUSH ON UKRAINE. STAKES HIGH FOR INDIA AND WORLD



UAE Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan (centre) during trilateral talks between Russia and Ukraine mediated by the US, in Abu Dhabi, Tuesday. AP

EXPLAINED

Vital to trade and security

The larger Black Sea region is key to trade and security interests of both Ukraine and Russia. It is the grain export hub of Ukraine, a major agricultural exporter. Russia too exports significant volumes of grain through the Azov-Black Sea region, an area it considers vital for military power projection.



Mist sprinklers being activated at ITO in New Delhi, Tuesday. At 299, the AQI was in the 'poor' category. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Crackers account for 71% of Delhi's PM2.5 on Diwali night: Data

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 10

FIRECRACKERS ACCOUNTED for 71% of fine particulate pollution in Delhi on Diwali night, shows a first-of-its-kind assessment by the country's premier atmospheric sciences research institute.

The assessment by the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune, based on real-time scientific data, shows that firecrackers contributed to 71.1% of PM2.5 pollution in Delhi's air between 1 am and 9 am on November 9 (Monday), immediately after the Diwali celebrations wound down.

The share of firecracker emissions in the PM2.5 concentration was much lower at 43.4% during the same hours on the night before Diwali, and even lower at 5.6% between 1 am and 9 am on November 7.

The IITM data corroborate the sharp spikes in actual ambient PM2.5 levels recorded at

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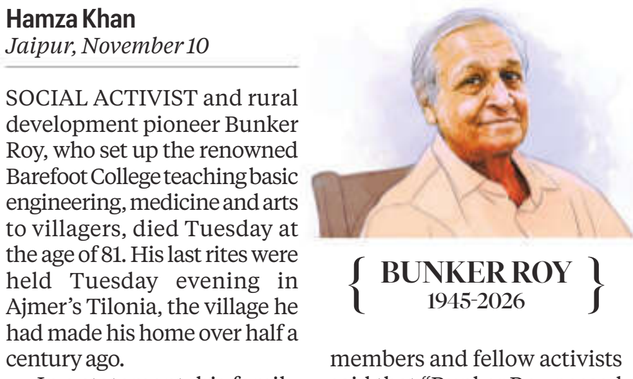
THE CITY PAGE 4
WINTER ACTION PLAN: RS 11 CR PENALTIES SLAPPED SO FAR, MOST FOR PUCC VIOLATIONS

THE BIG PICTURE
THE GANGA TAKES A PAUSE
PAGE 12

INSIDE
DU HISTORY FACULTY SAYS KEPT OUT OF PG SYLLABUS REVIEW, WRITES TO V-C
PAGE 4

'UNSPOKEN DIVISION OF RESPONSIBILITY': SONIA ON MANMOHAN

Pranab's desire to be PM shocked me, says Sonia; his daughter asks is ambition crime



Outside a bookstore in Khan Market in New Delhi, Tuesday. ANIL SHARMA

Ritu Sarin
New Delhi, November 10

THE LATE Pranab Mukherjee, former President and a Congress veteran, once dropped a big hint about his Prime Ministerial ambitions and suggested a "change at the top" during a chat with then-UPA chairperson Sonia Gandhi. This was in 2010, with Prime Minister Manmohan Singh firmly in the saddle in the UPA government's second term. Gandhi has written about this conversation in her memoir, *Belonging: A Journey of Love*, published by HarperCollins India.

Mukherjee, Gandhi has written, had developed "serious differences" with then Finance Minister P Chidambaram.

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INSIDE PAGE 6
'MY RAJIV WAS DEAD. HE WAS GONE... I DIDN'T WANT TO LIVE WITHOUT HIM'

Book courts Babri vote bank, papers over Bofors, family wrongs: BJP

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, November 10

CRITICISING CONGRESS Parliamentary Party (CPP) chairperson Sonia Gandhi's memoir, *Belonging: A Journey of Love*, the BJP on Tuesday said the "underlying thinking throughout the book revolves around the Babri (Masjid) vote bank".

Accusing her of trying to "justify" the Emergency, being "silent" on the Bofors scam, and making "claims completely contrary to the actual facts" on the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, the party said the book seeks to "sugar-coat the historical wrongs perpetrated by the Nehru-Gandhi family".

"Sonia Gandhi's book has made it clear that the underlying thinking throughout the book revolves around the Babri vote bank. She has revealed that vote-bank politics associated with Babri is deeply rooted in her thinking," said BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari.

"She says she cried for Babri Masjid. Did Sonia Gandhi shed

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Govt nominee votes tilt Gokul result in Mahayuti favour, Cong-led panel loses

Shubham Kurale & Manoj More
Kolhapur, Pune, November 10

WEEKS AFTER losing the election to the board of Maharashtra's largest dairy, Gokul, the candidate of the BJP-led Mahayuti alliance was elected the cooperative's chairman Tuesday. This came a day after the Bombay High Court upheld the Maharashtra government's decision to give voting rights to four government-nominated directors on the Gokul dairy board.

Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) leader and former Chandgad MLA Rajesh Patil was elected the dairy's chairman after the government-nominated directors tilted the contest in his favour. This triggered backlash from the Opposition, which accused the ruling alliance of "usurping power", and some farmer leaders in Kolhapur, where the cooperative is located.

In the October 19 election to the dairy's board, the Rajarshi Shahu Shetkari Samvichari Aghadi panel, led by Congress MLC Satej Patil, won 13 of the 25

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Newly elected chairman of Gokul dairy Rajesh Patil in Kolhapur, Tuesday. PTI

Year after his acquittal, Rampur terror attack accused shot dead

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, November 10

A YEAR after his release from jail following his acquittal by the Allahabad High Court in the 2007 terror attack on a CRPF camp that claimed eight lives, 52-year-old Mohammad Shareef was shot dead by unidentified men in Rampur Tuesday.

Shareef was riding pillion, behind his 21-year-old son, on a motorcycle when the assailants, also on a motorcycle, opened fire in the Khajuria area. Police said the assailants had covered their faces.

Shareef's son Abu Wais Khan told police that they were returning home when two youths, on another motorcycle, approached them near the Panwaria village crossing, opened fire at his father and fled.

Area residents alerted police who took Shareef to a hospital where doctors declared him dead. His son escaped unhurt.

Police said two bullet wounds were visible on Shareef's body. "The picture

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

At Barefoot College, social activist gave 'cop-outs, dropouts, washouts' new life

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, November 10



BUNKER ROY
1945-2026

SOCIAL ACTIVIST and rural development pioneer Bunker Roy, who set up the renowned Barefoot College teaching basic engineering, medicine and arts to villagers, died Tuesday at the age of 81. His last rites were held Tuesday evening in Ajmer's Tilonia, the village he had made his home over half a century ago.

In a statement, his family members and fellow activists said that "Bunker Roy passed away peacefully at 6.15 am with Aruna (wife and activist Aruna Roy) and others around him. He went as he wanted to, in his own home in Tilonia, surrounded by some of the countless people who loved and cared for him deeply and admired him for his lifelong contribution to people, society, India, and the planet."

Born Sanjit Roy in 1945 in an upper-middle-class Bengali family, Roy was educated at the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THEY SAY TITLE ALONE DOES NOT GUARANTEE SPONSORS, ELITE INVITES

100 grandmasters for India but for most, real test of wits begins after the title

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, November 10



Pranav V became India's 75th grandmaster in 2022 at the age of 16. His current rating is 2679. LENNART OOTES/FIDE

ON SUNDAY, India crossed an enviable milestone in chess: 38 years after Viswanathan Anand became India's first grandmaster, the nation now has 100 GMs. Ashok Shrivatri, the 22-year-old from Madhya Pradesh, will go down in chess history as the one to take India's GM count to triple figures.

There are many more in the frantic race to become the next GM, the sport's most prestigious honorific prefix and the top official title offered by FIDE. But unlike other life paths, such as pursuing an educational degree and a cushy job, becoming a grandmaster comes with no guarantees.

The "super grandmasters", who have crossed an Elo rating of 2,700, are usually invited to elite tournaments like Norway Chess, Tata Steel in Wijk aan Zee and Prague Masters — and India currently has five of them: R Praggnanandhaa, Arjun Erigaisi, D Gukesh, Nihal Sarin and Anand. But for most of the rest, just travelling to the next tier of tournaments, even if they get an invite, can burn a hole in the pocket.

"Becoming a grandmaster by itself does not lead to your life changing drastically. I became a grandmaster a few

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Ukraine talks begin

corridors" in Ukraine. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, meanwhile, spoke to Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov.

India's proposals revolve around easing the intense fighting since July around the critical Black Sea region — this will allow Ukraine's agricultural produce to reach the world; Russia halting attacks on Ukraine's energy infrastructure; and, Ukraine refraining from attacking Russian positions along the line of contact.

Responding to questions at a media briefing, Randhir Jaiswal, spokesperson for the Ministry of External Affairs, said, "On the issue of the Ukraine conflict, India has consistently maintained that dialogue and diplomacy are the way forward. In recent months, the Prime Minister has expressed that 'endless war must give way to end of war'. In keeping with this idea to bring peace, India has engaged both sides with certain ideas such as safety of shipping in the Black Sea, addressing immediate concerns of Russia and Ukraine on grain and energy exports, and non-attack possibilities."

"Yesterday, the Prime Minister spoke with President Zelenskyy. They shared perspectives on the ongoing conflict, its humanitarian aspects and various efforts to restore peace. Prime Minister reiterated India's firm commitment to contributing in every possible way towards a peaceful resolution," he said.

"Following this, the External Affairs Minister spoke with Foreign Minister Lavrov on the ongoing diplomatic initiatives focused on the conflict. On the issue of the food corridor, we have exchanged ideas. India remains in touch with both sides, as well as other interested parties, to contribute towards the return of peace to the region," Jaiswal said.

Last month, Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said India had put forward a "comprehensive" and "broad" proposal to end the war. Earlier, Russian President Vladimir Putin said Modi "constantly raises the question about putting an end to the conflict" and has "very good ideas".

Jaishankar too had said India was now a "little more involved beyond advocacy" and was having conversations with both Russia and Ukraine, trying to be "helpful" on the safety of shipping in the Black Sea, grain and energy exports and on "non-attack possibilities".

Of particular interest in the proposal is the larger Black Sea region, a key grain export hub for the world. The fighting there could put at least 400 million people in Africa, West Asia and Asia at risk of food shortages, malnutrition and hunger.

Ukraine, in particular, is a major agricultural exporter. Russia has targeted Ukrainian port facilities and vessel operations around the Greater Odesa region on the Black Sea coast. Ukraine has three key deep-water ports there — Odesa, Chornomorsk and Pivdennyi — which handle around 90% of its agricultural exports.

Since mid-July, Ukraine has also stepped up attacks on grain vessels, maritime infrastructure and ports on the Sea of Azov and the vital Kerch Strait that connects it to the Black Sea.

Russia exports significant volumes of grain through the Azov-Black Sea region — an estimated 42-44 million tonnes, or 77-81% of its total grain exports, is transported through this area.

This is why the trilateral talks in Abu Dhabi are being closely tracked. Last week, US President Donald Trump indicated that a broad deal was possible on ending the war in Ukraine and guaranteeing security in Europe.

Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner who, along with US envoy Steve Witkoff, is trying to broker a settlement, said he believed that there were "some good ideas how to bridge" the differences between the two sides. He told delegates that recent contacts with both sides had "really identified, narrowed the gaps", and that Trump was committed to achieving peace.

"He really has asked us to put extra effort into trying to find a solution that hopefully ends the war but also leaves both sides in a much stronger position to start pursuing the full potential of what their two amazing countries have the ability to reach," Kushner said at the start of the meeting.

Ukraine's chief delegate Rustem Umerov, in his opening remarks, said Kyiv was focused on achieving security guarantees and a lasting peace. Russian delegation chief Vladimir Medinsky said Moscow hoped for progress towards peace in the interest of the people of both countries.

India is also keen that the war in West Asia too comes to an end, and has called for free and safe navigation through the Strait of Hormuz.

Responding to questions on Strait of Hormuz, Jaiswal said, "We continue to call for free and safe navigation through the Strait of Hormuz. We are in touch with all concerned parties to avoid attacks on civilian shipping and seafarers, including vessels under the Indian flag and Indian seafarers." Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri was in the UAE last week, and Delhi had been in touch with Iran, Israel and the US among others over last several weeks. WITH AGENCY

Crackers

several air pollution monitoring stations in the capital on Diwali (Sunday) night. Fine particulate matter concentrations peaked at 4,985 µg/m³ in Jahangirpuri and 2,808 µg/m³ in Nehru Nagar at 3 am on November 9.

The IITM assessment has provided a breakdown of the relative contributions of various sources to PM2.5, including vehicular emissions, biomass-burning, waste-burning, secondary aerosols, and dust. Before Diwali night, these sources accounted for a bigger share of PM2.5 than firecrackers.

On the night of November 7 leading up to 9 am on Diwali morning for example, the major contributors to PM2.5 were secondary organic aerosols (20.8%), mixed or unresolved biofuel burning (18.1%), waste-burning (11.6%), secondary inorganic aerosols (10.3%), and vehicles (8.8%).

This changed dramatically on Diwali night leading up to 9 am on Monday. Firecrackers became the dominant contributor, while the shares of vehicles, secondary inorganic aerosols, secondary organic aerosols, and waste-burning fell to 6.9%, 5%, 4.5%, and 1.1% respectively.

Firecrackers continued to be the dominant contributor to Delhi's PM2.5 during the study hours of Tuesday as well, at 29.8%, the IITM study said. Secondary organic aerosols and transport sector emissions were the two next biggest contributors. Delhi's AQI was reported at 299 in the 'Poor' category on Tuesday.

Firecracker emissions are by nature episodic, unlike relatively continuous sources such as vehicular emissions. Their concentrations can change sharply depending on the timing and intensity of their bursting, wind speed, atmospheric mixing, and the height of the planetary boundary layer, which influences whether pollutants disperse or accumulate close to the ground.

The researchers flagged the uncertainties inherently associated with atmospheric processes, source characteristics, and observational limitations, and also the fact that their estimates take into consideration only the 1 am-to-9 am window for each date, and not full-day contributions.

Identifying firecracker emissions presents scientific challenges also because some of their chemical constituents overlap with those released by other combustion sources. Potassium, for instance, is a commonly used tracer for fireworks but is also released during biomass-burning, including crop-residue and wood-burning.

The challenges arising out of this overlap can increase as pollutants age in the atmosphere. A study published this year in the journal 'Environmental Science & Technology' found that fireworks-derived particles in Delhi's Diwali haze became internally mixed with biomass-burning aerosols, resulting in a "complex, chemically evolved haze".

Another study, published in 2022, which examined PM2.5 at two locations approximately 15 km apart in Delhi, found substantial variations in the concentrations of elements associated with fireworks. The study highlighted that the impact of firecrackers can vary across locations depending on the intensity of bursting, the movement of pollutants, and local atmospheric conditions.

"The source-apportionment estimates are derived using the best available source profiles, scientifically established methodologies, and practices accepted by the scientific community," IITM said.

Last month, the Advanced Atmospheric Chemistry and Aerosol Toxicity Analysis Laboratory (AATAL) was inaugurated at IITM's Delhi branch. The lab is equipped with instruments to analyse the chemical composition of atmospheric gases and aerosols, including PM2.5, metals, and toxic elements. It is integrated with IITM's Air Quality Warning and Integrated Decision Support System for Emissions (AIRWISE), which combines air-quality forecasts, observations, and source-apportionment information.

After the inauguration of AATAL on October 24, Dr Sachin Ghude, Project Director of the Metro Air Quality and Weather Service (MAQWS) of the Union Ministry of Earth Sciences, which is implemented by IITM, had said that the integrated system would provide early warnings and detailed information on sources contributing to deteriorating air quality, including stubble-burning, vehicular emissions, and construction and road dust, which would help identify the major sources of air pollution and plan targeted interventions.

Dr Ghude told *The Indian Express* Tuesday that the new IITM report marks the first time that firecracker emissions have been specifically included in an official source-apportionment estimate. In the absence of real-time measurements of firecracker-related aerosols, their impact has to be estimated indirectly.

Bunker Roy

premier Doon School in Dehradun and St Stephen's College in Delhi. He was also India's squash champion thrice. But, a visit to Palamu in Bihar (now Jharkhand) during the famine in the mid-1960s upended his worldview. As he told *The Indian Express* in 2015: "I went to the wrong school, wrong college and came back with a lot of arrogance." "After my education, I had a lot of fancy degrees and was told that I could overcome any problem. Then I went to a village in Bihar to help with the famine in 1966, and that experience of not being able to adapt to even a small village changed my life," he said.

Roy spent nearly a year-and-a-half travelling across the country, studying voluntary agencies, formulating his plans, and eventually settling in Tilonia. Here, along with his farmer friend Meghraj, he began with the simple task of drilling in open wells for water recharge, in one of India's most water-stressed regions.

In 1972, he started his experimental school, the Social Work and Research Centre (SWRC), which came to be globally known as the Barefoot College. Rooted in the Gandhian principles of self-reliance, dignity and decentralisation, the institution was built on the belief that the knowledge, skills and wisdom of rural communities are powerful resources for their own development. In Roy's own words, there were no failures in Tilonia. "Every failure is a beginning. Everyone had a chance in Tilonia. This is a place for cop outs, drop outs and wash outs."

The Barefoot College pioneered community-led approaches to rural development across areas such as solar energy, water conservation, education, healthcare, livelihoods and women's empowerment. One of its most transformative initiatives was the training of rural women, many of whom had never had formal education, as solar engineers. Popularly known as 'Solar Mamas', these women brought electricity to remote communities across the world.

In a statement Tuesday, the Barefoot College said Roy's "legacy will live on". "From night schools for rural children to community-based water management and renewable energy initiatives, his work demonstrated that meaningful development must be rooted in local ownership and participation."

The citation for the Padma Shri awarded to Roy in 1986 termed his work the 'Tilonia Movement', and noted, "the idea was to start a process of generating awareness and at the same time demystifying technology, making it simple, effective, inexpensive and accessible".

In 2010, he was named as one of the '100 Most Influential People in the World' by TIME magazine in the 'Thinkers' category. The other recognitions to Roy included the Jamnalal Bajaj Award for Application of Science and Technology for Rural Development (1985), the Tyler Prize for Environmental Achievement (2004), the Skoll Award for Social Entrepreneurship (2005), the Blue Planet Prize (2011) and the Clinton Global Citizen Award in 2013.

Last year, King Charles III of the United Kingdom wrote to Roy saying that "I am constantly singing your praises whenever I can, especially in Africa. There is much to discuss as I have many initiatives going on around the world..." Then Prince Charles, the royal first visited the Barefoot Collège in November 1975, and then again in February 1992 with Princess Diana.

In life and in work, he was complemented by wife Aruna, whom he first met while both were classmates at Delhi University. Aruna left the IAS in 1975 to join Roy in Tilonia. An eminent activist herself, she was a key architect of the grassroots movement that led to the Right to Information Act in 2005.

In her memoir *The Personal is Political*, Aruna wrote: "The need for an RTI law was built brick by brick, incident by incident. If the IAS showed what should not be, Barefoot College SWRC gave me a platform to evolve what should be."

Congress leaders Ashok Gehlot, Jairam Ramesh, Shashi Tharoor and Sachin Pilot were among those who paid tributes to Roy. While Gehlot recalled visiting the Barefoot College recently, Pilot said his contribution to rural empowerment would always be remembered. Tharoor said that the work of Roy, his senior from St Stephen's College, demonstrated that villagers without formal education possessed skills and ability to bring change to their communities.

Long-time associate and social activist Nikhil Dey noted that their approaches were different, but "Bunker would be unequivocal in his support". "Which is why the Barefoot College gave birth to many independent organisations across the country, who worked together and did not break away from the Tilonia family."

Writer Amitav Ghosh called Roy "a true hero", while academic Amitabh Mattoo said "India has lost one of the few men who took Gandhi literally".

Pranab's desire to be PM

"...and on one occasion, in 2010, I think, after expressing his frustration, he shocked me with the suggestion that perhaps it was time for a change at the top, which I understood as a hint of his long-held desire to become prime minister," she wrote.

"I gently changed the subject, and though he may have been disappointed, he never made me feel he held it against me. Our party did nominate him in 2012 as the UPA candidate for president, the highest office in our republic, and he was elected. I often called on him, mostly just to converse with the erudite and knowledgeable politician that he always remained," Gandhi added.

Pranab Mukherjee served as President from 2012 to 2017. He died in 2020. His years in Rashtrapati Bhavan saw the UPA being voted out of power and the NDA forming the government under Prime Minister Narendra Modi. President Mukherjee also shared a warm rapport with Prime Minister Modi, the latter describing him as a "father figure".

Gandhi also trashed allegations that she sent for files from the Prime Minister's Office, interfered with administrative matters, and made key appointments. "Though I had been the subject of worse accusations over the years, the fabrication that distressed me most was that I was looking into official files – something improper for anyone outside the government," she wrote.

She wrote that there was an "unspoken division of responsibility between the prime minister and me, one that worked smoothly: the government under Dr. Manmohan Singh, and the party under me". "A core group met weekly with the prime minister to ensure coordination between the two. Its other members were Pranab Mukherjee, who had been a minister in Indira Gandhi's cabinet in the '70s; the politically insightful Arjun Singh, a former chief minister of Madhya Pradesh; A. K. Antony, a former chief minister of Kerala; and Ahmed Patel," she wrote.

In a response on X, Pranab Mukherjee's daughter and former Congress leader Sharmistha Mukherjee questioned if it is a "crime to be ambitious". "What's there to get 'shocked' about? Is it a crime to be ambitious, especially when that 'ambition' was supported by decades of experience in politics & governance, hard work & a brilliant mind? Once, when asked by me whether he wanted to become PM, he very candidly answered that 'any politician worth his salt has this ambition'," she said in her post.

"My father came from a very humble background. Whatever he achieved in his life was through sheer merit & hard-work. There was no-one to serve him positions, including PM-ship, on a platter due to dynastic entitlements. If a well-deserving person harbours ambition to become Prime Minister, what's wrong in that, unless Sonia ji was 'shocked' by the fact that anyone outside Gandhi-Nehru family could even dare to nurture such an ambition & furthermore dared to 'hint' it to her?"

"In this same context, I read that she said she felt 'he never held it against me'. From what I read in his diaries & whatever conversation he had with me, I would like to reassure her that he DID NOT hold it against her or anyone else. He was a pragmatic person with deep understanding. He understood her reasons & insecurities that all human beings are prone to," she wrote.

BJP

even a drop of tear when gurudwaras were targeted and thousands of innocent people were killed during the 1984 Sikh massacre that happened during the Congress rule?Sonia Gandhi cried profusely for the Batla House terrorists, but did she weep for the brave CRPF jawans who were martyred in the line of duty protecting our nation and people," BJP's national spokesperson C R Kesavan said in a post on X.

In an interview to *The Guardian* before the release of her book, Gandhi had recalled crying as she watched the Babri Masjid demolition on television on December 6, 1992.

"The Bofors scam is missing from the book. The country witnessed corruption in the Bofors scam, but the Gandhi-Vadra family remains silent on it. Vote-bank politics and corruption are habits of the Gandhi-Vadra family, and they will lose again in 2029," Bhandari said.

"Sonia Gandhi could have titled her memoir as 'Whitewashing' instead of 'Belonging', because the motive of this book appears to be to sugar-coat the historical wrongs perpetrated by the Nehru-Gandhi family and camouflage the cardinal sins committed by the Congress party," Kesavan said, accusing her of trying to "justify and normalise the notorious Emergency".

BJP leader H S Phoolka questioned Gandhi's account of the anti-Sikh riots. "She claims that on the night of October 31, Rajiv Gandhi asked Army Chief General (A S) Vaidya to call in the Army. However, General Vaidya supposedly decided on his own that the Army personnel stationed around Delhi were Sikhs and that Sikh troops should not be called in. She says that the Army was instead summoned from distant locations such as Dehradun, which delayed its deployment. These claims are completely contrary to the actual facts," he said.

Hitting back at the BJP, Congress's Rajya Sabha member Rajeev Shukla said the party was trying to give the book a "political spin". "She is perhaps the first person in the family after (Jawaharlal) Nehru ji who has written an autobiography. She has penned down all her thoughts. So, I think people should respect her thoughts, respect the sentiments that she has expressed. This should not be turned into a controversy," he said.

"The BJP is trying to give this a political spin. What is the need for this? I saw a statement by a BJP spokesperson who asked if Babar lives in her heart. When Babri Masjid was demolished, Atal ji had criticised it. Did Babar live in his heart? Advani ji had called it a grave mistake. Did Babar live in his heart? Jaswant Singh strongly condemned it. Did Babar live in his heart? A few BJP spokespersons know neither history nor background," said Shukla.

Meanwhile, Shiv Sena leader Shaina NC said: "You speak of belonging, we ask who is this belonging for? In 1991, 1984 and 2004, you made the country cry, and now you speak of belonging. Is this belonging about votes? The way you rejected the chair back then, and the way you presented yourself thereafter, was portrayed as an act of sacrifice and penance. We would like answers to several questions. As far as the Ram Temple, Article 370 and Hindutva are concerned, these are not achieved by crying. Your actions are what establish you as a leader."

100 GMs

months ago, and not much has changed. Sponsors aren't knocking on my doors. And I have not received any invitation from prestigious tournaments," said a young grandmaster who did not wish to be named. Chennai-based Ilamparthi A R became India's 90th grandmaster in October 2025 at the age of 16. Ilamparthi points out that being a grandmaster does make it slightly cheaper to play in chess events, but he has had to spend his own money to cover most of the expenses.

"While life hasn't changed much for me since becoming GM, the only thing that has changed is that in tournaments organisers will give you 'conditions'," says Ilamparthi, who trains at the Chess Thulir academy in Chennai with grandmaster Shyam Sundar Mohanraj. What Ilamparthi means is that organisers usually foot the bill for accommodation, and sometimes full board and lodging, but the flight costs are still borne by the grandmasters.

There are exceptions to this as well. At an event like Sharjah Masters, even grandmasters have to pay entry fees that can go up to $100, besides all other costs. There are other events in Europe where no "conditions" are offered by organisers because the prize money on offer is high. At the moment, having become a GM, the only invitation that Ilamparthi has received is to play in leagues, like in Turkey.

Kanyakumari's Aswath S was India's 98th grandmaster, earning the title in July at the age of 17. Aswath, who also trains at Chess Thulir, said that becoming a grandmaster is usually the start of another race: to get to a rating threshold of 2,600 and then to 2,700.

Four years ago, Pranav V became the 75th grandmaster of India. He has since been playing in league after league, trying to raise his rating. While becoming a GM reduced the financial burden of playing in tournaments, his costs have gone up in other areas, like hiring superior coaches and trainers, who have steeper rates.

"And after you cross 2600 rating, the training gets even more expensive. Then, once you get past the 2700-mark, you will start hiring other people for your team, like seconds," he says.

Akash Ganesan was India's 66th grandmaster, getting there in 2020 at the age of 23 after taking a mini-break of four years from chess to focus on his academics and become an engineer. He has a different, less cynical perspective than many of the recent grandmasters.

"There is a lot of recognition you get from being a grandmaster. The way people look at you is very different from when you are an international master. Back in 2014, becoming a grandmaster was a very big deal. We had comparatively fewer grandmasters and the sport was getting bigger," he says.

Akash is one of those grandmasters who leveraged his title to transition into coaching — a lucrative side hustle because they can command steep hourly fees. Akash currently runs a chess academy called Madras School of Chess, in partnership with Vishnu Prasanna.

To chase the dream of becoming a grandmaster, players have given up other parts of their life to focus full-time on the battlefield of 64 squares. Some families have even sold their property, like that of GM Aronyak Ghosh. Many parents have quit jobs to become full-time chaperones to their young children travelling around the world chasing grandmaster norms.

So when life does not change all that much after becoming a grandmaster, and there are barely any sponsors or elite tournament invitations knocking on your door, why are thousands of players desperately chasing the title? International Master Deboushnik De, who is among those thousands, laughs and counters with a question of his own. "I understand the question: what after becoming a grandmaster? But you could ask the same question to Gukesh, too: what after becoming world champion? Being a grandmaster is never the final destination; it's just one significant step in a chess career," he says.

Gokul

director seats, while the Mahayuti-backed Chhatrapati Shahu Shetkari Vikas Aghadi panel secured 12 posts. However, the 12 from the Mahayuti initially stayed away from the board meeting on the chairman's election, denying Patil's panel the 14 members allegedly required for a quorum under Gokul's existing bylaws. The ruling alliance said the quorum requirement was not introduced after the election.

The deadlock raised the possibility of an administrator being appointed. The 13 directors allied with Satej Patil held a separate meeting and declared Shashikant Patil Chuyekar the chairman. However, the dairy administration did not recognise the decision and the Opposition group moved Bombay HC. The Maharashtra Cabinet on November 4 approved an ordinance giving the government the power to appoint five directors to cooperatives with an annual turnover over Rs 500 crore, with four of them having voting rights. This turned the Gokul contest in Mahayuti's favour and led LoP Rahul Gandhi to accuse BJP of attempting to "steal the majority" in the dairy. The ordinance was promulgated on November 6.

On Monday, the HC refused to put a stay on the election and allowed the four nominated directors to vote, but said their votes must be kept in a separate ballot box. Rajesh Patil on Tuesday bagged 16 votes, while Chuyekar got 13.

Satej Patil Tuesday accused the Maharashtra government of "trampling upon all democratic norms". "If the government wants to snatch power, then why hold elections? The government's behaviour goes against the spirit of the Constitution," he told *The Indian Express*.

Targeting CM Devendra Fadnavis, Patil said, "It was an attempt to throw us off guard. The election process does not require a quorum, yet the government did it anyway. An ordinance was issued just to seize power in Gokul."

Shiv Sena (UBT) MP Sanjay Raut accused BJP of attempting to "overturn a democratic mandate". "One needs great courage to accept defeat, but I do not see that courage in BJP. Such attempts to manipulate the Gokul election do not suit Maharashtra's political legacy," he said.

Defending the government's decision, Fadnavis said it was in accordance with the law. "I am supporting the institution (Gokul Dairy), not any individual. I am not behind any particular person. The four nominated board members had experience in the cooperative sector and the Deputy Registrar of Cooperative Societies had certified their credentials," he said.

Rajesh Patil thanked the farmers associated with Gokul and said he would focus on taking the dairy to the national level. "I will also work towards recovering the losses incurred in last financial year, while keeping aside politics in the union." Rajya Sabha MP Dhananjay Mahadik, a political rival of Satej Patil whose family wields control in Kolhapur, credited Fadnavis and Deputy CMs Eknath Shinde and Sunetra Pawar with resolving the issue. He said the alliance had agreed to limit Rajesh Patil's tenure to a year.

State Medical Education Minister Hasan Mushrif, who had teamed up with Satej Patil in the election five years ago, welcomed the pact between the allies and thanked Fadnavis and his Cabinet colleagues Chandrakant Patil and Prakashrao Abitkar for their support.

However, farmer leader and Swabhimani Shetkari Sanghatana founder Raju Shetti warned that the "people of Kolhapur will not remain silent". "The haste with which Mahayuti government introduced the ordinance and twisted the chairman's election outcome," he said.

Rajesh Patil's win is also significant in the context of the local political equations in Kolhapur, particularly the apparent rapprochement between LS MP Sanjay Mandlik and Mushrif, who had been at loggerheads in the past. Rajesh Patil is Mandlik's brother-in-law. In 2021, Rajesh Patil's wife and Mandlik's son both had lost to the panel led by Satej Patil and Mushrif, who was then in the undivided NCP.

Terror accused killed

will become clear after the post-mortem examination," Rampur Additional SP Anurag Singh said. "Shareef's son told us that the assailants had covered their faces and opened fire while their motorcycle was still moving," Singh said.

After his release from jail last year, Shareef had been living with his family in Badanpuri village.

His younger brother Shaheen said, "Shareef had gone to Khajuria police station with his son, Abu Wais Khan, on a motorcycle after being called by the police. The two were returning home after meeting police personnel and had travelled barely 200 metres when motorcycle-borne assailants approached from behind and opened fire on Shareef... Police had summoned Shareef to the police station on earlier occasions as well."

Shareef was arrested in connection with the terror attack on a CRPF camp in Rampur on the night of December 31, 2007. Seven CRPF personnel and a rickshaw-puller were killed. Five others were injured in the attack.

Police arrested Shareef along with Jung Bahadur from Moradabad, Kausar from Pratapgarh, Khan from Bareilly and Sabaduddin from Bihar. Two Pakistani nationals, Shahzad and Farooq, were also arrested in the case. Police said they had recovered AK-47 rifles, magazines, grenades and other items from the accused.

In November, 2019, a local court in Rampur awarded the death sentence to Shareef, Sabauddin and the two Pakistani nationals, Imran Shahzad and Mohammad Farooq. Jung Bahadur was sentenced to life in prison while Gulab Khan and Mohammad Kausar were acquitted due to lack of sufficient evidence.

In October 2025, the Allahabad High Court set aside the order of death penalty to the four men and life imprisonment for the fifth, citing defects in the investigation that struck at "the root of the case". It mainly cited gaps related to eyewitness accounts and the safekeeping of evidence.

It, however, sentenced the five to 10 years' rigorous imprisonment under Section 25 (1-A) of the Arms Act, 1959, related mainly to possession, and imposed a fine of Rs 1 lakh on each.

The High Court ruled that the "period of imprisonment undergone by the appellants will be adjusted towards... sentence awarded to the appellants".

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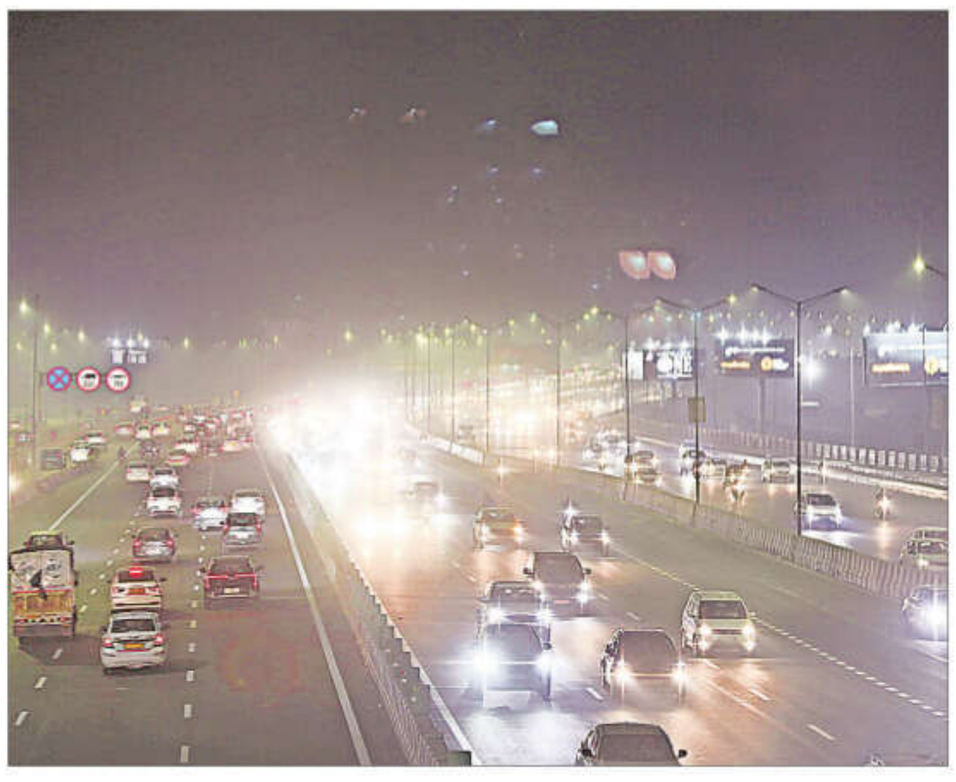
IN FIRST NINE DAYS OF ANTI-POLLUTION CURBS

Rs 11 crore in fines imposed under Winter Action Plan, most over PUCC violations

Alok Singh
New Delhi, November 10

AT AROUND 8 crore, penalties for Pollution Under Control Certificates (PUCCs) violations accounted for a majority of fines imposed in Delhi in the first nine days since the Winter Action Plan came into effect in the Capital on November 1.

While fines amounting to at least Rs 11 crore have been imposed during this period, violations related to the entry of vehicles below BS-VI emission standards and construction sites accounted for more than Rs 1.5 crore each, according to the data accessed from government sources. Private cars accounted for the highest number of challans among vehicles violating the non-BS-VI emission-related curbs.



Delhi remained shrouded by haze on Tuesday night. ABHINAV SAHA

Most PUCC violations by two-wheelers

For PUCC violations, the consolidated data shows that the Delhi Transport department and the Delhi Police issued 8,288 challans, amounting to Rs 8,28,80,000, as of November 9. Two-wheelers accounted for a majority of these vehicles followed by cars and heavy goods vehicles (HGVs), according to the government sources. Sources said many two-wheeler owners were found operating vehicles with expired pollution certificates.

Under Section 190(2) of the Motor Vehicles Act and Rule 115(7) of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, driving a vehicle without a valid PUCC draws a fine of Rs 1,000 for the first offence, which can go up to Rs 10,000 for subsequent offences.

Repeat offenders may also face additional penalties, including the suspension of their driving licences and cancellation of vehicle registrations, officials said.

Most challans for private cars

As part of the restrictions on vehicles below BS-VI emission standards, 18,304 vehicles were turned back at Delhi's borders, while 1,451 were challaned and 119 impounded. The penalties imposed in these cases amounted to Rs 1,16,28,000. Private cars accounted for the highest number of challans among vehicles violating the BS-VI entry restrictions, with 724 challans amounting to Rs 66.14 lakh. Trucks accounted for 179 challans, while buses were issued just six challans.

Around 80 teams from the Transport department and the Delhi Traffic Police have been deployed at the Capital's borders and 37 pollution hotspots have been identified to keep a check on vehicles violating the norms.

4,000 construction sites inspected

Meanwhile, teams with officials from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi inspected 4,004 construction sites and found 392 violating pollution-control norms.

Of these, 81 sites were ordered to shut down, while 312 were served show-cause notices. As part of the Delhi government's Winter Action Plan, outdoor construction activities and dust-generating demolition work have been prohibited until January 31, except for essential public infrastructure projects.

The government barred vehicles exceeding their prescribed lifespan from refuelling at 500 petrol pumps equipped with Automatic Number Plate Recognition cameras. Further, non-BS-VI petrol and diesel vehicles registered outside Delhi have been prohibited from entering the city.

CNG and electric vehicles have been exempted from the restrictions.

Earlier, on October 30, citing historically high pollution levels observed in November over the years, the Commission for Air Quality Management in the National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas ordered a 15-day ban on dust-generating demolition and outdoor construction activities across the region. The restriction came into effect on November 5.

The CAQM also directed government and private offices in Delhi and five NCR districts—Gurugram, Faridabad, Sonipat, Ghaziabad and Gautam Buddha Nagar—to allow up to 50% of their employees to work from home.

• Skywatch

Forecast: Nov 11, 2026
Partly cloudy sky. No rain. Mist, shallow fog

MAX: 27-29
0.5°C below normal

MIN: 14-16
1.7°C above normal

- *Sunrise: 6:41 AM (November 12)*
- *Sunset: 5:30 PM (November 11)*

• AQI Tracker

Sirifort: Very Poor, AQI: 337	Rohini: Very Poor, AQI: 301
Anand Vihar: Very Poor, AQI: 304	DTU: Very Poor, AQI: 324

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

After monitoring units go blank on Diwali night, CPCB clarifies

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, November 10

THE CENTRAL Pollution Control Board's (CPCB) air quality monitors could not capture the spike in particulate matter (PM) pollution on Diwali night as the analysers only measure in the range of 0–1,000 micrograms per cubic metre (µg/m³), and treats hourly readings beyond this calibration as "outside range", the pollution watchdog said on Tuesday in response to criticism of data gaps in pollution monitoring.

Delhi recorded its worst Diwali-day air quality since 2021 on Sunday. As it hinted at a review of the system, the watchdog issued the clarification after 45 of the 59 monitoring stations had missing hourly readings for at least one pollutant.

The Indian Express on Monday reported that the CPCB portal stations recorded blank hourly particulate concentrations as the load of particulate matter, fine particles emitted through burning and combustion, exceeded 1,000 µg/m³. However, Delhi Pollution Control Committee's continuous monitoring data showed that multiple stations recorded values as high as 5,000 µg/m³ during the period.

While acknowledging that monitoring instruments have advanced considerably, it added "internal consultations with respect to processing of data are underway".

Delhi vehicle curbs: Metro clocks nearly 4 days of over 78 lakh boardings in 1st week

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, November 10

THE DELHI Metro recorded high passenger boardings in the first week of November, as winter pollution-control restrictions barred non-BS-VI vehicles registered outside the capital from entering the city.

On Monday, November 2, the first working day under the new restrictions, passenger boardings rose to 80.54 lakh, up 8.3 lakh from the previous Monday's figure of 72.24 lakh.

The numbers remained high through the week. The Metro recorded 78.47 lakh boardings on Tuesday and 79.22 lakh on Wednesday.

EXPRESS special

The figure dipped slightly to 78.2 lakh on Thursday before falling to 72.43 lakh on Friday. On Monday, the Yellow and Blue lines carried the largest share of passengers. Each accounted for 26.4% of total boardings, with 21.27 lakh and 21.23 lakh respectively. They were followed by the Pink, Red and Violet lines.

Monday's figure also exceeded the network's typical daily average of around 64 lakh passenger journeys and came remarkably close to the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation's all-time record of 82.44 lakh boardings.

That previous peak, set in September 2026, was triggered by an operational crisis when a major strike by Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus drivers halted over 80% of the city's public bus fleet and forced millions of daily bus commuters onto the trains.

Unlike the September surge, the increase in November followed the enforcement of the Delhi government's winter action plan.

The restrictions kept an estimated 48 lakh older vehicles registered in neighbouring National Capital Region districts out of Delhi.

To handle the inflow of commuters displaced by the vehicle curbs, the DMRC operated 40 additional train trips daily alongside enhanced station management measures.

How ridership rose during the DTC strike

During the earlier period of high ridership caused by the DTC strike, daily boardings ranged between 72 lakh and 82 lakh.

On the first day of the strike, a Monday, passenger boardings stood at 72.73 lakh. The figure rose to 76.86 lakh on Tuesday and 80.71 lakh on Wednesday. It reached a record 82.44 lakh on Thursday, when the maximum number of buses were off the roads. Passenger journeys are different from the number of people travelling on the Metro on a given day.

The figure counts the number of Metro lines a passenger uses to complete a journey.

For instance, if a passenger changes a line once to reach his destination, it will be calculated as two journeys, and if she changes their line twice, it will be calculated as three journeys.

Delhi Metro used to calculate passenger ridership until 2018, but it started reporting passenger journeys from 2019.

AR Rahman concert in Gurugram postponed

Suanshu Khurana
New Delhi, November 10



AR Rahman . FILE

ACADEMY AWARD-winning composer AR Rahman's concert, which was scheduled to take place at Backyard Sports Club in Gurugram on November 21, has been postponed, according to organisers. The show is part of his ongoing 'Wonderment Tour'.

Ticket holders, who paid anywhere from Rs 2,499 for general standing to Rs 1,50,000 for premium VIP decks, have, however, received cancellation emails, besides full refunds.

In a statement shared with The Indian Express by Eva Live, the primary national producer for the concert, the concert is being postponed due to "unforeseen circumstances" and "last minute critical developments that cannot be avoided".

According to the company representatives, the concert will now be scheduled next year. But a fresh date has not been announced yet. District by Zomato updated the concert status as 'cancelled'. 'District Care', the online ticketing platform's official support handle, also replied to a fan on social media, saying that the show had been "cancelled".

"...We understand how disappointing this news must be... Unfortunately, due to unforeseen circumstances, the AR Rahman concert in Delhi on 21st November has been cancelled. We sincerely regret that things didn't work out as expected and apologise for the disappointment caused..." it stated. Earlier this year, the composer's concert in Kolkata, also a part of the same tour, which was to take place on January 11, had also been postponed and rescheduled for April 11 due to "scheduling considerations", according to an Instagram post by Rhythm Box India, Eva Live's local partners. It was then postponed indefinitely and never took place.

Kept out of PG syllabus review, says DU history faculty

Writes to V-C, and objects to changes proposed by expert panel; row follows wider concerns over changes to syllabi

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, November 10



DU's Executive Council gives final approval for new syllabus. FILE

THE DEPARTMENT of History of Delhi University has questioned the functioning of an Expert Committee constituted by the Vice-Chancellor to review its Post Graduate third-semester syllabus, claiming that the head of the department, who is a member of the panel, was being kept out of final decisions. It has also disputed some of the changes recommended by the Expert Committee, including that a paper taught for over a decade be dropped as it was "ideologically loaded".

According to the minutes of a Department Council meeting held on September 10 and accessed by *The Indian Express*, HoD Anirudh Deshpande told the faculty of the History Department that he was "not being made a party to final decisions" regarding the syllabus review. The council subsequently "expressed dismay at the composition of the Expert Committee" and asked Deshpande to convey its concerns to Vice-Chancellor Yogesh Singh.

On October 9, Deshpande wrote to the V-C on behalf of the department, placing on record concerns raised by the faculty over the composition, functioning and recommendations of the Expert Committee. Both Expert Committee Chairperson Shriprakash Singh and Deshpande refused to comment on the matter when contacted.

The History Department's objections comes amid wider concerns over changes to syllabi of various courses at DU under the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020. *The Indian Express* reported in August that several history papers taught at DU for decades, including 'The Delhi Sultanate: Structures of Authority in Medieval North India (13th-14th Centuries)', did not feature in the revised PG syllabus.

The October 9 letter pointed to the number of PG papers still awaiting notification. "Almost half of our DSE (Discipline Specific Elective) papers in the Semester III syllabus are yet to be notified," the letter said. These include papers on the history of caste, gender, labour and the Northeast.

The letter sought an early meeting with the V-C for discussion on issues "affecting the working of the department". *The Indian Express* reached out to V-C Singh over calls and messages but did not receive a response.

Dr Ankit Agrawal, Assistant Professor of History at PGDAV College and a member of the Expert Committee, denied that Deshpande or the Department's views had been sidelined. "All papers brought by the History Department were discussed by the Expert Committee, and nothing was rejected out of goodwill and with an intention to make things better. Experts only made suggestions for the department to incorporate... The HoD participated in all the meetings, discussed the papers, and his opinions were taken into account," Agrawal told *The Indian Express*.

The varsity earlier defended its syllabus review exercise, saying some papers in History had been altered even after they were cleared by DU's Standing Committee, including changes to course units and reading lists. Dean of Academic Affairs K Ratnabali told *The Indian Express* then that the Expert Committee for History was constituted by the V-C to examine courses that required further review.

In the October 9 letter to the V-C, Deshpande referred to online meetings held by the Expert Committee on July 30 and August 5, where Chairperson Singh told members to submit written suggestions, to be passed on to the V-C.

However, the HoD wrote, the Expert Committee's final report "does not record the detailed justifications, rationale and arguments presented by (me) in response to the issues raised by committee members".

The letter also took issue with the academic basis of some of the committee's observations, describing them as "vague, unsubstantiated and lacking the academic rigour and seriousness usually associated with discussions on course content". One example cited in the letter was the committee's recommendation to drop a paper titled 'History of Education in Colonial India (DSE 31)'.

Deshpande's letter said the Department Council found the charge that the paper was "ideologically loaded" disturbing.

"Even a cursory glance at the range of historians included in the reading list and the course content of DSE 31 proves this charge to be devoid of substance," the letter said, calling for overturning the recommendation. 'History of Education in Colonial India' examines indigenous education, Orientalist-Anglicist debates, Dalit and Adivasi educational experiences, missionaries and reformers, and nationalist alternatives, including Swadeshi education and Nai Talim (an idea proposed by Mahatma Gandhi). As per the letter, the paper had already been "substantially revised to pass muster" with the Standing Committee.

DU Academic Council member Maya John said: "It has now become a practice in DU that due process for syllabi framing is continually compromised. Amendments in papers are often sought at the level of the Standing Committee of Academic Affairs wherein Department Heads are frequently directed to make changes in syllabi like the removal of entire papers vetted by the Departmental Committee of Courses / subject experts and numerous revisions in papers. Notably, any 'oversight' committee constituted on issues of syllabi should be constituted via the university's statutory bodies like the Academic Council, but in the case of the MA History syllabus, it is disturbing to see handpicked persons constituting the 'Expert' or so-called 'Oversight Committee'... Their recommendations often appear political, and not academic in nature."

Another Academic Council Member, Monami Sinha, said: "If DU wanted a fully egalitarian view of the history syllabus, space should have been given to faculty members who are already a part of the Academic Council. Instead, the Expert Committee has members who have a background in Political Science and Commerce."

• RECREATIONAL CRUISE DEVELOPED ALONG A 4-KM STRETCH BETWEEN SONIA VIHAR AND JAGATPUR

Half-an-hour ride for Rs 500: In a first, an electric cruise launched on Yamuna

Alok Singh
New Delhi, November 10

FOR RS 500, residents of Delhi can now take a 45-minute electric cruise ride on the Yamuna. This comes after the Delhi government on Tuesday launched a river safari service at Sonia Vihar in a bid to promote tourism and reconnect people with the river, officials said.

Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated the 'Namo Yamuna River Cruise Service', developed jointly by the government and the Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI). According to officials, the pilot project will offer recreational boating and short-distance ferry services along a stretch of the river between Sonia Vihar and Jagatpur.

Officials said that the government has introduced an electric cruise with a seating capacity of 30 passengers. A second vessel of the same capacity is expected to be launched by February-March 2027.

The proposed entry fee to the premises is Rs 50, while a complete cruise journey will cost Rs 500. The ride will take approximately 35 to 45 minutes, with passengers returning to their starting point after completing the trip, officials said.

Calling the launch a significant moment for the Capital, Gupta said the initiative was not merely a cruise or boat service but an effort to reconnect people with the Yamuna, which she described as an integral part of Delhi's identity, culture and religious traditions. "Namo Yamuna River Safari reflects our faith, love and devotion towards Maa Yamuna," she said, adding that residents would now be able to experience the river's natural surroundings without travelling to cities such as Prayagraj for boat and cruise rides.

Gupta also urged people to visit the destination with their families and bring their children to experience the river and its surroundings. She said the project would give a new identity to Delhi's tourism sector and strengthen the Capital's image.

Taking a swipe at previous governments, Gupta said politics in the past had revolved around allegations, counter-allegations and excuses rather than development.



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh at the launch of the cruise ride on Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Her government, she said, was working to address long-pending problems and improve public facilities.

Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra said the project would offer visitors a new recreational experience, with facilities including a musical fountain, food court, gaming activities, a creative zone, ecological and walking trails as well as a children's play area.

"The musical fountain will showcase the story of Lord Krishna and the significance of Yamuna Maiya through music," Mishra said.

The officials said, under the pilot project, a stretch of approximately 6 km between Wazirabad Barrage and Jagatpur has been identified as suitable for water transport, subject to a minimum navigational depth of 1.5 metres.

The recreational cruise and ferry facilities have been developed along an approximately 4-km stretch between Sonia Vihar and Jagatpur, they added.

A riverfront terminal has been established at Sonia Vihar, with two floating jetties for passengers to board and disembark, an official said.

On the facilities, an official said that separate toilets for men, women and persons with disabilities, a sewage treatment plant, a drinking water borewell and a charging station for electric cruises have also been developed.

The service will remain closed annually between July 1 and September 30, keeping in view the river conditions during the monsoon, officials said.

Meanwhile, Public Works Department (PWD) and Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said cleaning the Yamuna and developing a riverfront had been among the government's priorities since it assumed office.

Centre claims century-old Waqf graveyard in Civil Lines, High Court steps in

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 10





The graveyard was notified as Waqf property in 1970.
SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

THE DELHI High Court has directed the Centre to maintain status quo over a century-old Waqf-notified graveyard in Civil Lines after the Land and Development Office (L&DO) issued an eviction notice claiming that the land is owned by the government.

Protecting the graveyard, Justice Amit Mahajan on November 6 directed the Centre "to maintain status quo till the next date of hearing" scheduled for March 11, 2027. The court also sought the response of Centre and the Delhi Waqf Board, respondent parties to the plea, by the next date of hearing.

The Qabristan Bagh Sher Jung, managed by a registered charitable society called Anjuman Wakil-I-Quam Punjabian, is situated between Ludlow Castle Road and Under Hill Road. Spread over 17 acres, the graveyard has ancient graves, shrines, a functional mosque and a madrasa. The society has been in existence since before 1910.

The eviction notice follows a series of notices issued by the L&DO to properties in Lutyens' Delhi. Another Waqf-notified property, the Delhi Race Course Masjid, opposite Prime Minister Narendra Modi's residence at 7, Lok Kalyan Marg, is also facing the prospect of demolition, with the L&DO having taken possession of the adjoining Delhi Race Club and Jaipur Polo Ground.

1985 ruling at centre of the dispute

On October 22, the L&DO issued an eviction notice to four alleged encroachers on the graveyard premises, asking them to vacate within 15 days, failing which possession would be taken over forcibly.

The four had been deemed encroachers on a portion of the graveyard land in a civil suit instituted by the graveyard's management in 2018.

However, the October 22 notice also claimed that the entire 17-acre plot "is the property of the Government of India and is vested in and administered by the L&DO under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)". The graveyard's management has contested this claim.

The graveyard was notified as Waqf property in 1970. A year later, the Centre filed a civil suit claiming ownership, arguing that it had acquired several properties in Delhi between 1911 and 1915, when the city was being built, including the graveyard.

However, in 1985, a district court ruled that the Centre had failed to establish ownership of the land after not completing the procedure following its acquisition. According to the petitioner-society, the district judge's finding was never challenged.

The society, represented by advocate Wajeeh Shafiq, sought that the MoHUA and the deputy land and development officer under it be restrained from forcibly taking over possession of the graveyard and from claiming to be its owner.

The management of the graveyard has also instituted a suit seeking execution of the 2018 court order for the eviction of the four persons deemed encroachers on a portion of the land. That matter remains pending.

According to the petitioner, the graveyard has been historically used by and for members of the Punjabi community of Muslims "since several centuries".

The community, a merchant class among Muslims, largely originated in the Punjab region of pre-Partition India. Its members were concentrated in Delhi around the property until the 19th century, before settling in different parts of Delhi and beyond after 1857.

City's first transit-oriented project in East Delhi in final stages of completion, says LG Sandhu

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 10

THE EAST Delhi Hub, the Capital's first transit-oriented development (TOD) project, is in the final stage of completion, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu said on Tuesday after reviewing its progress at Karkardooma. He directed the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and executing agency National Buildings Construction Corporation (NBCC) to expedite pending statutory clearances and ensure timely handover.

Sandhu reviewed work at the residential towers and took stock of the work yet to be completed before the project can be handed over. Accompanied by MLA OP Sharma and senior officials, he also inspected the civic amenities and green spaces being developed under the project.

"East Delhi shall be a benchmark in sustainable, compact urban living. Delivery must match the vision," the LG said.

Spread across approximately 30 hectares, the East Delhi Hub is being developed as an integrated urban centre combining residential, commercial and civic spaces.

Under Phase I, the DDA launched its premium housing scheme, DDA Towering Heights, comprising 1,026 two-bedroom apartments. Its tallest residential tower has 48 storeys and stands approximately 155 metres tall, making it the tallest residential building in Delhi.

The project is located adjacent to the Karkardooma Interchange Metro station, providing direct connectivity to the Blue and Pink lines. It is also connected to NH-9 and NH-24 and is close to Anand Vihar Railway Station and ISBT.

The development includes a central green area spread over around 20,000 square metres, with a jogging track, children's play area, open-air gym, cricket field and badminton courts.

TOD is an urban development strategy that aims to create the maximum number of houses, shops, offices and recreational spaces possible near public transport facilities. The main objectives are to minimise personal vehicle usage, shorten commutes, reduce transport costs, and reduce exposure to harmful pollutants.

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11TH NOVEMBER
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- Can be made by the policy-holder himself/herself or by his/her legal heir or assignees or nominees as recorded in policy.
- Must be related to the grievance that has been rejected entirely or partially by the insurance company.
- Must be made within one year from the date of rejection by the insurance company.
- Cannot be on a matter that is or has been under litigation in any other forum.

*Conditions apply

For more information, please visit www.cioins.co.in
Office of Insurance Ombudsman / Council for Insurance Ombudsmen does not involve directly or through any representative in selling any insurance policy nor does it announce any bonus for insurance policies, nor does it make any kind of payment. Beware of fraudsters impersonating as employees of Bima Lokpal / CIO / ECOI / GBIC.

E-mail ids of 18 offices of Insurance Ombudsman are as follows:-

Ahmedabad: oio.ahmedabad@cioins.co.in
Bengaluru: oio.bengaluru@cioins.co.in
Bhopal: oio.bhopal@cioins.co.in
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FOUR ARRESTED, FURTHER PROBE ON

Interstate racket busted: 21K tablets of anxiety drug, painkiller seized

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 10

A TOTAL of 21,180 tablets and capsules of Alprazolam, a popular drug used to treat anxiety, and Tramadol, a painkiller, were recovered as the Delhi Police's Crime Branch busted an alleged interstate network involved in the illegal supply of psychotropic pharmaceutical drugs, officers said Tuesday. Four persons have been arrested, police added.

The arrests followed targeted interceptions and raids at multiple locations across the Capital, said officers. A motorcycle and a scooter allegedly used to transport the contraband was also seized, they said.

A case was registered under sections 22(C), 25 and 29 of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act on November 1, following an initial seizure near Nigambodh Ghat on October 31.

DCP (Crime Branch) Chandra Kumar Singh said, "The operation has led to the arrest of four key operatives and the recovery of over 21,000 tablets and capsules of Alprazolam and Tramadol. Further investigation is underway..."

The arrested accused were identified as Munesh Kumar Gupta (44), Akhilesh Mishra (46), Virender Kumar alias Hero (48), and Rajeshwer Pandey alias Gopal (34), police said.

According to police, Gupta and Mishra were intercepted near Nigambodh Ghat while allegedly transporting two cartons containing pharmaceutical preparations. A total of 16,380 Alprazolam and Tramadol tablets and capsules, weighing around 10.626 kg, were recovered from their possession.

During questioning, the two allegedly disclosed that they had been procuring the controlled medicines through Virender. Acting on this information, the Crime Branch team raided a location in West Delhi's Madipur and apprehended Virender, who was allegedly carrying another 4,320 Tramadol capsules, weighing approximately 3.240 kg, police said.

Further investigation led police to Rajeshwer Pandey alias Gopal, who was arrested as another alleged link in the procurement and distribution chain. A joint search conducted by the Crime Branch and the government's Drugs Control Department at his shop in Madipur Village resulted in the recovery of 480 Tramadol capsules, weighing around 360 grams.

HARERA

PUBLIC NOTICE
FOR INVITING OBJECTIONS REGARDING APPLICATION FOR AMENDMENT OF REGISTRATION OF THE PROJECT NAMELY "SS CAMASA"
LOCATED AT SECTOR 90, GURUGRAM BEING DEVELOPED BY M/S SS GROUP PVT. LTD.

It is for the information of allottees of the Project namely **"SS Camasa"** being developed by the promoter **M/s North Star Towers Pvt. Ltd.** situated in Sector 90, Gurugram and Project namely **"SS Whitewater"** being developed by M/s **SS Group Pvt. Ltd.** situated in Sector 90, Gurugram

The license no. 265 of 2023 dated 19.12.2023 valid till 18.12.2028 was issued in favour of M/s Matrix Buildwell Pvt. Ltd. & M/s North Star Towers Pvt. Ltd. in collaboration with M/s North Star Towers Pvt. Ltd. for the development of Group housing colony over an area admeasuring 6.4166 acres situated in Sector 90, Gurugram.

The Phasing plan has been approved vide no. ZP-1940/PA(DK)/2024/21785 dated 17.07.2024 by DTCP, Haryana. The Phase 1 of the project having an area admeasuring 5.0456 acres was earlier registered on 04.11.2024 with the name **"SS Camasa"** with the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram vide Registration No. 108 of 2024 dated 04.11.2024 in the name of M/s North Star Towers Pvt. Ltd.

The promoter has obtained an additional license vide no. 35 of 2026 dated 20.02.2026 (after migration from license no. 119 of 2023 which is already registered with the Authority vide RC no. 08 of 2024 dated 07.02.2024) for an area admeasuring 3.99 acres. The total area of the colony becomes 10.4066 acres.

It is informed that now the Director, Town and Country Planning Department has approved the revised building plans vide memo No. ZP-1940/JD(RA)/2026/31644 dated 02.09.2026 and revised phasing plan vide memo no. ZP-1940/SD(RD)/2026/12482 dated 15.04.2026 in the already registered project.

Further, the Change of Developer has also been obtained on 29.10.2025 from Director, Town and Country Planning Department in favour of M/s SS Group Pvt. Ltd. w.r.t the license no. 265 of 2023 dated 19.12.2023. Now, the promoter i.e., **M/s SS Group Pvt. Ltd.** has applied vide application dated 25.09.2026 for the amendment of registration of the Group housing colony registered vide registration no. 108 of 2024 dated 04.11.2024.

As per the provisions of Section 14(2)(ii) of the Real Estate Development and Regulation) Act, 2016 any alteration or addition in the sanctioned plan of the project requires written consent of at least two third of the allottees. As per the promoter, there are total 238 sold units out of which there are 235 unique allottees. The promoter has submitted written consent of 168 unique allottees out of total 235 unique allottees regarding revision in building plans which is more than two third of the existing allottees.

The relevant revised building plans, sanctions, consents and documents of application are available in the office of the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram which can be seen by any concerned on any working day during office hours i.e. 10.00 AM to 4.00 PM upto 26.11.2026 for filing of objections, if any and may also appear before the authority in person on 30.11.2026 at 11:00 am for hearing.

Given under the approval of the Authority and its seal.

Secretary,
Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

Dated: 11.11.2026

CM distributes LPG aid to 15L beneficiaries

New Delhi: The Delhi government on Tuesday transferred a total of Rs 141.88 crore to the bank accounts of 15.45 lakh ration card holders as financial assistance under the Delhi Free LPG Cylinder Scheme.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said, "Supporting families financially during festivals is the government's commitment. Ensuring that the benefits of welfare schemes reach people directly remains our priority.

The government had announced that an amount equivalent to the cost of an LPG cylinder would be given to eligible beneficiaries through Direct Benefit Transfer every year on the occasions of Holi and Diwali.

Officials said 1,24,964 families covered under Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana were given Rs 642 each, while 14,21,030 families outside the scheme got Rs 942 each. ENS

University College of Medical Science (University of Delhi) & Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital, Delhi - 110095
Tel: 22582972-4, Extn 1405; Fax: 0091-11-22590495
MULTI-DISCIPLINARY RESEARCH UNIT

UCMS/MRU/2026-27/406 9/11/2026

VACANCY NOTICE

Applications are invited for the recruitment of Research Scientist-II (Scientist 'C'; Medical/Non-Medical, one post), Research Scientist-I (Scientist 'B'; Medical/Non-Medical, one post), Laboratory Technician (two posts) and Lab Assistant/ Data Entry Operator (one post) under Multi-disciplinary Research Unit (MRU) for the period of 1 year initially and extendable based on the continuation of the project and the candidate's performance upto 5 years. Essential qualifications and other necessary information for the above mentioned posts are available on college website, www.ucms.ac.in under the career option.

Interested candidates may send their application along with relevant documents on the email nodalofficermru@gmail.com. Last date of submission of application is 01/12/2026, up to 4 PM.

Nodal Officer-MRU

University College of Medical Science (University of Delhi) & Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital, Delhi - 110095
Tel: 22582972-4, Extn 1405; Fax: 0091-11-22590495
MULTI-DISCIPLINARY RESEARCH UNIT

UCMS/MRU/2026-27/405 9/11/2026

VACANCY NOTICE

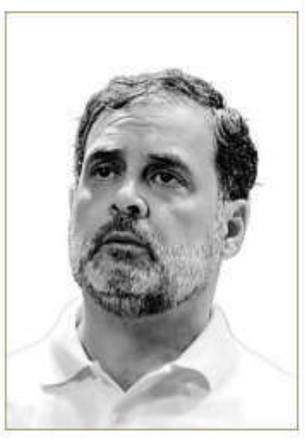
Applications are invited for the recruitment of Project Research Scientist-II (Non Medical; one post), Project Research Scientist-I (Non Medical; one post), Project Technical Support-III (two posts), Project Technical Support-II (two posts) and Project Technical Support-I (two posts) under CoRE Project of Multi-disciplinary Research Unit (MRU) for the period of 1 year initially and extendable based on the continuation of the project and the candidate's performance upto 5 years. Essential qualifications and other necessary information for the above mentioned posts are available on college website, www.ucms.ac.in under the career option.

Interested candidates may send their application along with relevant documents on the email nodalofficermru@gmail.com. Last date of submission of application is 01/12/2026, up to 4 PM.

Nodal Officer-MRU



DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



Much-awaited Reshuffle

THERE IS growing curiosity among Congress leaders over the proposed reshuffling of AICC secretaries. Senior leaders of the party, including Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, have already 'interviewed' around 200 probable candidates for the key posts over the past few weeks. Those eyeing the posts have been enquiring from senior party leaders about the official announcement on the reshuffle. Sources say the announcement can come any time over the next few days.

Clearing the Court Air

AT A time when Delhi grapples with severe levels of air pollution, the process for servicing and maintenance of air purifiers installed at the Supreme Court has started. On Tuesday, the CPWD floated a tender with an estimated cost of Rs 7.86 lakh for the overhauling of 50 air purifiers in the main building and replacing the filters of 30 others in the complex. The CPWD has given potential bidders 60 days to complete the work.

'My Rajiv was dead. He was gone... I didn't want to live without him'

In her memoir, '*Belonging: A Journey of Love*', Congress leader Sonia Gandhi shares some of the most private chapters of her life. A look at some of them:



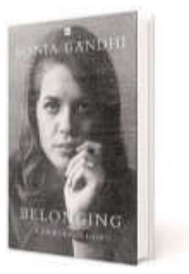
A photograph by Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, from the author's private collection. Sonia Gandhi's memoir, *Belonging: A Journey of Love*, hit the stands on Tuesday.

On Rajiv Gandhi's assassination

Sonia Gandhi has narrated how her daughter, Priyanka, informed her about the suicide blast at Sriperumbudur that killed Rajiv Gandhi.

She quotes Priyanka as saying: "I just got a call. There's been a bomb explosion. They are saying that twelve people around Papa are dead, but he is okay. It can't be possible. If twelve people have died, he must be injured, he must be in hospital. We'll have to go to Madras, Mama. Start getting dressed."

"...I couldn't breathe. I stood up, she stepped forward and held me in her arms. I could feel her heart thumping wildly against my chest," she writes.



Priyanka then says, "I'm going to the office to check. Mr. George said he would find out, but he hasn't called back, and he isn't picking up the phone." Vincent George was Rajiv Gandhi's personal secretary who later worked with Sonia Gandhi too.

Priyanka returned a while later. She announced "Papa is dead". "I looked into her eyes, desperately hoping this was a nightmare from which I would awake. She looked back at me, her gaze piercing mine, mirroring my horror," Gandhi writes.

"I crumpled in my daughter's arms. 'I should have gone with him,' I cried out, again and again. 'Why didn't I go with him?' She said nothing. Disbelieving, clinging to hope, I dialled Mr. George myself. 'Just tell me, is it true?' His voice faltered. 'Yes — it is true, Sahab is no more.' I felt as if my world had gone dark, and that darkness had swallowed me whole," she writes. "...My Rajiv was dead. He was gone. I would never see his beautiful face again, I would never feel him holding me, I would never again know the safety of his embrace. I wanted to die. I didn't want to live without him."

The Bofors scandal

Gandhi writes about the Bofors scandal, one of the biggest challenges her husband faced as Prime Minister. According to her, "Rajiv had declared that no agents would be, or were, involved in the arms purchases, but after a protracted series of disclosures, enquiries, accusations, and denials, it was established that indeed there had been agents — opening the door to allegations of corruption."

An Opposition campaign was "supported by a corporate house and some within the Congress party", she writes. "It took no time for Rajiv to be targeted as the culprit. He was accused of being a recipient of bribes from the Bofors firm."

"In an ongoing trial by media, a barrage of charges was hurled at Rajiv by those determined to bring him down... We were all deeply affected by the onslaught; even the children were hurt and indignant."

On Maneka Gandhi

Gandhi writes about "differences" between her brother-in-law Sanjay and Maneka. "When annoyed, she would use expletives, even in the presence of my mother-in-law, that were taboo in the home; they embarrassed him and shocked us," she writes. She also writes about Maneka drifting away from the family after Sanjay died in a plane crash. Indira Gandhi felt that at 23, Maneka was "still too young and immature to be given a leadership role".

"My mother-in-law was disturbed by Maneka's rush to secure a political position... When baby Feroze's first birthday drew close in March 1981, my mother-in-law suggested a small get-together with some of Maneka's friends and their children, but she was rebuffed. She learnt later that a birthday party for her grandchild had indeed taken place — but in the house of Vasundhara Raje, the daughter of the dowager Rajmata of Gwalior, a staunch supporter of the RSS and a political opponent of Mrs. Gandhi. It was clearly intended to wound her," Gandhi writes.

On 1984 riots

About the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, Gandhi writes that she is certain that Rajiv himself "could not in any way have authorised those heinous acts on innocent men, women and children". "In retrospect, it's evident that the system had undergone a time of cataclysmic upheaval in which the structure of government had come under strain — perhaps even broken down," she writes. "The riots of 1984 remain a tragic and shameful chapter in the history of our nation."

On losing first born

Gandhi writes that she gave birth to a boy on January 18, 1969 but the joy was short-lived for the family. It was a normal delivery, she writes. "Later Rajiv took me to see him, a tiny, perfectly formed boy, with thick, black hair and long, slim fingers... We fell in love with him immediately, but Rajiv had been told already that there were doubts about his survival. With Amie Aunty beside him, he broke it gently to me when at 6:30 in the morning the end came."

"I cried my heart out, and Rajiv, in spite of his 'stiff upper lip' upbringing, also wept copiously," she writes.

On battling cancer

Gandhi, who has never spoken earlier about her medical condition, shares that a year after surgery for breast cancer in 2010, another growth was detected in her pancreas during a follow-up test. When the malignancy was first detected in 2010, she writes that although she had confidence in the doctors in India, she opted for treatment abroad because of the media frenzy it would create here. "I felt shaken and worried, there was no time to lose, my children and I were told, and my mind began to race to a possible scary outcome... I wasn't keen to be at the centre of a media frenzy that would have inevitably accompanied a surgery in Delhi... "

After the surgery at the European Institute of Oncology in Milan, Gandhi recalls how the surgeon informed her that everything had gone on well and there were no residues. A year later, during routine follow-up tests, a growth was detected in the pancreas. "This came as a shock to me and the children.... Following many consultations, my doctors felt I needed immediate surgery..." This time, she went to Erasmus University Medical Centre in Rotterdam, where she was treated by well-known pancreatic surgeon Dr Casper van Fijck.

Retired officials rehired also come under model code: EC

Goa, Manipur, UP, Uttarakhand and Punjab will go to polls next year

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 10

THE ELECTION Commission of India (ECI) on Monday directed authorities in five election-bound states that restrictions under the model code of conduct (MCC) that apply to government officials should extend to retired officials re-employed or engaged by state governments.

Writing to the chief secretaries and chief electoral officers of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, and Uttarakhand, where Assembly elections are expected early in 2027, the ECI said it previously issued instructions that government employees must not participate in election campaigns or support any individual or party during elections.

"The provisions of the Model Code of Conduct apply to all organisations/committees, corporations/commissions, etc. funded wholly or partially by the Government, and their employees. Further, the relevant Conduct Rules, in the States, prohibit the Government servants from taking part in political activities and elections," the ECI said.

The ECI said that the same restrictions should extend to retired government employees engaged or re-employed in various capacities by the states, noting that there were "no specific guidelines or rules relating to their political neutrality and conduct during MCC period".

"The Commission hereby directs that restrictions and prohibitions applicable to Government Servants shall similarly apply to the aforesaid category of individuals during MCC period. Further, they shall not summon any election-related officer of the constituency or district where elections have been announced for any official discussions/meetings or hold video conferences/meetings with any such officer. Any omission or commission of any act in contravention of Commission's directions shall be viewed seriously," the ECI said.

The ECI's directions come at a time when preparations for the Assembly polls are underway. Ahead of the election announcement, the three-member Commission also usually visits the states. Teams of senior EC officials have been visiting the states.

Suvendu slams Left but praises Buddhadeb: 'He was a very honest man'

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, November 10



West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari

EVEN AS he reiterated his promise to reopen cases against the Left Front leaders in connection with the 2007 Nandigram land agitation, West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Tuesday praised Buddhadeb Bhattacharjee, the then chief minister, calling him "a very honest man".

Addressing an event at Gokulnagar in Nandigram in Purba Medinipur district to mark the 19th anniversary of police firing that left 11 people dead, the BJP chief minister said, "After November 10, 2007, there was a bloody sunrise. I pay my respects... I will not name him. He has passed away — the then chief minister. Standing at the Writers' Building, he had said, 'They have been paid back in their own coin'. However, the late chief minister was a very honest man in his personal life. The party was bad."

Adhikari also praised veteran CPI(M) leader Biman Bose. "Bimanbabu is still alive; he is in his eighties. Paying him respect as well. He had said, 'A new sun has risen in Nandigram'. Today is November 10. Nineteen years have passed. Even that day, I remained steadfast in my resolve, and I still am today. I am standing firm. And those who tried to stop me are no more," he said.

Claiming that the CID investigation into the Nandigram firing incident failed to culminate in a complete judicial process, leaving those responsible unpunished, Adhikari promised again to reopen the cases. "I have said that fresh FIRs will be filed and cases reopened against those responsible," he said, naming CPI(M) leaders Abhay Ghosh of Goghat, Manoranjan Patra of Taldangra, Tapan Ghosh of Garbeta and Himanshu Das of Khejuri, among others.

"They had come from outside, dressed in black, in an organised manner. Action will be taken according to the law."

Keralam minister walks away as Vande Mataram is sung in full

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, November 10

THE VANDE Mataram controversy continues to haunt the Congress government in Keralam, where the party's official stand is to sing the first two stanzas in all state government functions. However, the song was sung in full at an official function attended by senior Congress leader and Health Minister K Muraleedharan in Kasaragod on Monday, prompting him to return to his seat midway.

The minister was attending the inauguration of a laboratory at a family health centre at Mulleria, Kasaragod, held by the health department.

The confusion was evident as Kasaragod MP Rajmohan Unnithan, MLA Kallatra Mahin and district collector Sreedhanya Suresh also returned to their seats before the rendition was over. On Tuesday, BJP district president M L Ashwini said, "This is a serious violation of the protocol. They have insulted the national song. We will... initiate legal action against officials who insulted the national song."

Muraleedharan said the state government can't allow the Centre's protocol in functions it conducts. "Don't teach me patriotism... We will not allow the BJP agenda to be implemented in state-run functions."

In first polls since creation of 6 new districts, Ladakh to elect hill councils on December 4

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, November 10

FRESH ELECTIONS to the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDCs) will take place on December 4.

For the first time, eight elected hill councils will take shape in Ladakh with the addition of six new districts to the union territory this year. A total of 1.87 lakh electors will cast their vote to pick 100 councillors who will form the next LAHDCs.

Ladakh Chief Secretary Ashish Kundra made the announcement in Leh on Tuesday. He said the delimitation of these new constituencies is complete, and the nomination process is set to begin this week. It will close on November 17.

Terming this a watershed moment for democracy in Ladakh, he said, "This is a crucial inflexion in the larger tourney of democracy and the demands which have been raised and people should participate. They must demonstrate that they are for democracy and this is their desire."

Meanwhile, the Kargil region of Ladakh observed a complete shutdown on Tuesday over the conduct of these polls. On Monday, the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) raised concerns about holding LAHDC polls in Ladakh's harsh winter weather. Ladakh MP Mohmad Haneefa Jan also raised this with Lieutenant Governor V K Saxena, in a letter sent to his office.

However, Kundra argued that schools in Ladakh remain open until around December 10, and weather conditions may remain favourable for voting. Kudra also dismissed allegations that since two LAHDCs are now being replaced with eight, the new elected bodies will be "disempowered" in any way.

Previously, concerns were raised over dilution of powers of the new bodies in smaller districts. "The powers of LAHDCs are enshrined in the LAHDC Act, and they will continue to exercise those functions," he said.

Panchayat and Urban Local Body Polls for Ladakh will take place on November 21. As per the gazette notification for LAHDC polls, the process is to be completed by December 8, but the official date for results is yet to be announced.

With regard to calls for a boycott of polls from some social and religious bodies, Kundra said, "On one hand they argue that there is bureaucratic rule and then they say they will not participate in elections... I can only appeal to the leaders of Kargil and Leh to participate in the elections and demonstrate to the central government that yes, we want democracy and we want to strengthen democratic institutions, and that is how we will build a body that will take shape at the Apex level in Ladakh."

Regarding the preparations for the elections, he said that Deputy Commissioners have been instructed to provide heating systems in voting booths on December 4.

● THOUGH BJD ROUTED IN POLLS OVER 2 YEARS AGO, BJP FOUND IT DIFFICULT TO SHRUG OFF ITS FORMER ALLY THAT, DESPITE ITS PROBLEMS, HAS BOTH THE CADRE AND GROUND SUPPORT TO KEEP FIGHTING

After sweeping Odisha in 2024, why BJP has failed to build on its momentum

CAPITAL CONTEXT
BY LIZ MATHEW

A WEEKLY LOOK AT POLITICS IN A STATE FROM THE VANTAGE POINT OF NEW DELHI

AS THE BJP took a hit in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections in states where it was expected to perform well, such as Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra, Odisha stepped up to save the party by delivering 20 vital parliamentary seats that pushed its overall tally to 240. That regional wave provided Prime Minister Narendra Modi with the required leverage to secure a historic third consecutive term, anchoring a coalition government alongside regional allies such as the TDP and JD(U).

Now, over two years down the line, the BJP that also formed the government for the first time in 2024 is struggling to sustain the post-election momentum. BJP insiders say that the Naveen Patnaik-led Biju Janata Dal (BJD), the main Opposition party and former ally, continues to hold significant ground presence and vote share despite its electoral rout. In the Assembly election, the BJD was marginally ahead with a 40.22% vote share while the BJP managed to get 40.07% of the votes.

In recent months, the BJD has targeted the BJP-led Central government over the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026, or the MMDR Amendment Act, arguing that it strips the state of crucial financial and constitutional rights and is anti-federal in nature. The BJD has also added its voice to the Opposition's chorus against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

"Prime Minister Modi began his post-2024 Lok Sabha election victory speech at the BJP national headquarters chanting 'Jai Jagannath' thrice instead of his usual 'Jai Shri Ram'. It was seen as his appreciation for what Odisha contributed to his return to power. People in Odisha expected a lot from the PM, but what it got is MMDR," said former Lok Sabha MP Tathagata Satpathy.

BJP insiders said some senior party leaders in the state were "unhappy" with the state government's inability to keep up the momentum in the perception battle. BJP parliamentarians Pradeep Kumar Panigrahy (Berhampur MP), Sangeeta Singh Deo (Bolangir MP), and Balabhadra Majhi (Nabarangpur MP) have recently complained, in separate letters, to the state government about the slow pace and the poor quality of infrastructure construction in their constituencies.

"Another point of discontent was triggered when Nitin Nabin revamped the national team. The state was completely sidelined. No new face from Odisha was inducted in the national team, though the state has a prominent role to play in the 2029 elections," said a BJP leader. Both Baijayant 'Jay' Panda and Sambit Patra were in the previous team as national vice-president and North East Coordinator, respectively.



Odisha CM Mohan Charan Majhi addresses the grievances of people, at Circuit House in Keonjhar last week. X/@MOHANMODISHA

Some BJP leaders said Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi has a clean image but has not done enough to wield power, because the "ecosystem remains the same" as under the Naveen Patnaik government. "The cadre still feel we are left out and the BJD leaders still call the shots at the ground level," said a young BJP leader from Odisha. "Control over development projects at the block levels is an important source of influence for those working on the ground. However, ground-level contracts remain the BJD's forte."

However, a senior party MP from the state came to the CM's defence, saying "transition" takes time. " After 24 years (of Naveen Patnaik -led BJD in power), one cannot change things overnight. If we change things rapidly, we will be accused of being dictatorial or undemocratic. We have to do it officially and properly. When it comes to contracts, the BJD networking at the ground knows the tricks, while our karyakartas do not even apply for many. Also, regional party-ruled states have a way to do things too," he said.

The CM's defenders in the party said internal divisions — mainly due to the one-upmanship some senior leaders engage in — often slow down the CM. However, others pin the blame on him.

"The Chief Minister has not been able to appoint a regular DGP yet. This is a perfect example to show how incompetent the government is," said a source. Majhi has also not expanded his Council of Ministers since taking power. The state currently has 16 ministers, including the CM, and can induct six more.

BJD's hurdles

The BJD has ground cadre and support, but its leadership crisis is far from over. Once a strong BJP ally — they shared power in a coalition for nine years — the Naveen Patnaik-led party initially maintained equidistance from the BJP and the Congress after losing power, but there has been a shift in recent months.

After it backed the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) July protests on the NEET exam paper leak issue, the BJP branded it "an ally of anarchists". Two of its Rajya Sabha MPs, Manas Mangaraj and Sulata Deo, have joined Opposition protests calling for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Like the INDIA bloc, the BJD has also alleged "vote theft" through SIR. However, the party has made it clear it does not want to be seen as part of the INDIA bloc either.

With the formal entry into the party of former IAS officer Sujata Rout Karthikeyan, the BJD's second-rung leadership and sections of the cadre are struggling to readjust themselves to the new internal dynamics. Karthikeyan is married to Patnaik's close aide V K Pandian, whose role in the party came under fire in the 2024 elections.

Some BJD leaders pointed out that Patnaik has reiterated that he would remain the party's face in the next elections. Unlike Pandian, who was labelled an outsider and is seen as a political liability in the party, Karthikeyan, who hails from Kendrapara, is viewed by many as Patnaik's potential successor in the long run.

Rashtrapati Bhavan security man critical after being shot at during Diwali

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, November 10

A 26-YEAR-OLD man, who was deputed with the Rashtrapati Bhavan security, was seriously injured after he was shot in the head during a dispute over bursting firecrackers in Uttar Pradesh's Baghpat on Diwali night, police said.

Saurabh Tomar had come home to celebrate Diwali with his family, who live in Gopalpur Khadana. Police said they received information about the firing around 10 pm on Sunday. During the preliminary inquiry, police learnt that Saurabh was bursting firecrackers on the road along with his family when two neighbours, brothers Dheeraj and Monu, objected to it and got into an argument with Saurabh's brother, Vineet, 28.

Police said the disagreement soon escalated into violence as Dheeraj allegedly pulled out a country-made pistol and opened fire. The bullet first struck a wall before hitting Saurabh in the head.

The accused also allegedly assaulted Vineet and threatened the family with dire consequences before fleeing. Family members rushed Saurabh to a hospital, where doctors performed surgery and removed the bullet. His condition is now reported to be stable.

Police registered an FIR against Dheeraj and Monu on charges of attempt to murder. Circle Officer Anshu Jain said, "Efforts are underway to trace and arrest the accused."

CRPF plans to procure kamikaze UAVs with 15-km strike capability

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 10

THE CENTRAL Reserve Police Force (CRPF) is planning to acquire kamikaze unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) that are capable of striking targets up to 15 km away while livestreaming video of the ground beneath.

The Directorate General of CRPF has circulated draft qualitative requirements and trial directives for what it calls OFC+RF-based FPV kamikaze drones — first-person-view UAVs — that fly to a designated objective carrying a high-explosive warhead, transmit surveillance imagery back to the operator, and then destroy themselves on impact.

The draft, issued on November 5, has been sent to original equipment manufacturers and vendors for information by November 25.

The CRPF said the drone must be small and light — not more than 7 kg — with capability to land vertically within a 5X5 metre box. "It must fly at 150 kmph or more with full payload, operate in winds of 35 km/h or more during take-off, flight and landing, and stay airborne for a minimum of 30 minutes at 1,000 m AMSL [above mean sea level] without the warhead and spool, or 20 minutes with them, with endurance falling by a tenth for every additional 1,000 m of altitude," the note said.

Strong bipartisan support in US for India ties: MEA on midterms

Rejects lawsuit by Khalistan terrorist Pannun, calls his charges fabricated and malicious

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, November 10



MEA Spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal addresses a press conference, in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

IN THE first response on the US midterm elections in which Democrats won both Houses of the US Congress, defeating US President Donald Trump's Republican Party, India said on Tuesday that it is an "internal matter" of the US but underlined that the India-US bilateral ties enjoy "strong bipartisan support" across the political aisle.

External Affairs Ministry's official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal, while responding to questions, said: "The midterm elections are an internal matter of the US. I have no specific comment on them, beyond underlining that the India-United States relationship enjoys strong bipartisan support in the US. We continue to work to further strengthen our Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership with the US."

Two years into the US Presidential term, Trump has suffered the biggest rebuke as the Republican Party was defeated in the Senate as well as the House of Representatives.

Widely billed as a referendum on Trump's second term as President, the US midterms have dealt a striking blow to his actions that impacted the US and the world, including India.

The India-US ties have gone through ups and downs over tariffs, trade, visa restrictions, deportations, and US close ties with Pakistan's military in the last two years.

The regular comments by the United States Commission on International Religious Freedom (USCIRF), and the US federal government commission that monitors religious freedom conditions worldwide, have also added to Delhi's worries.

Responding to the latest USCIRF comments, Jaiswal said, "As I have said before, the USCIRF is a biased and ill-informed organisation with a blatantly political agenda. It is particularly telling that the USCIRF and its Commissioners have consistently chosen to remain silent on attacks on religious places in the US and on the hate crimes and racial abuse targeted at the Indian community in the US. A prejudiced entity can hardly be taken seriously."

In a post on X last week, the USCRIF had quoted one of its Commissioners, David Anderson, as saying: "Over the last several weeks, Sikh gurdwaras in India have been targeted with vigilante attacks, including attempts to harm religious leaders. The USG should link security assistance to the Indian government's response to violence that stops people from exercising FoRB [Freedom of Religion or Belief]."

It also quoted another one of its Commissioners, Joe Grogan, as saying: "Attacks on houses of worship in India, including churches, gurdwaras, and mosques, undermine FoRB rights enshrined in international law. The USG should continue to press the Indian government to hold perpetrators of such violence accountable & protect places of worship."

With ties between India and the US going through a rough patch, Delhi has hired lobbyists to maintain communication channels open.

The Indian Express reported on November 7 that US Foreign Agents Registration Act (FARA) filings revealed that lobbying firm SHW Partners LLC facilitated eight phone calls between Indian officials and senior White House figures in May and June 2026.

The MEA spokesperson, when asked about the FARA filings, said, "It is a normal practice in the US for diplomatic missions to engage lobby firms to facilitate outreach and engagement with the US Administration, members of the Congress, and other relevant stakeholders. Incidentally, past filing records give ample examples of lobbyists facilitating contacts with US Administration leaders and personnel. So there should be no confusion on this account."

"Such engagements are undertaken in accordance with the applicable US laws, including the Foreign Agents Registration Act (FARA), under which the activities of these firms are publicly disclosed. India has been engaging lobby firms in Washington DC since 1948," he said.

The MEA spokesperson also rejected the lawsuit filed by Khalistani terrorist Gurpatwant Singh Pannun against Indian officials in the United States, after a US federal court allowed him to pursue the service of summons on National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and former Research and Analysis Wing (R&AW) chief Samant Goel through Indian courts.

Responding to the development, the MEA spokesperson said, "We reject the fabricated and malicious attacks on our high officials. Also, we reject the frivolous lawsuits. A request for the service of judicial documents in India can only be routed through India's designated central authority, which is the Ministry of Law and Justice."

The development relates to an order by the US District Court for the Southern District of New York in the civil lawsuit filed by Pannun.

Three workers die at Tata's Hosur plant for iPhones, inquiry on

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, November 10

THREE CONTRACT workers died on Monday evening while servicing a wastewater treatment tank at a Tata Electronics factory near Hosur, Tamil Nadu, that makes casings and other components for Apple's iPhones.

Officials in Krishnagiri district said they suspected the workers had inhaled toxic gas. The police said the cause of death would be determined after their autopsies.

The plant, in Vanniyapuram near Uddanapalli, performs one of the more demanding jobs in Apple's effort to make more of its phones outside China. Its products include back panels and precision-machined metal casings.

On premium smartphones, the casing serves as the frame on which other components are mounted, and its manufacture requires specialised tooling and surface finishing. A separate Tata plant in the same compound assembles finished iPhones. India now makes about a quarter of the world's iPhones, according to *Reuters*.

According to the office of the Krishnagiri district collector, the three men were part of a four-person maintenance crew. B Akmal was the first to collapse after trying to look inside the filtration tank.

M Sarathikumar went to check on him and also collapsed. P Kaveri then went in after the two men. The fourth worker called for help. All three were pulled out and taken to a private hospital in Hosur, where they were pronounced dead.

A top official attached to the Directorate of Industrial Safety and Health told *The Indian Express* that the crew lacked proper safety measures for the work.

"A unit of the American company Ecolab, Nalco Water, operated the treatment plant and had engaged another company through a subcontract that employed the men. The bodies were taken to the Government Medical College Hospital in Krishnagiri for post-mortem examinations. We are conducting a detailed inquiry today," the official said.

The district administration opened an inquiry. Apple and Tata have also ordered investigations. The factory was already closed for Diwali when the accident happened.

A fire in a chemical storage area in September 2024 had halted component production at the Hosur site. At the time, the plant was the only Indian supplier of iPhone back panels to both Foxconn and Tata's own assembly operations.

This year, the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB), the pollution regulator, had intervened over allegations that wastewater had contaminated nearby farm wells. Tata said it had addressed the regulator's questions and that the board had dropped further action.

Spotlight on some TVK MLAs, CM Vijay calls a meeting today

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, November 10



The government led by Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay completed six months in office on Tuesday. ANI

AT A time when the public behaviour of some of his TVK MLAs is under scrutiny, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay has summoned his party legislators to Chennai for an emergency consultative meeting Wednesday. The high-level meeting chaired by Vijay is scheduled to take place at the TVK headquarters in Panaiyur in Chennai.

The Vijay government completed six months in office on Tuesday, but questions remain about the actions of a few TVK MLAs that could push the party into a corner. MLA C Arul Vignesh has denied allegations that he had sent a district Collector an obscene message and harassed her. While Congress MP Jothimani claimed the Collector had filed a formal complaint, it has yet to be officially confirmed.

In Thuraiyur, the complaint began with a shortage of drinking water and a pile of uncollected garbage. Karthik Kumar, a resident who took those grievances to MLA M Ravishankar, said the legislator slapped and kicked him. Ravishankar is the deputy speaker of the Tamil Nadu Assembly.

History repeating?

Vijay promised a different standard of government. Six months on, his TVK is facing an accusation familiar from the years of DMK and AIADMK rule, when ruling-party legislators were accused of throwing their weight around and relying on the administration to manage the fallout. Party sources say TVK is preparing an internal inquiry into both cases. So far, it has announced no disciplinary action against either MLA.

For Vijay, who runs a minority government, the most consequential step under discussion would also expose the limits of his authority. Party sources say the leadership is considering asking Ravishankar to give up the deputy speaker's post. If he refuses, removing him would take a resolution under Article 179(c) of the Constitution, with 14 days' notice and the support of a majority of all the members of the Assembly. TVK would need votes beyond its own ranks to remove one of its own.

The video from Thuraiyur is dark enough that the faces are hard to make out. "Which village are you from?" one man asks as he repeatedly slaps another. The man being hit keeps saying he voted for Vijay. Kumar says he was the man being hit and identifies Ravishankar as the man who struck him.

Kumar said his neighbourhood had been short of drinking water for a week. He said his appeals to municipal officials went nowhere and calls to his MLA went unanswered. On Diwali night, he approached Ravishankar at his residence in Manachanallur. Kumar later received treatment at the government hospital there.

In a second recording, sitting beside Ravishankar, Kumar denied being assaulted and said social media had misrepresented a commotion. In a third, he said Ravishankar and a police inspector, whom he identified as Kirubanithi, had forced him to record the denial after threatening him and his family. He said it took about six takes.

Police said they had received no complaint about the alleged assault. Ravishankar issued no statement and could not be reached by phone for comment. School Education Minister A Rajmohan said an investigation would follow if Kumar filed a formal complaint.

• EXPELLED JD(U) LEADER'S LAVISH PLANS FOR DAUGHTER'S WEDDING

On the cards: Two lakh guests, horse races and 150 dishes

Santosh Singh
Patna, November 10

FROM A high-stakes horse race with a Mahindra Thar as the top prize and a sleek white Land Rover Defender for the groom to a guest list of 2 lakh people and over 150 culinary delicacies, the upcoming wedding of expelled Janata Dal (United) leader and Mokama MLA Anant Singh's younger daughter is all set to be a lavish affair. Singh and his wife Neelam Devi, a former MLA from Mokama, were expelled from the JD(U).

Their daughter Shivangi is tying the knot on November 25 with Rishikesh Kumar (alias Ankit) from Bihta. While Singh is a postgraduate, Rishikesh, the son of CRPF Commandant Ranvijay Singh, is an MBA graduate from Georgia State University, Atlanta, and has lived in the US for over a decade.

The CRPF commandant's residence in Bihta's Krishnanagar area has been given a complete makeover for the occasion.

Singh and his wife Neelam Devi were expelled for anti-party activities. The JD(U) has also sought Singh's disqualification as a member of the Bihar Assembly.

The expulsion came amid tensions between Anant Singh and the JD(U), which came to a head when Singh defied party orders to back Jan Suraaj Party candidate Anuj Singh against JD(U) spokesman Neeraj Kumar, his political rival, in the recent MLC polls. Kumar eventually won the race.



Mokama MLA Anant Singh

Despite ongoing legal troubles and political setbacks, the sheer scale of the wedding ceremony at Ladwan village in Mokama has taken centre stage. On October 30, the Supreme Court rejected Anant Singh's plea for an extension of bail in the Dularchand Yadav murder case but extended his bail until December 4 in view of his daughter's marriage.

Speaking to the media, Singh appeared unperturbed by his expulsion from the JD(U), the potential loss of his MLA status or the outcome of the recent MLC polls, instead falling back on his signature refrain: "*Janata maalik hai* (The people are the masters)".

On his legal situation too, Singh said: "My bail plea extension was rejected. It is the process of law".

For some time now, Anant Singh has remained focused entirely on the nuptials, inviting everyone in his phonebook across political lines — including JD(U) chief Nitish Kumar and Rashtriya Janata Dal chief Lalu Prasad. Kumar, however, has reportedly been left out.

According to sources, Singh, known for his love of horses, is organising a horse race on the wedding day. The top prizes for the winners, according to sources, are a Mahindra Thar, a motorcycle and a scooty.

Sources said the celebrations will feature a star-studded lineup of performers, including Udit Narayan, Sonu Sood, Maithili Thakur, Ravi Kishan, Manoj Tiwari and Pawan Singh.

At Ladwan village, supporters are seen erecting modern pandals across 10 bighas of land, with fresh flowers being flown in from China and major cities like Bengaluru to decorate the main stage and wedding mandap.

Meanwhile, a white Land Rover Defender parked at Singh's Patna residence awaits the bridegroom amid growing social media buzz.

• BRIEFLY



CM Samrat Choudhary during the event in Patna on Tuesday. ANI

BIHAR

Patna Municipal Corporation lists Rs 200-cr municipal bond on NSE

BIHAR CHIEF Minister Samrat Choudhary on Tuesday marked listing of the Patna Municipal Corporation's (PMC) Rs 200-crore municipal bond on the National Stock Exchange (NSE). This represents the first-ever municipal bond listing from Bihar on the NSE. It is in line with the state government's push toward economic empowerment, infrastructure modernisation, and innovative revenue generation. The CM said: "Funds secured through the municipal bond must be strictly utilised for projects that generate a continuous, regular stream of revenue." He added the state had been looking towards modernizing urban life with plans to develop 12-greenfield satellite townships named after historical and cultural landmarks. ENS

J&K: 18 tourists injured in road mishap, 8 critical

AT LEAST 18 tourists from Gujarat and West Bengal were injured, some critically, in a road accident on the Srinagar-Sonamarg road. Eight critically injured tourists were shifted to Srinagar's Sher-i-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences (SKIMS) for specialised treatment. Officials said a Tempo Traveller ferrying tourists met with an accident at Sumbal Bala in Ganderbal district, leaving 18 tourists injured. Jammu & Kashmir Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha has directed officials to ensure specialised medical care for the injured. ENS

Kolkata cop suspended over anti-govt posts

A KOLKATA police inspector has been suspended pending an inquiry for allegedly posting derogatory remarks against the West Bengal government and Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on social media. Police Inspector Ekhlaque Ahmed, who used to serve as the officer-in-charge of the Medical College, Kolkata, outpost under the Central Division, was transferred to the 1st Battalion of the Kolkata Armed Police. He was placed under suspension with effect from November 9 after an order issued by city Police Commissioner Ajay Kumar Nand. ENS

Cancer drug prices slashed by up to Rs 6,000 as trade margin caps kick in

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, November 10

Eight medicines saw a change of over Rs 50,000 per unit. This includes the prostate cancer drug manufactured by Astellas Pharma

CANCER DRUG prices dropped by an average of nearly Rs 6,000 after the government's trade margin cap on 137 medications came into effect on Monday.

However, an analysis of the final revised prices from the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) reveals the reduction is not evenly distributed among the medicines. The most expensive patented and single-source drugs have more or less retained their high prices.

Revised prices of 1,366 formulations — doses, package sizes, and brands — submitted by the manufacturers were analysed. No change was found in the prices of 201 of the 1,366 formulations, while prices of another 255 formulations reduced by less than Rs 100. This means, in total, 456 medicines saw only negligible change in their prices.

However, eight medicines saw a change of over Rs 50,000 per unit. This includes the prostate cancer drug enzalutamide, manufactured by Astellas Pharma, whose price dropped by around Rs 2 lakh.

Importantly, the most expensive drugs actually saw the lowest drop in prices.

Only four of the 57 formulations that cost more than Rs 1 lakh per unit recorded a drop in prices. This also translated into no change in prices of the patented and single-source drugs — i.e. drugs marketed by only one manufacturer in India.

As per the data, there were at least 62 formulations of 39 such drugs, the prices for which did not change at all.

This included drugs such as pembrolizumab — a drug that can be used for the treatment of around 18 cancers and features on WHO's list of essential medicines. An *Indian Express* investigation revealed that the drug remained out of reach for most Indians, despite the company's patient assistance programme.

Breast cancer immunotherapy drugs such as ribociclib and abemaciclib, for which patients have filed petitions in court to make them more accessible, did not register any price change as well.

That said, the government move is expected to bring relief to patients on cancer drugs manufactured by several firms.

"The reality is that the MRPs of cancer drugs are unreasonably high, sometimes 100-fold higher than the actual drug cost. The trade margin rationalisation would not affect big pharmacy stores because they sell the products at prices much lower than their inflated MRPs," said the owner of a pharmacy store in central Delhi.

However, they added, "The revised MRP will force all stores, including the one in hospitals, to sell the drugs at lower costs. Once a patient is admitted to the hospital, they are usually asked to get the medicines from pharmacies on the hospital premises, where they are charged MRP prices. The reduced MRP will help such patients," they said.

However, the exercise offers little relief to patients on newer targeted therapies, who must still pay full price. "Because trade margin rationalisation cannot make patented drugs affordable. The government would have to use provisions in the patent law such as compulsory licensing or governmental use to bring down the prices," said an expert in medicine patents.

WEB EXCLUSIVE
Deepinder Goyal's Rs 85,000 wearable: When wellness marketing runs ahead of science — *By Rinku Ghosh*
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

WORDLY WISE
We have art in order not to die of the truth
— *Friedrich Nietzsche*

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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Kill the encounter, it undermines rule of law

THE KILLING in a police encounter of a man accused of raping and murdering a minor girl in West Bengal's Uttar Dinajpur, the fourth such incident in the state since the BJP came to power in May, points to a disquieting possibility. The "encounter" is becoming routine in the state. Bengal has a long and troubled history of political violence. But the frequency of the incidents, and Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari's public defence of a "free hand" to the the police, particularly in cases of sexual violence, raise questions about the troubling short-circuiting of due process in a climate of impunity.

Unfortunately, the incidents in Bengal are not isolated aberrations. By all accounts, they are part of a wider national pattern of the police taking the law into their own hands. Earlier this month, in Andhra Pradesh's Anantapur, a 21-year-old accused of attacking a schoolgirl with a chainsaw was shot by the police and subsequently had to have his leg amputated. The incident revived memories of the 2019 Hyderabad rape-murder case, in which the four accused were killed in an alleged encounter. In Uttar Pradesh, official statistics recorded 17,043 police encounter operations between March 2017 and May 2026. An investigation by this paper earlier this year found that the Punjab Police reported 34 encounters between November 2025 and January 2026 — more than one every three days. There is a fundamental distinction between enabling the police to act decisively within the law and endorsing a culture of retribution. The promise of instant justice can command public approval, when leaders present it as evidence of resolve against crime. But the less visible processes of investigation, prosecution and trial are indispensable to the rule of law. Political capital gained from displays of toughness comes at the cost of institutional credibility. It creates a cycle of weakening accountability that shrinks citizens' freedoms.

Courts have repeatedly sought to draw important distinctions, but their interventions have done little to arrest the larger pattern. In its 2014 judgment in *People's Union for Civil Liberties v State of Maharashtra*, the Supreme Court laid down safeguards for investigating police encounters resulting in death — including mandatory registration of an FIR, an independent investigation and a magisterial inquiry. In May 2025, in *Arif Md Yeasin Jwadder v State of Assam*, the Court reaffirmed that these safeguards were binding and could not be made contingent on the victim or the family initiating proceedings. Such judicial directives are essential, but their efficacy ultimately depends on institutional compliance. The legitimacy of the criminal justice system rests not on the speed or spectacle of punishment, but on the certainty, fairness and credibility of due process. No government can afford to lose sight of that.

As demand overtakes supply, a big fat problem

MILK IS naturally prone to adulteration; milk fat even more so. The unscrupulous players who add water to milk would probably not forgo the opportunity to lace desi ghee with palm and other vegetable oils or other animal fats such as tallow and lard. The crackdowns by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India and other regulators, especially post the Tirupati laddu scandal in September 2024, have considerably undermined the operations of such suppliers. In the process, these have also increased the demand for genuine ghee, khoya, paneer and other high-fat dairy ingredients. That has received a further fillip with the September 2025 cut in GST rates on ghee, butter and cheese from 12 to 5 per cent, on ice-cream from 18 to 5 per cent, and on paneer from 5 to zero per cent.

The flip side is that supply isn't keeping pace with demand on the back of rising incomes and consumer awareness about what constitutes "real" milk fat versus vegetable oil-based frozen dessert or analogue paneer. India, today, faces a problem of milk fat shortage. The challenge isn't one of milk availability. Milk production at an aggregate level has been growing annually by about 3 per cent over the past decade. But that is coming increasingly from cows rather than buffaloes. Standard cow milk has 3.5 per cent fat and 8.5 per cent solids-not-fat (SNF). For buffalo milk, these are taken at 6.5 per cent and 9 per cent. If buffaloes are contributing hardly 45 per cent to the national milk output now, as against 60 per cent three decades ago, it translates into that much less of total solids — specifically fat — being produced.

Over time, this is causing a fundamental imbalance. As fat demand continues to go up, meeting it more through cow milk would also result in greater production of SNF, that is, skimmed milk powder (SMP), for which the domestic market isn't expanding at the same rate. One could well have a situation where India is surplus in SMP and not so in fat. That the country is already deficit in milk fat is evident in average ex-dairy prices of butter soaring by over 54 per cent between October 2023 and October 2026, compared to just 18 per cent for SMP. Policymakers can take credit for making India the world's top milk producer. But they also need to address its big fat problem.

In Arpita Singh's canvas, depth of meaning

A PAINTING is, to begin with, a mark on paper. Distinctions of genre and form are an overlay, not an organic feature of the artwork. Or so suggests the vast and infinitely imaginative oeuvre of Arpita Singh, who died this week at the age of 90. Over the course of her decades-long career, as she reinvented herself, exploring new ways of expressing, Singh created richly detailed, almost tapestry-like works that invited multiple viewings.

Born in pre-Partition Bengal, Singh, who moved to Delhi as a child, witnessed the brutal realities of a newly independent nation. Was this why, in her work, she rejected clear binaries and hierarchies, placing violence and beauty, the domestic and the political, within the same frame? Her voracious reading and her training at the Weavers' Service Centre in Kolkata also led to the collapse of such walls in her work where a five-armed goddess in widow's whites (one of her many powerful feminine figures) might be found brandishing a pistol at a man dressed in a bureaucrat's black coat. Or where Yudhishthira may ascend to heaven seated on an aeroplane (accompanied by the faithful dog, Dharma in disguise). She even made room for words, a gesture to a time when, for want of affordable paper, she began painting on printed catalogues.

There is an elasticity to her work, which expands with meaning the more time one spends with it. It is this quality that gives her style — fabular, observant and impatient with any logic but her own — such fluidity, making it contemporary and timeless.

Court dismantles unconstitutional buffer zone between detention & arrest



FAIZAN MUSTAFA

EVERY ARREST deprives liberty and, therefore, must be a last resort in a liberal democracy. Even words may amount to arrest if they are calculated to bring to a person's notice that he is under compulsion and he, thereafter, submits to such compulsion. Indeed, the word "arrest" is a legal term of art.

At a time when there is a widespread conversation about institutional decay, with some expressing concerns that the Supreme Court has become an executive-minded court, a two-judge bench led by Justice Ujjal Bhuyan — Justice A S Chandurkar was the other judge — has given a bold judgment that drastically restricts the power of the police to detain people before their formal arrest. In *Prabir Purkayastha* (2024), too, a violation of Article 22(1) for not supplying grounds of arrest was the basis of his release. In last week's verdict, the right to production before a magistrate within 24 hours under Article 22(2) was in question. Unfortunately, the 44th constitutional amendment (1978), which was aimed at humanising preventive detention in Article 22(4), has not been notified even after 48 years. This shows successive governments' lack of commitment to due process. Interestingly, Article 22(1) and (2) in essence incorporated guarantees — right to counsel of choice and production before a magistrate within 24 hours — that were already part of the colonial government's Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898.

Justice Bhuyan is showing, time and again, that every appointment to the apex court is extremely important. Judges sitting even in smaller benches not only greatly contribute to our constitutional jurisprudence but can help reinforce the people's trust in the judiciary.

Criminal law is the most direct expression of the relationship between a state and its citizens. Criminal sanction is the most coercive method of regulating an individual's behaviour that a state can deploy. Criminal law's promise as an instrument of safety is matched only by its power to destroy. Today, we are making excessive use of criminal law by not only adding new crimes but also mindlessly enhancing the punishments. No precise number of criminal offences is available, but central laws alone provide for as many as 7,305 criminal offences. Criminal law is entry number 1 of the Concurrent List: State criminal statutes provide for thousands of additional crimes. The progressive view among criminologists is that criminal justice policy is largely irrelevant in reducing the incidence of crime. Incarceration rates are higher in countries whose capacities to regulate the macroeconomy and contain inequality are weak. The "culture of control" is also a product of market and economic dynamics. Incarceration impinges on the autonomy of the individual.

As per the National Crime Records Bureau, in 2024, we recorded 58,85,867 cognisable crimes, with 35,44,608 under the IPC/BNS and 23,41,259 under special and local laws. In most crimes, there are several suspects and accused who are arrested. About 72.6 per cent of prisoners are undertrials — they have not been convicted of any crime.

Article 22 is unequivocal in the provision that every arrested person must be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours. In reality, though, the police often detain suspects for hours prior to formally entering their arrest in the record.

> At a time when civil liberties are being curtailed with bail provisions being made far more stringent, Justice Bhuyan has yet again reminded us of the apex court's jurisprudence and how fundamental rights are to be interpreted

At a time when civil liberties are being curtailed with bail provisions being made far more stringent, Justice Bhuyan has yet again reminded us of the apex court's jurisprudence and how fundamental rights are to be interpreted.

In *Sakal Papers* (1961), the Constitution Bench had already held that " [The] Constitution must be interpreted in a broad way and not in a narrow and pedantic sense... while considering the nature and content of those rights the Court must not be too astute to interpret the language of the Constitution in so literal a sense as to whittle them down."

Similarly, in *M Nagaraj* (2006), the Court had said that people's rights are not a gift from the state. Part III of the Constitution does not confer fundamental rights; rather, it confirms their existence.

With such an understanding of civil liberties, it was not difficult for Justice Bhuyan to hold that the 24-hour period starts the moment a person is detained and the police get the power to restrict their liberties. Justice Bhuyan rightly observed that Article 22(2) uses the expressions "arrested" and "detained" in conjunction. So, arrest and detention cannot be artificially separated. The two words are synonymous. He overruled the judgments of the Orissa, Madras and Kerala High Courts that tried to distinguish between the two terms. Justice Bhuyan held that "the Constitution does not recognise any detention dehors arrest". He went on to observe that "any attempt to draw an artificial distinction between 'arrest' and 'detention' would dilute or negate the fundamental protection guaranteed by the Constitution under clause (2) of Article 22. Such an endeavour should be avoided."

In unequivocal terms, Justice Bhuyan held that Article 22 neither mandates any time for inquiry nor investigation nor medical examination nor anything else. Article 22 permits exclusion only of the time in reaching the court of the magistrate. No buffer zone can be created where the liberty of an individual is curtailed for investigating purposes prior to formal arrest. Such a buffer zone is unconstitutional.

Justice Bhuyan based his observations on Justice V R Krishna Iyer's judgment in *Niranjan Singh* (1980), which acknowledged that explanations like "the police have taken a man into informal custody but not arrested him or have detained him for interrogation but not taken him into formal custody" are "unfair evasions of the straightforwardness of the law".

While Article 22(2) does not explicitly provide for production before a judicial magistrate, Justice Bhuyan did have an opportunity in this case to interpret the word "magistrate" as a judicial magistrate and not an executive magistrate. Section 15 of BNSS,2023 authorises state governments to appoint any police officer not below the rank of Superintendent of Police as Special Executive Magistrate (SEM). A person arrested by the police should not ideally be produced before a fellow police officer. Is not the separation of powers a basic feature of our Constitution? Recently, student activists and CJP leaders in Delhi were produced before the SEM, who was a police officer and whose remand order is questionable on several counts.

The writer is vice-chancellor, Chanakya National Law University, Patna. Views are personal

He listened to the village and the small town



USHA RAI

SANJIT "BUNKER" Roy, 81, social activist, educator and entrepreneur, passed away early Tuesday morning at his home in Tilonia, Rajasthan. Bunker, as he was popularly known, had not been keeping well after he suffered from Covid.

An outgoing person, Bunker, despite being a Doon School and St Stephen's College alumnus, made rural development and empowering people his life mission. He moved to Tilonia in the early Seventies and set up the Social Work Research Centre. As a journalist covering development issues, I bumped into him in Rajasthan, workshops in Delhi and in the corridors of the Planning Commission as he sought to influence government policies and find resources for his dream projects on water, solar energy and grassroots education, and breathe new life into rural arts and crafts. The Tilonia Bazaar became a landmark event at the Triveni Kala Sangam.

Not many people know that Bunker was a national squash champion for three successive years in the mid-Sixties, a cricketer and a competitive swimmer. Despite his elite background, in an interview to a magazine a few years ago, he said he had been inspired to work in rural India by the JP movement, the famine and poverty he saw in Bihar and Gandhian ideals. Since he had moved to Rajasthan, where water was a perennial problem, mapping and enhancing water resources was among his early priorities. He set up water pumps near villages and trained the local population to maintain them without dependence on mechanics. He founded the Barefoot College, and in addition to surveys for traditional sources of water in drought-prone areas of the state, he began educating people, many of whom had never been to a school, with skills that would enhance their livelihood opportunities while addressing the needs of villages and small towns. The Barefoot College trained people as paramedics, midwives, solar power engineers and weavers.

In 1970, Bunker married Aruna Roy. An IAS officer, Aruna quit the civil service to also work at the grassroots level in Rajasthan. Along with two others, she set up the Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan in Devdungri. Though their areas of specialisation were different, Aruna and Bunker supported each other and brought new synergy to non-governmental, grassroots movements.

In 2010, Bunker was among the 100 people selected by *Time* magazine for impacting development in the world. It stated, "With abiding compassion for the rural poor in India, Bunker nurtured a grassroots social entrepreneurship that is redefining the way the world thinks about fighting poverty. His Barefoot College trained more than 3 million people for jobs in the modern world."

The 1,700 women solar engineers trained by Bunker in 96 countries became international icons as "solar mamas". The young people from different parts of India trained by Bunker and the Barefoot College since 1974 have opened 20 barefoot colleges in 16 Indian states.

I remember meeting Norti Bai, one of Bunker's trainees, at a Bengaluru workshop. She wore a billowing Rajasthani skirt with *ghunghat*. She had learnt to use the computer to map water resources. Bunker had got her a computer keyboard with Devanagari characters, and she was adept enough to become a master trainer on locating water bodies. Norti Bai's life story was one of the foundational human examples used by Bunker to showcase how traditional village wisdom, when paired with technical confidence, outmatches formal paper degrees. She later became a village sarpanch and successfully organised daily wage labour to fight for fair minimum wages.

So impressed was my sister by Bunker's work that she gave up her job at Safdarjung Hospital to work as a doctor at one of his Social Work Research Centres in Khori village, Pataudi.

Bunker was awarded the Padma Shri in 1986, the Jamnalal Bajaj Award for Application of Science and Technology for Rural Development in 1985, and the Robert Hill Award for his contribution to and promotion of photovoltaics (solar energy) in 2009. He received several other forms of recognition, international and national, but his biggest award was the love and respect that he got from those he empowered.

The writer is a senior journalist

> Despite his elite background, in an interview to a magazine a few years ago, he said he had been inspired to work in rural India by the JP movement, the famine and poverty he saw in Bihar and Gandhian ideals

After Messi and Ronaldo, a less beautiful game



SHUVADITYA BOSE

OURS WAS a wonderfully weird time, the Diwali of the mid-2000s. The festival remains eternal, but the era is distinguished by one visual — fairy lights. They were a riot of colour, a celebration of the entire palette. Recreate that spectacle today, and it might be "cringe". In that noisy era, football was noisy too, untouched by media training and calibrated statements. A Manchester United captain tore into his teammates on the club's own channel after a humiliating defeat. A Swedish youngster declined a trial at one of England's grandest clubs because he "did not do auditions". The anything-goes age also gave the world two of its greatest stars. Cristiano Ronaldo and Lionel Messi won't be seen playing international football again.

In the summer of 2007, Messi was compared to Diego Armando Maradona, a burden he would carry for the rest of his career. Against Getafe, he gathered the ball in his own half and embarked on an odyssey of 11.6 seconds, leaving five defenders in his wake before rounding the goalkeeper and rolling the ball home. Commentator Joaquim Maria Puyal cried "Messi" 18 times, each with a different emotion. That same year, Ronaldo was announcing himself in a language of his own. Against his boyhood club, Sporting CP, he struck a stoppage-time winner from a free-kick 25 yards out. The British press already had a name for him: Rocket Ronnie. For the next decade and a half, picking a side seemed almost mandatory. Ronaldo made the extraordinary seem within reach. There was no single, unforeseen trick in his repertoire, just sheer determination. Messi, at five foot seven, slipped through spaces that didn't exist, left defenders grasping.

In a post-Ronaldo and Messi era, what the sport will miss is the particular individuality they brought to a game built around the collective. It would be a travesty to suggest football lacked tactical nuance in the past, yet talent demanded exceptions. When Roma's David Pizarro alleged in 2008 that dribbling was mistaken for humiliation, Alex Ferguson defended his blue-eyed boy: "That is what people pay to see." Frank Rijkaard, asked about his instructions to Messi, said: "Without the ball, he has to keep it wide. With the ball, he can do whatever he wants."

That football no longer exists. Gary Neville has warned that the "robotic nature of not leaving our positions" was becoming "a disease". Per Opta, dribbles per 90 minutes in the Premier League fell from 38.52 in 2014/15 to 34.99 in 2021/22, and in La Liga from 42.13 to 34.71. Asked about the instructions he gives Lamine Yamal, Spain's coach Luis de la Fuente said, "I tell Lamine that if he has three players on him, there's an area of the pitch where we have superiority. We must get the ball there, not by dribbling, but with fast passing." Zinedine Zidane has conceded that "with just technique, you could go far" in the past, but "nowadays, I think it's more complicated". The question, then, is not whether festivals will always have fairy lights. It is whether they will have colour, or whether all that remains will be beige.

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> In a post-Ronaldo and Messi era, what the sport will miss is the particular kind of individuality they brought to a game built around the collective

40 YEARS AGO
November 11, 1986


SAREES
INDIAN EXPRESS
LUXMI
Probe ordered into Ayodhya mishap
India's nuclear options under constant review
Concern at US arms to Pak
Two more killed in Punjab
Ershad lifts martial law

India reviewing nuclear option

THE GOVERNMENT is constantly reviewing its nuclear option in light of the deteriorating security environment, MoS External Affairs K Natwar Singh said in the Rajya Sabha during a debate on Pakistan's nuclear plans and renewed US arms supplies to that country. Reacting to a plea by members cutting across party lines for India to go nuclear, the minister said the issue had global implications and was not confined to India-Pakistan relations.

Ershad lifts martial law

BANGLADESH'S FOUR-and-a-half years of military rule ended when President Hossain Mohammad Ershad lifted martial law and said he was returning the country to democracy. A proclamation signed by Ershad said he was renouncing his title as Chief Martial Law Administrator and restoring the constitution he suspended after seizing power in a coup in 1982. The proclamation came after parliament passed a law protecting the President against prosecution for his role during military rule.

Probe into Ayodhya stampede

UTTAR PRADESH Chief Minister Vir Bahadur Singh ordered an inquiry by a high court judge into the stampede near Ram Ki Pauri in Ayodhya. Thirty-one pilgrims were killed in the incident. The CM flew to Faizabad and motored to Ayodhya to see the site of the tragedy and the relief and rescue operations being carried out. The stampede occurred when the ropes put up to control the movement of pilgrims gave way.

Acrimony in Bollywood

THE UNITY and solidarity the film industry displayed during its month-long strike crumbled in a day when following the accord, a section of the industry cried for the blood of its leaders for engineering a settlement devoid of tangible results. The very industry that had lionised its star MPs Amitabh Bachchan and Sunil Dutt during the strike period was busy running them down, with suggestions made to burn their effigies.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

The AI chip boss's actions raise urgent questions about... national security and the US president's willingness to listen to intelligence warnings.— *The Guardian*

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At Abu Dhabi, new diplomatic push on Ukraine. Stakes are high for India and world



RAJA MANDALA

BY C RAJA MOHAN



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

AS REPRESENTATIVES of the US, Russia, Ukraine and Europe gather in Abu Dhabi this week to renew the stalled peace talks, Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to President Volodymyr Zelenskyy on Monday to reaffirm India's strong commitment to supporting the peace process. The same evening, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar spoke to his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov about the Ukraine conflict and ongoing diplomatic initiatives. Delhi has good reason to engage with the prolonged crisis in Europe amid Washington's renewed diplomatic push. For, peace in Ukraine and Europe could help ease India's current economic and geopolitical challenges.

Many in Delhi assumed that Donald Trump's setback in last week's midterm elections, which will give the Democrats control of both houses of Congress in January, would slow him down. It has not. Trump has dug in his heels at home, appointing immigration hardliner Stephen Miller as his chief of staff, while pressing ahead with diplomatic initiatives abroad.

This week's trilateral talks between the US, Ukraine and Russia are their first since February. Secretary of State Marco Rubio is in Paris seeking support from G7 foreign ministers for the initiative. Expectations of a breakthrough remain modest, but the intensity of the American effort is unmistakable. Trump's envoys, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, have prepared the ground through several rounds of consultations with Kyiv and Moscow.

An important element of the renewed initiative is the idea of embedding peace in Ukraine within a broader European security architecture. When negotiations reach a deadlock, diplomacy can either break the problem into smaller parts or widen the framework to create room for compromise. Washington has chosen the latter.

Trump hopes that addressing Russia's larger security concerns will make Vladimir Putin more amenable to an immediate ceasefire and a sustainable settlement with Ukraine. The challenge for Washington is to accommodate Moscow's concerns without sacrificing the legitimate security interests of Ukraine and Europe.

Kushner has outlined five objectives for a broader European security framework: Permanent security consultations, reliable crisis communications, greater military transparency, reciprocal measures to reduce the risks of escalation, and arrangements for long-term stability. He has also affirmed that countries must remain free to make their own security choices. Rubio says there has been progress in discussions on Europe's future security arrangements, but no final agreement. Whether Abu Dhabi can produce a broad set of principles acceptable to all sides remains uncertain.

Europe, meanwhile, is struggling to come to terms with an American initiative that could produce a settlement negotiated over its head. Washington has stepped up consultations with European capitals. Senior officials from the EU, France, Germany and Britain will be present in Abu Dhabi, but not at the trilateral negotiating table. Moscow has resisted their direct participation.

> The hardest question remains Ukraine's security after the fighting stops. Kyiv wants guarantees strong enough to deter another Russian attack. Moscow opposes Western military deployments in Ukraine and wants limits on its armed forces

Europe's foreign policy chief, Kaja Kallas, argues that Europe already has a security architecture; the problem is Russia's refusal to respect it. Moscow insists that the West has violated the principles of European security agreed at the end of the Cold War.

There is also a fundamental disagreement over sequencing. Kyiv and its European partners want a ceasefire before negotiations on the wider security order. Washington believes simultaneous progress on both fronts could create room for progress all round.

Europe is also divided internally. Poland's Foreign Minister Radosław Sikorski has warned against Western Europe negotiating with Russia over the heads of Eastern Europeans. Italy's Giorgia Meloni has criticised Europe's fragmented diplomatic formats and called for a single European envoy. Europe wants a place at the negotiating table, but has yet to agree on who should speak for it and with what mandate.

The hardest question, though, remains Ukraine's security after the fighting stops. Kyiv wants guarantees strong enough to deter another Russian attack. Moscow opposes Western military deployments in Ukraine and wants limits on its armed forces. Reconciling these positions will not be easy.

Washington is also exploring economic incentives to make peace more attractive. Trump is betting that Russian energy, European markets, Ukrainian transit routes and American capital can create a shared interest in ending the war.

Russian gas once bound Europe and Moscow together. The 2022 invasion broke that relationship, prompting Europe to reduce Russian energy imports and impose sanctions. India, as a major importer of Russian oil, was caught in the crossfire between Moscow and the West.

Today, American and Russian officials are reportedly discussing the revival of gas supplies to Germany through the Nord Stream pipelines, potentially involving American investors. Trump's calculation appears to be that commercial interdependence could help sustain a political settlement.

If the Abu Dhabi talks make progress, Trump could take the negotiations to the highest level. He has indicated an opportunity to meet Putin on the margins of the APEC summit in China later this month. There is also talk of a meeting involving Trump, Putin and Xi Jinping.

Trump has embarked on a difficult diplomatic balancing act in Ukraine, reinforced by his pursuit of accommodation among the great powers. Its success is far from assured, but the stakes for India are considerable.

Peace in Ukraine could bring three benefits. First, it would ease pressures on energy and food security. Second, even a limited relaxation of tensions between Russia and the West would expand India's diplomatic space to strengthen relations with both Moscow and Washington. Third, it would give fresh momentum to India's growing economic and strategic partnership with Europe.

Together, these developments could create a more favourable international environment for India's economic transformation. Delhi has every reason to support the peace process and contribute wherever it can.

The writer is contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. *His new book,* India Pivots to Europe: In Search of a New Eurasian Balance, *is published this month*

World Bank's poverty estimate does not pass the thali test



PULAPRE BALAKRISHNAN AND AMAN RAJ

THE WORLD Bank recently released estimates of poverty in India, pegging "extreme poverty" at 2.6 per cent. If true, that would be good news, as it would imply that high levels of economic deprivation are now a thing of the past. We argue that such a conclusion would be premature.

The WB's poverty estimate is a headcount ratio — the ratio of the number of poor to the population. It estimates the number of poor by applying a poverty line to data reported in the NSS's Household Consumption Expenditure Survey for 2023-24 (HCES). The poverty line translated into goods represents the minimum acceptable level of consumption, below which an individual is deemed poor. The report does not mention the set of goods and their prices that the World Bank used to construct its poverty line for India. The Survey is a rich source of consumption across the population and reveals granular information on the standard of living, which can be used to assess a headcount poverty estimate, as we demonstrate.

In 2025, we proposed a simple measure of the standard of living in India ('The Thali Index', *IE*, July 1, 2025). Termed the "thali index", it measures the number of thalis an individual can afford to buy based on the monthly per capita expenditure on food reported in the HCES. Why did we choose this metric? The thali is a metaphor for a complete meal, combining protein, carbohydrates and minerals. It is a unit of food consumption that Indians culturally relate to and is both nutritious and satisfying. To measure the standard of living of Indians based on the thali index, we would need to apply a price to the consumption expenditure reported. We have adopted Rs 30 as the price of a thali, being the cost of a home-cooked vegetarian thali as estimated by CRISIL for the year 2023-24. We chose a home-cooked vegetarian thali as it is the cheapest. Applying the thali index to the data on consumption across expenditure groups, we found that up to 50 per cent of rural Indians and 20 per cent of urban Indians cannot afford two thali meals a day. Imputing the value of the subsidised food, which the WB report refers to as a factor affecting poverty, lowers this percentage to 40 per cent and 10 per cent, respectively. This implies that approximately 30 per cent of the Indian population cannot afford two square meals a day, making it difficult to stomach an estimate of less than 3 per cent for poverty in India.

Note that the Bank's estimate and ours come from the same source, namely, the HCES. The difference is that the Bank uses a poverty line to measure income poverty while we are going by the directly observable data on the food consumption level. If two thali meals per day are considered the minimum acceptable food consumption, our findings imply levels of extreme poverty higher than the Bank's estimate. The implication of our finding is that it must rethink the poverty line that it uses for India. The point is that even if the income at its currently used poverty line is more than sufficient to enable two thalis a day per person, there are several items of expenditure that must be met by a household to earn a livelihood, maintain good health and educate their young. We can think of rent, medicines and school fees. It is likely that these expenses are met first, so as to ensure survival, reducing food to the status of a residual item of consumption. If we accept the criterion of a minimum level of food consumption for an individual to be counted as non-poor, then the chosen poverty line must reflect this feature. If 30 per cent of the population does not have access to two square meals a day, surely we cannot hold that less than 3 percent of the population is poor. Our argument has been made with respect to the World Bank's measure of income poverty but carries over to the Multidimensional Poverty Index of the UNDP to the extent that it relies on the Bank's poverty line.

The latest poverty estimates could create complacency in economic policymaking — if extreme poverty is almost non-existent, policies are needed to remedy it. But our finding of a low level of food consumption for a significant section of Indians imparts an urgency to it. The level of food consumption is directly affected by food prices, and controlling the price of food is central to safeguarding the well-being of the population. Right now, we are experiencing a surge in food price inflation. Quite unusually, between January and September, it has risen every month, trebling over this period. This means that prices are not just continuously rising but the rise in prices is accelerating. An urgent review of the policies to control food price inflation is warranted. Food price inflation can only be controlled by managing food supply, in particular by producing more food at a steady price. This requires increasing agricultural productivity.

Balakrishnan is honorary visiting professor, Centre for Development Studies, Thiruvananthapuram, and Raj is a PhD student at Shiv Nadar University, Delhi NCR

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Fiscal discipline

ONE-TIME windfalls are fiscal cosmetics, not cures, and India's budget math leans on them more than it should ('Walking the fiscal tightrope won't be easy', *IE*, November 10). Disinvestment gains from IDBI's sale and strong customs collections mask a worrying trend. Core tax growth and capital spending are slowing simultaneously, exactly when the economy needs sustained public investment most. The fertiliser subsidy overshoot reveals a deeper discipline problem — budgets routinely underestimate politically sensitive expenses. Genuine fiscal credibility would mean budgeting honestly for subsidies upfront.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

Protecting liberty

THE SUPREME Court has made a crucial reaffirmation that the 24-hour limit for producing a detainee before a magistrate begins from actual detention, not formal arrest ('Court's relook at detention protects liberty', *IE*, November 10). By dismantling the artificial distinction often exploited by law enforcement, the apex court has closed a dangerous loophole that permitted unauthorised custody and heightened the risk of custodial abuse. Allowing investigative agencies unbridled discretion to delay recording formal arrests undermines Article 22(2) and weakens accountability.

S S Paul, Nadia

Missing 'I' in AI writing

AI HAS undoubtedly democratised writing, making it easier for people to articulate their thoughts. However, in the process, we may be losing something far more valuable: The individuality of human expression ('The storyteller, now powered by AI', *IE*, November 10). Good writing was never merely about flawless grammar or sophisticated vocabulary; it was about personality, lived experiences, imperfections and a distinctive voice. The real danger is not AI writing for us, but our gradually forgetting how to write for ourselves.

Bablu Kumar Gupta, Lucknow



SUMANA ROY

Watching Ramayana, missing the forest

BHARATA, AFTER whom our country takes its name, was conceived in a forest. His parents Dushyanta and Shakuntala meet and marry in a forest; the rest we know — the father's journey back to his urban world, the curse of forgetfulness, the little boy Bharata raised by a single mother and the forest.

That the man, after whom this landmass would come to be named, should have been conceived in a forest is telling. Something shifts in Rabindranath Tagore's philosophy when he recognises this, that we are a forest people, and that it was unlike Europe, whose mind was shaped by the sea: "In the sea, nature presented herself to those men in her aspect of a danger, a barrier which seemed to be at constant war with the land and its children. The sea was the challenge of untamed nature to the indomitable human soul ... This refers to a people who live by the sea, and ride on it as on a wild, champing horse, catching it by its mane and making it render service from shore to shore. They find delight in turning by force the antagonism of circumstances into obedience. But in the level tracts of Northern India men found no barrier between their lives and the grand life that permeates the universe. The forest entered into a close living relationship with their work and leisure, with their daily necessities and contemplations. They could not think of other surroundings as separate or inimical. So the view of the truth, which these men found, did not make manifest the difference, but rather the unity of all things. They uttered their faith in these words: *Yadidam kinch sarvam prana ejati nihsratam* (All that is vibrates with life, having come out from life)."

> Tagore calls Valmiki's Rama 'giri-vana-priya', lover of the mountain and forest. There are no real forests in 'Ramayana Part I', an ironically honest commentary about the disappearing forests in India

Tagore is, of course, going back to the *Aranyaka*s, the Vedic texts whose name derives from the forest; to the *Brihadaranyaka Upanishad*, the great forest. That a text could cover such a wide range of subjects, the *atman-brahman*, *neti neti* (not this, not that), creation, sacrifice, and even dreams, owes, without a doubt, to its forest-form and forest-mind. These thoughts could have come only from a forest location, a space outside human ordering and a space more physically and philosophically accommodative than any other on the planet.

"When one tears out the tree from its roots,/the tree can grow no more,/out of which root the man grows forth,/when he is struck down by death?" It is the intimation of this self-and-species destruction in the *Brihadaranyaka* that Bibhutibhushan Bandyopadhyay writes about in *Aranyaka*, possibly the Subcontinent's earliest environmental autofiction, where Satya (a character like Bandyopadhyay himself, but whose name, meaning "truth", gives it a metaphysical texture) oversees the cutting down of forests in Bihar. Later, in *Ichhamati*, his last novel, he would say it more directly: After spending a long paragraph on cataloguing the plant life by the river Ichhamati, he would write: "Their voices, their stories, are the real history of our nation".

The equivalence of the forest and nation is not new. Here is Banabhatta in *Kadambari*, 7th century CE: "The forest seems at times and at places to flaunt the trappings of a sovereign state as it were, as its herds of deer wave their *chamara*s or bushy tails, and bands of wild elephants circle around, the one an insignia of royal power and the other an arm of the defence force". Without *vanavas*, there could have been no Ramrajya. Tagore the literary critic notices this: "In the Ramayana, we are led to realise the greatness of the hero, not in a fierce struggle with Nature, but in sympathy with it ... Sita asks about the flowering trees, and shrubs and creepers which she has not seen before."

Tagore calls Valmiki's Rama "*giri-vana-priya*", lover of the mountain and forest. There are no real forests in Nitesh Tiwari's *Ramayana Part I* (*Rise of a Legend*), only VFX and green screens, an ironically honest commentary about the disappearing forests in India. His Rama is like a European warrior, who thinks of "nature as a barrier". We are the least Indian we have ever been.

Roy, a poet and writer, is professor, Ashoka University. Views are personal



CHIRAG DHARA AND SHRUTEE JALAN

Look beyond the biggest emitters at COP31

"WHEN A poor farmer in Nepal went to sow... seeds in the monsoon, fertilisers didn't reach her on time ... [Yet] Rifles and ammunition cross borders, clear every bottleneck, meet each deadline. We have built a world with flawless logistics for war and broken logistics for food ... [We are] hit by the climate we did not warm and by the wars we did not start." So said Nepal's Prime Minister Balendra Shah at the UN General Assembly in September, barely a month after a "Himalayan tsunami" killed nearly 1,500 people in Nepal, with over 5000 still missing.

Nepal's was one of many major climate disasters this year. India's summer monsoon was severely weakened by the Super El Niño, with vast parts of the country now reeling under drought. Through it all, the US war on Iran has broken global supply chains inflating household bills for the average consumer, even as US oil companies are reported to have made billions in wartime profits.

As we stand on the brink of overshooting 1.5°C of global warming, policymakers gather this week in Antalya, Turkey for COP31, whose goal is to implement solutions to slow warming, limit overshoot, and help countries adapt.

But who should take the lead in implementing these solutions?

The common view holds that the US and Europe bear the greatest responsibility but it misses the full picture.

To see why, imagine that all humanity had historically lived a European or American lifestyle. How much would the world have warmed already? What about the Indian or Nepalese lifestyle? In peer-reviewed research soon to appear in *Climate Policy*, we build a new framework to study this thought experiment.

By 2022, the Earth's actual warming was about 1.3°C. But, had the whole world historically lived like the average British citizen, the Earth would have already warmed about 2.5°C. And like the average American, about 3.7°C.

But our most striking findings concern small, super-affluent countries. Had humanity lived as Singaporeans do, warming would have been about 2°C; as Luxembourgers do, nearly 4°C; and as Qataris do, a staggering 5+°C. In contrast, the historical lifestyles of the Least Developed Countries (LDCs) would have led to a mere 0.6°C of warming, and about 0.8°C for India.

> Had humanity lived as Singaporeans do, warming would have been about 2°C; as Luxembourgers do, nearly 4°C; and as Qataris do, a staggering 5+°C

Thus, affluent countries have avoided climate collapse only because most of the world did not live as they do. Global inequality has inadvertently subsidised climate stability.

This sharpens Shah's address in two ways. First, the injustice developing countries face is not merely that they bear the brunt of disasters they did not cause. Their low emissions have additionally helped stave off even higher levels of warming and bought the world valuable time to act. Second, responsibility for climate solutions rests not only on large affluent countries but also on small, super-affluent ones.

What does this mean for COP31? Those with the most destabilising lifestyles must lead on implementation. Countries whose universalised lifestyles would already have breached 1.5°C face an obligation to pursue net-negative emissions today. Technological and financial limits may put this out of reach even for the world's richest. But they can still contribute to the UN Loss and Damage fund, ease intellectual-property rules, transfer technologies for emissions reduction, and accelerate grant-based climate finance.

If the world can deliver arms and ammunition across borders on schedule, it has the means to move fertiliser, finance, and technology to those in need. Surely, that is the yardstick by which the outcomes of any COP must be judged.

Dhara is a sustainability scientist at Krea University. Jalan is research scholar at Indian Institute of Science. Views are personal

SC panel: Phase out 'unsustainable' river sand mining in 3 yrs, desilt dams

Apurva Vishwanath & Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, November 10

THE SC-appointed Central Empowered Committee (CEC) has said that the country should phase out "unsustainable" sand extraction from rivers within three years, and instead desilt dams to meet the construction sector demand.

The recommendation is part of the CEC's Report No. 36 of 2026, filed before the apex court on November 2, in the suo motu case on illegal sand mining in the National Chambal Sanctuary.

"A time-bound roadmap shall be prepared to progressively phase out unsustainable sand extraction from active river channels over the next three years, alongside development of adequate alternative sources, including reservoir sediment, M-sand and recycled C&D waste, while ensuring that legitimate construction requirements are met," the report states.

M-sand, or manufactured sand, is produced by crushing and processing suitable rock and can substitute for natural river sand in concrete and other construction applications when it meets BIS specifications. The committee also recommended a set of measures on "digital monitoring and traceability of mineral movement".

Key among these will be regulation through secure electronic transit permits, incorporating unique QR/barcodes or RFID-based identification.

Additionally, state mining departments shall establish a digital monitoring system on permissions, quantities permitted, actual extraction, transit permits and end-use.

Desilting plan

On dams, it recommended that "a time-bound desiltation programme be prepared, with contracts for eligible works awarded within the next three years, followed by a structured 10-year desiltation cycle for reservoirs identified as suitable".

The court had sought the report on October 6 when it widened the Chambal proceedings to cover river sand mining across the country. In earlier hearings, the court had warned that the activity has a "disastrous effect" on river ecosystems and cannot continue unchecked.

A two-judge bench headed by Justice Vikram Nath also appointed advocates Nikhil Goel and Rupali Samuel as amicus to assist the court.

The CEC recommended that the Ministry of Jal Shakti lead a comprehensive national framework specifying reservoir-wise sediment availability, recoverable quantities, processing requirements, timelines, financing arrangements and environmental safeguards in consultation with the CWC, National Dam Safety Authority, MoEFCC and State Governments. Sand, a minor mineral, and water are state subjects.

The CEC cited data from the Ministry of Jal Shakti, placed before Parliament in December 2025, that of the 439 reservoirs in the country assessed, gross storage lost to sedimentation averaged 19.24 %. It states that 23 reservoirs had lost more than half their capacity and Gobind Sagar, behind the Bhakra dam, has shrunk from 9,868 million cubic metres (MCM) to about 7,300 MCM (-26%).

Desilting, the report argues, would serve the "dual purpose of restoring reservoir storage capacity and meeting part of the growing demand for construction materials".

According to the Jal Shakti reply cited by the report, the 2025 national register lists 6,628 specified dams.

The panel recommended that all storage dams over 15 years old that have not been systematically desilted be assessed, and about one-tenth of reservoirs found suitable would be desilted each year.

The recovered sand, the CEC recommended, would be sold through transparent mechanisms. The panel adds that the cycle "should not be construed as a mandate for desiltation of every dam".

However, the CEC acknowledged that it does not know how much usable sand the dams hold since the potential of reservoir sediment as a source of construction sand "has not been adequately assessed at the national level".

It said "the total volume of accumulated sediment cannot be equated with the quantity that is technically recoverable, environmentally permissible or commercially usable".

On illegal mining, it said: "There is no consolidated, reliable national database that quantifies the volume or value of illegally extracted river sand." The available material, it said, "does not support a scientifically defensible national estimate of its total volume or value".

The CEC's recommendation for a national desilting plan is a deviation from earlier efforts to regulate illegal sand mining by banning it in specified areas. A 2020 CEC report on Rajasthan found that legal sand collection fell from about 57 million tonnes a year to 5 million after the SC restrained mining. It identified that gap as the main driver of illegal mining. The new report stated only that alternatives must be developed "while ensuring that legitimate construction requirements met".

The report also cited the desilting project by Bhakra Beas Management Board, as a model, which plans to excavate deposits up to two metres deep in the Bhakra reservoir.

'A Constitutional responsibility': Fadnavis backs UCC, says plan on to introduce it in state soon

Express News Service
Mumbai, November 10

BACKING THE Uniform Civil Code (UCC), Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis on Tuesday said the state government was committed to introducing the set of personal laws, as they had constitutional validity.

"The process of UCC draft is underway. We are going to bring the UCC soon," he told media persons during Diwali Milan, held at his official residence.

Slamming AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, both of whom objected to the BJP's decision to bring the UCC, the CM said, "Under the Constitution's Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP), UCC has the mandate."

"Dr Ambedkar's Constitution has given us fundamental rights and DPSP. One such directive states that every state should bring a Uniform Civil Code. Who has written this? The Constitution of India. It is a Constitutional responsibility," Fadnavis said.

The CM, however, added that the Directive Principles cannot be implemented like fundamental rights, as they require consensus among people.



Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis

He added, "The Leader of Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, had launched a campaign to undermine every Constitutional body, including (the) ECI, Supreme Court, Parliament and CAG. They are using the Special Intensive Revision as a pretext to attack democracy and the Constitution. Therefore, BJP had to take to the streets and counter the Opposition's fake narrative... The Congress wants to bring an ultra leftist regime in the country. But people will not accept it," said Fadnavis.

NCP-NCP(SP) merger

Breaking his silence on the rumours of a merger of the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) with NCP (Sharad Pawar), Fadnavis said, "Only Sharad Pawar and Sunetra Pawar can tell (that). If any decision were taken, we would have been informed. The merger cannot happen without our knowledge. And till now, neither has conveyed anything to us."

The CM has also assured that the NCP's demand for the finance portfolio will be met. "We have absolutely no problem."

His remarks came amidst last week's developments, when NCP's Praful Patel visited Sharad Pawar in the hospital, where the latter was admitted after he fell ill. NCP's Parth Pawar also visited Pawar's residence thrice. Additionally, State NCP leader Sunil Tatkare had indicated that late Ajit Pawar had wanted a merger.

Further, commenting on the difference between the working style of the late Ajit Pawar and Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar, Fadnavis said, "It would be unfair to draw any comparison, as Ajitdada had vast experience in politics and administration, stretching several decades. Sunetratai has taken charge recently. She is adapting to the responsibilities well."

Cong's 'Bharat Summit' to discuss new global order

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 10

THE CONGRESS on Tuesday announced that it will host experts from 70 countries this week in Hyderabad for deliberations on the emergence of a new global order and India's strategic responses to the developments, along with issues like cooperative federalism and electoral integrity.

Addressing a press conference at the Congress office in Delhi, party's Foreign Affairs department head Salman Khurshid said the 'Bharat Summit' in Hyderabad on November 13-14 will bring together around 1,000 delegates from across the world, and the areas of focus include the formation of a new think tank — 'Our World'.

The international conference will see the participation of leaders of Opposition in both Houses of Parliament, Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge, global policymakers, and prominent figures from progressive movements, said Khurshid.

Discussions at the summit will primarily focus on the "political vision" of Rahul Gandhi, evolving national and international political landscapes, the emergence of a new global order, and India's strategic responses to these developments, he said.

"The intention is to reflect the vision of Rahul Gandhi for India and the world of tomorrow, and the emergence of a new global order. We will have 12 international sessions and eight important sessions on Telangana," said Khurshid.

The summit coincides with two important occasions — the 137th birth anniversary of Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, who "continues to be an inspiration for foreign policy formulation and thinking in our party" and the 80th year of India's Independence.

The event's focus would also be on a joint statement and the formation of a new think tank, 'Our World'.

Telangana IT Minister Sridhar Babu told reporters that deliberations by hundreds of delegates from different countries will give a boost to Telangana's governance and its people.

"The Summit will address geopolitical matters, the new world order, societal challenges, climate change, the role of the media, journalism and information integrity," he said.

AI as his guide, Chhattisgarh man kills nephew, removes organs for quick buck

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, November 10

ON NOVEMBER 6, Ramjeet Ram, a daily wage labourer in Chhattisgarh's Jashpur district, woke up in his hut to find his four-year-old son missing. After a frantic search, the boy was found dead, around half a kilometre away, wrapped in a blanket inside a pit. Ram removed the blanket and was horrified to find the body in a mutilated state. The villagers alerted the police.

The search for the accused, Basudev Korwa alias Tangnu, ended in Ram's own family: His son was kidnapped and killed by his cousin. The accused thought he would be able to sell some of the boy's organs to make a quick buck, said police.

What left Ram, and the police, even more shocked was where Basudev got the idea to kill the four-year-old from: An Artificial Intelligence (AI) app.

Police have arrested Basudev, 27, and have recovered the boy's missing organs: kidneys, lungs and eyes. Basudev told police he had come across a video on social media about making money by selling organs.

For the last 45 days, he had been interacting with an AI app to find ways to execute his plan. On November 5 night, Basudev lured the boy with chicken. Police said Basudev first intoxicated the boy with liquor, took him to his hut and waited for him to pass out. After this, he slit the boy's throat and removed his kidneys, lungs and eyes.

On how the police zeroed in on Basudev, police said a local resident had spotted him accompanying the boy before he disappeared. "We have an eyewitness," said inspector Suman Toppo of Sanna police station.

The police have recovered the murder weapon and sent the boy's body and organs for an autopsy. The remains were handed over for last rites.

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No.: VSSUT/EE/902/2026 Date: 09/11/2026

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For more details, please visit our university website **www.vssut.ac.in.** The authority the reserve right to accept or reject all the tenders without assigning any reason thereof.

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Name of work	Provision for modification of 02 Nos. Lubricated compressor of 1750 LPM each on board mounting in WAP-4 type Electric Locomotives with modified cab fed by 180 KVA SIV at Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad.
Place of work	Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-110044
Completion Period	1 Years
Approximate cost of work	Rs. 31,60,753.31/- Including GST (Rupees Thirty One Lakh Sixty Thousand Seven Hundred Fifty Three and Thirty One Paisa only)
Amount of Bid Security	Rs. 63,200/- (Rs. Sixty Three Thousand Two Hundred only)
Technical Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
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Website to download and upload e-tender document	**www.ireps.gov.in**
Due date & time of uploading of Tender by tenderer	30.11.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs
Date & Time of Tender opening	30.11.2026 After 12:00 Hrs
Validity of offer	60 days from opening of tender

Tender Document can be downloaded from Indian Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in** For details of work experience, scope of work and terms & conditions please see Tender document. **No. TKD-MOD-Compressor-RT-26 Dated 07.11.2026**

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TENDER NOTICE

The Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Const./Northern Railway, 4th Floor, DRM Office, New Delhi-110001 invites e-tender under **single Packet System** for the under noted work:-

1.	**Name of work and location :** "Dismantling of Towers causing Hinderance in Railway working in connection with 3rd-4th line in DLI-Ambala section."
2.	**Completion period of the work :** 12 (twelve Months)
3.	**Approx. Cost of work :** Rs. 37,78,450/-
4.	**Earnest Money amount (to be deposited Online) :** Rs. 75,600/-
5.	**Date & Time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender :** Tenders may be uploaded by **11:00 hrs.** on **11.11.2026** by Railway on IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**. The bidders can participate in the e-tender, the tender will be opened at **11:00 hrs.** on **03.12.2026**.
6.	**Detailed Tender Notice & Tender Document :** The detailed e-tender notice and tender document is available on **www.ireps.gov.in**. Above tender document will be available for submission of offer on IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** from **19.11.2026 to 03.12.2026**. All other terms and conditions in respect of above tenders are given in tender document. The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.

No.: 349-Dy.CEE/C/NDLS/2026-27 Dated: 10.11.2026 3937/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	DNIT NO.180212(EPC-D-147/PO&C)DATED 22.09.2026	" OPENING DATE OF CORRIGENDUM-2 IS 06.11.2026 WITH EXTENSION IN DUE DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION UPTO 13.11.2026 17:00 HRS. "	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	DNIT NO.180205(EPC-D-149/PO&C)DATED 22.09.2026	" OPENING DATE OF CORRIGENDUM-2 IS 06.11.2026 WITH EXTENSION IN DUE DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION UPTO 13.11.2026 17:00 HRS. "	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50885/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE PANIPAT CO-OP. SUGAR MILLS LTD., PANIPAT	SALE OF PRESS MUD FOR CLUSTER SUGAR MILL DURING SEASON 2026-27	07.11.2026 14.11.2026	160 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996161283 panipatsugarmills@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50913/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE RADAUR	CONSTRUCTION OF IPS ON MC LAND NEAR JMIT AT CHOTA BANS IN MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE RADAUR, DISTRICT YAMUNA NAGAR + 2 WORKS	06.11.2026 20.11.2026	9,21,19,062/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9050970239 socymcradaur@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50895/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF HPLC WITH UV DETECTOR ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	1,65,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF HPLC WITH PDA DETECTOR, FLUORESCENCE AND RI DETECTOR ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT.	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	75,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF DISSOLUTION MACHINE AUTOSAMPLER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT.	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	15,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
4	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF ELECTRICAL AUTOPSY SAW STAND WITH ACCESSORIES ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 20.11.2026	22,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
5	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF AUTOREFRACTOMETER WITH ACCESSORIES ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	4,38,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
6	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF ND YAG LASER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	1,05,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50888/HRY

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Open Tender Notice No.: SRDEE-TRD-IZN-2026-27-T16, Date-10.11.2026 Open E-Tender

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD, North Eastern Railway, Izzatnagar for and on behalf of President of India, invites sealed "OPEN" E-Tender for the following work. **S.N.:-** 1, **Name of work:-** TRD related work for provision of remodeling at Lalkuan yard in IZN division., **Tender reference no:-** SRDEE-TRD-IZN-2026-27-T16, **Approx. Cost (in Rs):** 3,63,48,529.28, **Earnest money/Bid Security (in Rs):-** 7,27,000.00, **Cost of tender documents (in Rs):-** 00, **E-Tender closing date and Time:-**04.12.2026 11:00, **Completion period:-** 12 Month, • E-Tender Online will be submitted upto 11:00 Hrs on date: 04.12.2026, • For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website if Indian railways i.e., **www.ireps.gov.in**

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD
CPRO/Elect-260 Izzatnagar
Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Smt. Megha W/o Vikram Raj R/o N-110/36 Gali No.4, Rajasthani Udyog Nagar, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 223/2026, U/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act & 78 J.J. Act at PS: Mahendra Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Smt. Megha** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Smt. Megha** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Smt. Megha of FIR No.223/2026, U/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act & 78 J.J. Act of PS: Mahendra Park, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 21.12.2026.**

By order
Sushil Anuj Tyagi
Special Judge (NDPS) North Distt
Room No.207, IInd Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/16093/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Shri Khilesh Gandhi S/o Sh. M.L. Gandhi R/o H.No. 18, 3rd Floor Front Side RK Block Uttam Nagar New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No.14791/18 U/s 138 NI Act at PS: Patel Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shri Khilesh Gandhi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shri Khilesh Gandhi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shri Khilesh Gandhi of CC No. 14791/18 U/s 138 NI Act of PS: Patel Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.12.2026.**

By order
Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class- NI Act-04
Room No-04, (Annex-I)
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/16125/CD/2026

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

The Chief Workshop Manager/SEC Railway, MIB/WS, Nagpur, acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender for execution of work mentioned below: **Tender Notice No.:** MIBW-2026-19-06-02-1 Date: 05.11.2026, **Name of Work:** "Energy Audit through external agency under the Environmental Related work (ERWs) at Motibagh Workshop, Nagpur." **Approx Tender Value (in ₹):** ₹ 1,29,304/- (Rupees One Lakh Twenty-Nine Thousand Three Hundred Four only) inclusive of all charges and taxes (including GST @ 18%), **Earnest Money (in ₹):** ₹ 2,600/- (Rs. Two Thousand Six Hundred only). **Tenure of Contract:** 3 (Three) Months, **Cost of Tender Form (in ₹):** ₹ 0/- (Zero only); **Tender Notice No.:** MIBW-2026-19-06-02-02 Date: 05.11.2026, **Name of Work:** "Water Audit through external agency under the Environmental Related Works (ERWs) at Motibagh Workshop, Nagpur." **Approx Tender Value (in ₹):** ₹ 1,05,020/-(Rupees One Lakh Five Thousand Twenty only) inclusive of all charges and taxes (including GST @ 18%), **Earnest Money (in ₹):** ₹ 2,100/- (Rs. Two Thousand One Hundred only). **Tenure of Contract :** 3 (Three) Months, **Cost of Tender Form (in ₹):** ₹ 0/- (Zero only).

Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to 11:00 hrs on 27.11.2026 for tender No. MIBW-2026-19-06-02-1 Date: 05.11.2026 & up to 11:00 hrs on 27.11.2026 for tender No. MIBW-2026-19-06-02-02 Date: 05.11.2026 only.

Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offers received shall be rejected. Details are available on our website www.ireps.gov.in

Dy. CME/MIBW, SECR, Motibagh Workshop, Nagpur
PAM/67/181
South East Central Railway @secrail

GOVT. OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
Office of the Additional Chief Engineer
Vansadhara Nagabali Basin, Paralakhemundi
(email Id: se_sicpkd@yahoo.com)
32001/1301/2627

e- Procurement Notice No. ACEVNB-07/2026-27

1	Type of works	:	Improvement of service embankment road and Canal lining
2	Total number of Packages	:	01(One) No.
3	Estimated Cost	:	Rs.456.23 Lakhs
4	Bid Identification No.	:	ACE, VNB(CCD)-01/2026-27
5	Period of completion	:	11 (Eleven) months
6	Availability & submission of bids oriline	:	From 11.00 AM of 12.11.2026 to 5.00 PM of 03.12.2026
7	Date of Opening of Technical Bids	:	04.12.2026 at 11.00 AM. in the, O/O the Additional Chief Engineer, Vansadhara Nagabali Basin, Paralakhemundi.
8	Procurement Officer	:	Additional Chief Engineer, Vansadhara Nagabali Basin, Paralakhemundi.
9	Further details can be seen from Govt. Website **www.tendersorissa.gov.in** and any addendum/ corrigendum/ cancellation will be published in the said website.		

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer
Vansadhara Nagabali Basin Paralakhephundi
OIPR-32001/32417/1/26-27/0009

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, PALWAL	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW ROAD FROM VILLAGE BHIDUKI TO VILLAGE BHAINDOLI RD 0.00 TO 2.30 KM HAVING CONSOLIDATION PATH MORE THAN 6 KARAM UNDER HODAL CONSTITUTION IN PALWAL DISTT. (WITHOUT GST)	07.11.2026 16.11.2026	237.81 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466219169 pwd-eepd-palwal@hry.nic.in
2	CONTROLLER, PRINTING & STATIONERY,DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANCHKULA	PURCHASE OF DELUXE DIARY, POCKET DIARY, VISITING CARD CASE & ORDINARY DIARY FOR THE YEAR 2027.	CLOSING DATE 07.12.2026	65 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9872020766 opbranch06@gmail.com
3	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (CAP. NITROFURANTOIN 100MG, TAB. RANITIDINE 150MG, SYP. ZINC 60ML ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	16.11.2026 23.11.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
4	ZILA PARISHAD, ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF COMMUNITY CENTER DHAMMAR + 1 WORKS	05.11.2026 12.11.2026	51.53 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01262254150 prexeeng.roh@hry.nic.in
5	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF THE MATERIAL FOR REPAIR OF 325 HP & 200 HP ATS STARTER AT PUMP HOUSE NO. 3 OF LOHARU CANAL UNDER JURISDICTION OF LWS (M) SUB DIVISION NO. 1, CHARKHI DADRI & 10 MORE WORKS	CLOSING DATE 20.11.2026	10.48 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, MANDI DABWALI	MANDI DABWALI STP:- PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION / REPLACEMENT OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRIC INSTALLATION AT 16.50 MLD STP MANDI DABWALI DISTT. SIRSA. CH. TO :- MANDI DABWALI:- ESTIMATE FOR REPLACEMENT/UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT`S AND ELECTRICAL ITEMS AT 16.50 MLD STP AT DABWALI TOWN DISTT. SIRSA	06.11.2026 25.11.2026	149.58 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8730000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com
7	DIRECTORATE OF STATE TRANSPORT HARYANA, CHANDIGARH	SHORT TERM TENDER NOTICE FOR PROCUREMENT OF NEW STEEL RADIAL TUBELESS TYRE OF SIZE 295/80R22.5-16PR, NEW NYLON TYRE SETS OF SIZE 7.50X16-16PR WITH TUBE AND FLAP AND NEW STEEL RADIAL TYRE SET OF SIZE 10.00R20-16PR WITH TUBE & FLAP FOR MEETING REQUIREMENT FOR THE BUSES OF HARYANA ROADWAYS FOR NEXT ONE YEAR.	11.11.2026 25.11.2026	29.52 CRORE	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01722709809 dtcstore22@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50914/HRY

Study: CO2 emissions from fossil fuels to decline this year

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, November 10



'Fossil of the Day' presentation at the COP31 U.N. Climate Summit, on Monday, that calls out countries they say fall short on climate action, in Antalya, Turkiye. AP

GLOBAL CARBON dioxide emissions from burning fossil fuels are projected to be slightly lower than 2025, in part because of supply shocks created by the US-Iran conflict and the growing footprint of renewable energy sources, reveals a new study by the Global Carbon Budget.

Released at the COP31 climate meeting in Antalya, Turkey, on Tuesday, the study said carbon dioxide emissions from fossil fuels in 2026 was expected to be 38.2 billion tonnes, 0.4% lower than the 38.4 billion tonnes measured for 2025.

India was the only major emitter whose fossil fuel emissions were expected to grow in 2026. The study said India's fossil fuel emissions in 2026 were likely to be 4.4% higher than the previous year, while China, the United States, European Union and Japan are expected to see declines, the study said. India's growth this year is higher than the 3.5% average annual growth it registered over the last one decade, it said.

While the small dip of 0.4% in global CO2 emissions might appear to be an encouraging signal from a climate change perspective, researchers behind the study clarified that it is most likely a short-term consequence of the ongoing conflict.

"A decline in fossil CO2 emissions is encouraging, but a reduction driven partly by geopolitical shocks is not a sustainable climate solution," said Professor Pierre Friedlingstein, director of the Global Carbon Budget Office at the University of Exeter, who led the study.

The expected marginal decline in CO2 emissions from fossil fuels this year would be the first since 2020, when the Covid19 pandemic had resulted in a 2% drop, the biggest year-on-year decline measured so far.

Similar small declines have been witnessed in 1992, 2009, 1981, 1974, and 1998, all associated with some kind of global churn that affected industrial activity and led to reduced fuel usage. Such reductions in fossil fuel emissions have remained single-year aberrations, caused by some temporary disruption, and have resumed on their upward trajectory after that.

"The long-term answer remains the rapid deployment of clean energy technologies. While renewables and electric vehicles are increasingly offsetting growth in energy demand, further acceleration is needed if global emissions are to peak and enter a sustained decline," he said. Besides, CO2 emissions from fossil fuels are only one, though dominant, part of the larger basket of greenhouse gas emissions which are responsible for causing global warming.

The overall emissions of greenhouse gases are still rising, as pointed out by the State of the Climate Report released on Monday.

That report, an annual publication of the World Meteorological Organisation, which, too, is released to coincide with the climate conference, said that the greenhouse gas emissions had touched a new high in 2025, and early indications for 2026 suggested that it would continue to increase this year as well.

Scientific assessments had found that the world needed to cut its annual greenhouse gas emissions by almost a half from 2019 levels by 2030 to give itself minimal chance to keep the rise in global temperatures within 1.5 degrees Celsius from pre-industrial times, a target defined in the Paris Agreement. The annual emissions are still rising and current projections show that even in the best case scenario, not more than 2% reduction in annual emissions would be achieved by 2030.

Kishor questions Brahmins' support to BJP, asks them to prioritise education over caste

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, November 10



Jan Suraaj founder and Bankipur MLA Prashant Kishor

JAN SURAAJ founder and Bankipur MLA Prashant Kishor has questioned Brahmins in Mithila over their support for the BJP, arguing that the community has weakened its influence by alienating Muslim voters who once backed its leaders.

Urging the audience to prioritise education over religious mobilisation, he said, "Your strength is the pen. Your strength is Saraswati. You are not people who wield axes."

The remarks came during Kishor's event addressing a Brahmin community in Mahinam village in Darbhanga, where he challenged the assumption that electing representatives from one's own caste would improve living conditions. He was responding to questions about his vision for health, education and employment, and a suggestion from locals that a Brahmin should be fielded from the area.

"Your MLA is already a Brahmin," Kishor said, adding that the community had held the seat for about 15 years and that the local MP was also a Brahmin. "If electing a Brahmin alone could solve your problems, you should not have suffered at all."

Kishor argued that Brahmin leaders had previously benefited from Muslim support, which, he claimed, had shifted elsewhere after sections of the community aligned with the BJP and abused Muslims on Facebook.

"You separated from yourself those who were calling you 'guruji' and putting you in office with their votes, by abusing them on Facebook and calling them Pakistani," he said, questioning whether any dispute over land, reservation or local communal violence justified that estrangement.

Invoking Parashuram, Kishor said the reference to wielding an axe belonged to a particular context and should not displace education. "If your child does not study, will wielding an axe fill their stomach?" He argued the community's historical standing came not merely from caste identity but from learning and concern for others.

Questioning descriptions of Mithila as a land of intellectuals, Kishor said his Padyatra through Darbhanga and Madhubani had revealed widespread dependence on migrant labour. Families with distinguished backgrounds and large parcels of land, he claimed, were seeking jobs paying Rs 20,000 a month for their children. Others depended on money sent home by relatives settled elsewhere.

His wider criticism centred on what he called political "bonded labour" – voting along caste or religious lines, or supporting the BJP out of fear of Lalu Prasad and vice versa. He argued assured support allowed parties to take voters for granted.

Kishor criticised Prime Minister Narendra Modi over Bihar's floods and contrasted promises of industry and infrastructure in Gujarat with train services that, he argued, facilitated migration from Bihar. He attacked Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary's leadership, while holding voters responsible for the representatives they elected.

Ahead of local-body and panchayat elections, he urged voters to choose honest candidates regardless of caste, religion or party, reject inducements and vote for their children's education and employment.

Fresh bomb threat linked to Diljit Dosanjh's Indore concert

Express News Service
Bhopal, November 10



Singer Diljit Dosanjh

A FRESH bomb "threat" linked to Punjabi singer Diljit Dosanjh's upcoming concert in Indore has prompted security agencies across Madhya Pradesh to step up vigilance. This comes after police received an alleged email on the official email ID of the Gwalior Bench of the Madhya Pradesh High Court threatening bomb blasts at the singer's upcoming concert, along with some other locations in Indore, Gwalior and Bhopal.

Dosanjh's concert is scheduled for November 15 at C-21 Ground in Indore as part of his ongoing Aura Tour. The latest threat comes barely a week after three private schools and the office of Indore Mayor Pushyamitra Bhargava received emails threatening bomb blasts in connection with Dosanjh's November 15 concert.

Police teams in all three cities are investigating, which reportedly mentioned several institutions, individuals and locations across the cities. With the latest communication reaching the HC's official email address, police are examining whether the threats are connected and attempting to establish sender's identity and location.

Amid the successive threats and speculation over the fate of the Indore concert, Dosanjh on Tuesday reassured fans during an Instagram Live session and said: "*15 tareekh ko Indore aa rahe hain, 101 per cent aa rahe hain! Sabse pehle aakar poha khaayenge, phir energy lekar fir chak de phatte* (101 per cent coming to Indore on 15th. The first thing I will do is eat Poha and then bring the energy and do the show)."

Confirming the receipt of the email, Robin Jain, DSP, Police Headquarters, said: "This email was received on the official website of the HC, which contained a threatening message regarding pop singer Diljit's upcoming programme in Indore, along with some remarks and the names of a few other organisations. Since security measures are already being taken by the police from a safety perspective... and because the email also mentioned some locations in Bhopal and Indore besides Gwalior, the police departments of those places are also working on it".

Jain said a separate team was investigating the email's origin and attempting to establish who sent it. Police are examining the digital trail, including the source of the communication, while reviewing security arrangements at the locations mentioned in the message. The threat reportedly warned of an improvised explosive device (IED) being planted at Dosanjh's stage. Security was strengthened around Gwalior HC premises and residences of the judges.

Preliminary findings reported by police suggest the IP address associated with communication is linked to a foreign network. Investigators are attempting to establish its origin and identify who is behind it.

Police direct auto-rickshaws in Srinagar to go transparent

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, November 10

IN A directive, Srinagar Traffic Police have asked auto rickshaws plying in city to remove their black hoods and replace them with transparent coverings. While the police have cited security reasons, the move has drawn concerns about privacy and financial burden on drivers.

Srinagar Senior Superintendent of Police (Traffic) Bisma Qazi said autorickshaw owners need to put up see-through sheets so that the interiors are visible from outside.

"We appeal to everyone that the black doors you have kept, the black cavities that you have made, you put transparent sheets instead," Qazi said while speaking to reporters during a drive to remove the doors of auto rickshaws. "From the security point of view, we conducted this drive today because we don't know what is going on behind them [the black coverings]."

SSP Qazi said they had doors of auto rickshaws removed during the drive.

"They (autorickshaw drivers) had an excuse that the weather has turned cold," she said. "We asked them to put transparent sheets so that they can see through and the inside (of the autorickshaw) is visible from outside."

Autorickshaw drivers say they are already facing challenges since government started operating e-buses in Srinagar.

"We barely live from hand to mouth," said an autorickshaw driver near Baghat Chowk. "We can't afford this extra burden... when the rickshaw remains transparent, people will hesitate to board it."

Ujjain makeover gets another Rs 950-crore infra boost with an eye on Simhastha 2028

Express News Service
Bhopal, November 10



Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav during the foundation stone-laying ceremony of various development projects ahead of Simhastha 2028, in Ujjain on Tuesday. ANI

LENDING EVEN more impetus to the Madhya Pradesh government's preparations for Simhastha 2028, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Tuesday launched development projects worth nearly Rs 950 crore to deck up the temple town of Ujjain, which is expected to host an estimated 40 crore visitors during the auspicious duodecennial event.

Chief among them is the redevelopment of the Angareshwar Mahadev Mandir in Ujjain, improvement of facilities at 84 Mahadev temples across the city, and the construction of approximately 50km of roads. Together, these, the Ujjain Development Authority said, will strengthen the city's religious and cultural heritage.

A sum of Rs 83 crores have been set aside for the Mandir's redevelopment into a more organised religious tourism destination. It will see the expansion of the temple premises, the construction of a dedicated waiting hall, shopping facilities, organised parking and other amenities.

The first phase of improvements at the Mahadev temple sites is estimated to cost about Rs 3.80 crore. It will include flooring, renovation and beautification of walls, necessary repairs, drinking water facilities, sheds and benches for devotees, toilets, lighting arrangements and improved pavements.

Road construction and widening projects account for nearly half of the total budget at Rs 495 crore. An additional Rs 370 crore has been earmarked to compensate farmers whose land will be acquired for the expansion. On Tuesday, Yadav launched the compensation process by distributing Rs 37 crore to 48 farmers. The improved connectivity is expected to greatly benefit pilgrims during the religious congregation with access to bathing ghats and other important destinations.

This string of development projects comes amid an even extensive infrastructure overhaul of Ujjain, with the state government approving 128 projects worth Rs 13,851 crore across 10 departments, all in preparation for Simhastha 2028. Among the biggest projects are the Rs 1,692-crore Ujjain-Indore six-lane project and a separate Rs 2,935-crore greenfield four-lane corridor between the two cities.

Another major project is the 98.73-km Ujjain-Jaora greenfield four-lane corridor, estimated to cost Rs 5,017 crore, which is expected to provide connectivity towards the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway and divert long-distance traffic away from Ujjain.

Along the Shipra, approximately 29.2 km of new ghats and associated infrastructure are being developed under a Rs 778-crore project. The government is also executing the Rs 919.94-crore Kanh closed-duct diversion project, involving a 30.15-km system, including a 12-km tunnel and an 18.15-km cut-and-cover section, to prevent polluted water from the Kanh river from entering the Shipra.

CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, HARYANA

एक और अवसर
हरियाणा SIR 2026

क्या प्रारूप मतदाता सूची में आपका नाम नहीं है?

अनुपस्थित, स्थानांतरित, मृत या दोहराव (ASDD) चिह्नित मतदाता भी अपना नाम अंतिम मतदाता सूची में जुड़वा सकते हैं।

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भारत निर्वाचन आयोग के पत्र सं. 23/INST/2025&ERS दिनांक 06.11.2026 के अनुसार

1 सूची देखें
कारण सहित ASDD सूचियां मतदान केंद्र, पंचायत भवन, शहरी निकाय व बीडीओ कार्यालय तथा CEO हरियाणा की वेबसाइट पर उपलब्ध हैं।

2 फॉर्म प्राप्त करें
बीएलओ घर आकर या व्हाट्सऐप (एसएमएस) ई-मेल से फॉर्म देंगे या पुराने EPIC नम्बर से voters.eci.gov.in / ECINET ऐप पर डाउनलोड करें।

3 ERO / AERO / बीएलओ को जमा करें

उसी पते पर रहते हैं
गणना प्रपत्र + अनुलग्नक-B
देरी का कारण बताएं। स्वयं, परिवार द्वारा या ECINET पर ई-साइन से ऑनलाइन जमा करें।

हरियाणा में ही पता बदला
गणना प्रपत्र + अनुलग्नक-C + पते का प्रमाण
फॉर्म-8 जरूरी नहीं। नए विधानसभा क्षेत्र के ERO / AERO को जमा करें।

फॉर्म-6 पहले ही भरा है
दोबारा आवेदन जरूरी नहीं
SIR के दौरान जमा फॉर्म-6 पर ही कार्यवाही होगी।

✓ फॉर्म स्वीकार होने पर वही पुराना EPIC नम्बर दोबारा मिलेगा।

बेघर हैं? बीएलओ की सत्यापन रिपोर्ट को ही पते का प्रमाण माना जाएगा।

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THE GANGA TAKES A PAUSE

For 18 days, with the Upper Ganga Canal shut for annual maintenance, in Haridwar, an army of sanitation workers and volunteers descended on the dried riverbed to clear it of silt and trash ahead of the Ardh Kumbh. VIDHEESHA KUNTAMALLA visited the ghats to see what it takes to clean the Ganga

PHOTOGRAPHS: GAJENDRA YADAV





(Clockwise from above) After the Upper Ganga Canal was reopened, the water returned to Har Ki Pauri at midnight on November 7; volunteers collecting trash from the dried riverbed; around 200 workers cleared the stretch over 18 days

WHEN THE Ganga recedes, Vijay's chances of finding a coin rises. On the exposed riverbed, beneath the towering Shiva statue near the Old Vishnu Ghat in Haridwar, the 20-year-old stands bent over, sifting through the silt with his fingers. He has been doing this since he was 10. A green paper plate beside him holds the brown, muddied coins he has found. Some mornings, the riverbed gives him a little money; on others, nothing.

"*Jab Ganga Maa chahti hai toh kuch paise de deti hai* (When the Ganga wishes, she gives me a little money)," says Vijay, a Class 7 dropout whose parents work as daily-wage labourers at a construction site.

Every year, the annual closure of the Upper Ganga Canal for maintenance leaves the riverbed at Haridwar dry and exposed for about 18 days, filling Vijay and other wastepickers with hopes of better earnings. It's also a brief 18-day window when authorities can clean around 10 km of the river stretch from Khadkadhi to Jwalapur, covering Har ki Pauri and its neighbouring ghats.

Eighteen days of an army of machines and around 200 men and women — municipal workers, volunteers, ashram inmates, and civic groups — working for about 12 hours daily, from 5 am until sundown, to clean what's considered the most sacred of rivers.

But this year, there is an added urgency. The 2027 Ardh Kumbh, held once every six years, kicks off in January, when millions of pilgrims will descend on these banks. As the devotees throng the steps leading to the river, they will make more offerings to the river, but before that, the riverbed has to be cleaned of what was left behind: red and saffron garments, plastic bags, footwear, flowers, coconut shells and the remains of countless rituals.

Municipal workers and volunteers collected around 150 metric tonnes of waste from the ghats, before the Upper Ganga Canal was reopened and the waters returned to Har Ki Pauri at midnight on November 7. During last year's cleaning exercise, they had collected around 70-80 metric tonnes of waste.

For the pilgrimage city of Haridwar, the Ganga is much more than a river that ebbs and flows. At the iconic Har Ki Pauri, said to be the point where the river enters the plains, the fast-flowing Ganga is the reason pilgrims arrive. It is the centre around which the town's religious life, economy and everyday rhythms have been built.

But the question is whether the river that is cleaned every year can be protected from the waste that keeps returning to it.

What the river leaves behind

On a Saturday afternoon, 10 days after the Upper Ganga Canal had been shut for maintenance, an army of municipal workers, volunteers and members of social and educational organisations, some of them in fluorescent yellow jackets, takes over the vast, exposed riverbed. After a few lumbering earthmovers scoop out the silt-covered ground, workers dig through the sludge to painstakingly retrieve layers of accumulated waste. Just as one patch is cleared, another reveals more trash. Tractors and JCBs ferry away enormous heaps of muck and discarded clothes to a designated point on the ghats for the municipality truck to pick them up.

Mahakal, a sanitation worker with the Haridwar Nagar Nigam, the city municipal corporation, has begun his day at 5 am. Every day for 18 days of the clean-up, the 50-year-old, dressed in a fluorescent reflective vest, gloves and boots, would work until 2 pm, fishing out shreds of cloth, plastic and other waste from the riverbed. Every year, he says, the cycle is familiar: the waste is removed, the water returns, and much of the same material accumulates again.

To Mahakal, the Ganga's plight feels personal. "Every year the waste keeps increasing. *Log bas Ganga maa ko takleef pahunchate hai* (People keep burdening the Ganga every year)," he says.

Heera Vallabh Pant, who is associated with the Shri Bhuvneshwari Mahila Ashram at Har ki Pauri, says discarded clothes and footwear form a substantial part of what volunteers collect. "Leaving behind clothes worn during a ritual bath is believed to be a way of shedding impurities or washing away sins. But what is an act of spiritual cleansing for one person becomes waste for someone else to remove," says Pant.

During the Kanwar Yatra between July and August, Pant says, around 70 metric tonnes of clothes and footwear were collected from the ghats. "But this year's cleaning operation was more intensive than in previous years," he says.

Ahead of the 2027 Ardh Kumbh, the National Mission for Clean Ganga (NMCG), a Central government initiative to check pollution and rejuvenate the Ganga, has approved a Rs 115.61-crore sanitation and waste-management plan for Haridwar. The Municipal Corporation, in a first, is planning to deploy floating conveyor belts to intercept debris at key points along the Ganga, the Amarpura Ghat and Jatwara bridge, to collect waste.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Haridwar Municipal Commissioner Nandan Kumar says, "These conveyor belts can only intercept floating debris. They cannot remove dissolved pollutants... their effectiveness will depend on how regularly they are cleared and how the collected waste is disposed of."

For those who have spent their lives around the ghats, however, the problem is measured not just in tonnes, but in the distance between the river and the people who have built their lives around it. The ghats remain crowded with shrines, shops and places for rituals, but the water no longer reaches the steps the way some older residents remember.

Tarun Sharma, 42, a priest at the temple near the Old Vishnu Ghat, says he has heard older generations describe a time when the river flowed much closer. "The cleaning has been carried out for generations. The river has given people a lot; in turn all it gets is filth. Around 50-60 years ago, the water would reach the entrance of the temple. I have heard it from my father, he was a priest at this temple before me... If Ganga ji is not here, how will we survive, how will devotees come?"

When the barrage gates shut

The annual reduction in water at Har Ki Pauri is linked to the maintenance of the Upper Ganga Canal, which carries water from the Ganga to parts of Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh and beyond through a 400-km network. The region between the Ganga and Yamuna rivers depends on water from the canal network for drinking and irrigation. Every year, after the monsoon, the canal is temporarily closed so the silt deposited along its bed can be removed and repairs carried out.

At Haridwar, the process is controlled at the Bhimgoda Barrage, about a kilometre from Har Ki Pauri. Water from the Pashulok Barrage near Rishikesh, about 17 km upstream, reaches Bhimgoda, where some of the water is directed into the channels supplying Har Ki Pauri and the wider canal network. The remaining water passes downstream through the main river channel towards Bijnor and Kanpur, ultimately flowing into the Bay of Bengal.

Harish Prasad, a junior engineer with the Uttar Pradesh Irrigation Department that controls the flow into the Upper Ganga Canal, explains that during the annual closure, the department shuts the gates of the channels leading towards Har Ki Pauri and lifts the gates of the Bhimgoda Barrage. Water arriving from the Pashulok Barrage in Rishikesh then passes through the barrage downstream into the main river channel.

The Upper Ganga Canal system that supplies to Haridwar is generally closed around midnight on Dussehra and reopened around midnight on Chhoti Diwali. This year, the closure began on the night of October 20–21, and water returned to Haridwar at midnight on November 7.

Even during the closure, however, water has to be made available for the evening Ganga Aarti at Har Ki Pauri. Officials, who monitor how much water has reached the ghat, lift the barrage gates once the required level is achieved. "This process takes around one to one-and-a-half hours. Around 2-3 feet of water is required at Har Ki Pauri for the ritual," says Prasad.

He said that while there were demands from Haridwar to extend the closure — given the mammoth cleaning task at hand ahead of the Ardh Kumbh — the Irrigation Department couldn't have kept the gates shut for long. Around 16 districts downstream in Uttar Pradesh, including Firozabad, Agra, Muzaffarnagar, Ghaziabad, Prayagraj and Kanpur, among others, depend on water from the canal for drinking and irrigation.

"Every year, when the flow is stopped at the Bhimgoda Barrage, these areas do not receive fresh water through the canal, eventually leading to a shortage of water supply in these 16 districts," he says.

'We are battling small fires'

Despite the annual cleaning exercise along the length of the canal system, those working to rejuvenate the Ganga say a cleaner canal may not be an indicator of the health of the larger river system.

That's because, they point out, the water that flows through Har ki Pauri is controlled and supplied through the canal system.

Shailendra Kumar Kumre, a scientist at the National Institute of Hydrology in Roorkee, says, "Har Ki Pauri receives water from this canal. It is not a separate natural river channel in the way people might imagine. Historically, the Ganga may have occupied a much wider floodplain in this area, but as the region developed, its course became more confined."

The distinction between the canal-fed stretch at Har Ki Pauri and the main river channel has long been contentious in Haridwar. In 2016, the state government classified the stretch as an "escape channel" of the Ganga Canal, triggering protests from priests, saints and religious groups who argued that it undermined the sacred identity of Har Ki Pauri. The order was revoked in December 2020 following sustained opposition.

Scientists say given the burden on the ghats, a lot more than visible cleaning of the river needs to be undertaken.

An audit of the Namami Gange programme in Uttarakhand, carried out by the Comptroller and Auditor General between 2018 and 2023, found that the total coliform count at Har Ki Pauri rose fivefold, from 26 MPN/100 mL (Most Probable Number per 100 milliliters) in October 2014 to 130 MPN/100 mL in October 2023, indicating rising contamination from human and animal waste.

The audit also found that Haridwar's water quality remained in Category B throughout 2018-2023, a classification that makes it suitable "only for organised outdoor bathing". It found that 12 of 37 sewage treatment plants physically inspected were discharging untreated sewage into the Ganga and its tributaries.

Anoop Nautiyal, an environmental activist in Dehradun, says, "We are battling small fires, but we are not looking at issues in totality."

He argues that river conservation has placed disproportionate emphasis on "hardware" (sewage treatment plants, drains, ghats and other infrastructure) while neglecting the "software" (public participation, behavioural change and preventing waste from entering the river in the first place).

Ruchi Badola, Dean and Scientist at the Wildlife Institute of India (WII) and Principal Investigator of the NMCG–WII Jalaj Project, Dehradun, says, "Diverting a substantial quantity of water from the Ganga for 18 days may alter the river's depth, water velocity, habitat conditions and ecological connectivity...Reduced water flow may also influence dissolved oxygen levels and sediment transport, which, in turn, can bring changes to the overall river ecosystem."

Back in Haridwar, around early evening, the ghats come alive — loudspeakers advertising restaurants and hotels, the toll of temple bells and the chatter of pilgrims.

Further along, at Old Vishnu Ghat, 60-year-old Savita Devi sits on a cot outside her shop, where she sells snacks and water bottles. The shop is an extension of the home Savita and her husband built three decades ago. From here, they have watched the Ganga, and the life around it, change over the years.

As her husband does a small puja, offering water to the Ganga before the start of the day's business, Savita looks out at the workers on the riverbed.

"Every year, we see more and more tractors trying to clean the Ganga. But the river keeps getting worse and we can't do anything about it. Ganga *pe bahut bojh daal rahe hain* (We are placing too much of a burden on the Ganga), but the river can no longer bear it," she says.

Savita has seen the water recede over the years, and with it her fortunes. "Fewer pilgrims have been coming these days, except for the Kanwar Yatra...Most pilgrims are now going to Varanasi. We are now waiting for the Ardh Kumbh so that our business picks up," she says.

Vijay is back on the riverbed after his lunch break. He has managed to collect a hundred Re 1 coins. "I'll now try and sell them, take a rickshaw home for Rs 20, and sleep. I have to wake up early and come back here," he says.

How the river flows

- The 400-km Upper Ganga Canal irrigates the Doab region between Ganga and Yamuna
- The canal starts in Haridwar at the Bhimgoda Barrage, whose gates control the flow of the Ganga
- From Bhimgoda, 3 channels carry the water towards Har ki Pauri, a km away
- The remaining water flows downstream to Bijnor



150
metric tonnes of waste removed from the ghats around Har Ki Pauri

ENERGY STORAGE SYSTEMS STORE SURPLUS ELECTRICITY AND DISCHARGE IT WHEN DEMAND RISES

Discoms' finances emerge as key concern amid energy storage push

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, November 10

AS THE government works on a mandate requiring electricity distribution utilities (Discoms) to add energy storage capacity, concerns are emerging over the ability of financially stressed discoms to shoulder the additional investment burden, given their already stretched finances and limited capacity to fund new infrastructure.

While the specific storage capacity that utilities will be required to procure has not yet been finalised, the proposed mandate is understood to be at an early stage of formulation.

The development comes as energy storage systems are becoming vital as India scales up its renewable energy capacity.

However, the growing share of intermittent renewable sources such as solar and wind is posing a challenge for the power system: generation is often abundant during certain hours but insufficient to meet demand at other times.

Energy storage systems can address this mismatch by storing surplus electricity when renewable generation is high and releasing it when demand rises or generation from these sources falls.

The government has already proposed making battery storage mandatory for all new government solar and wind power projects from July 2027.

Govt mandate raises concerns

Most state-owned utilities continue to incur losses and rely on borrowings to fund operating shortfalls and accumulated liabilities. Public sector DISCOMs have accumulated losses of Rs 6.77 lakh crore and borrowings of Rs 7.11 lakh crore.

Their already strained financial position also affects their borrowing costs, with lenders charging higher interest rates from utilities with weaker financial health.

Additional borrowing to finance energy storage infrastructure could further increase debt-servicing burden. Anoop Singh, Founder and Coordinator of Centre for Energy Regulation and Energy Analytics Lab at IIT Kanpur, said energy storage systems (ESS), either in hybrid mode or on a standalone basis, have become indispensable with increasing share of renewables in Indian grid.

He said while the Ministry of Power in July 2022 had outlined an Energy Storage Obligation (ESO) trajectory, envisaging the requirement to increase from 1% of total electricity consumption in financial year (FY) 2023-24 to 4% by FY29-30, subsequent notifications excluded any mention of ESO.

"The choice between capex and opex model is guided by the competitive cost discovery and operational risk hedging for discoms," he said, adding that implementing such a mandate through capital expenditure (capex) route could be challenging for discoms, given their already strained financial situation. "Procurement of energy storage services through competitive bidding, for example through SECI (Solar Energy Corporation of India Ltd), may be more economical as such aggregated bids would ensure scale and cost competitiveness for DISCOMs," he said. Singh maintained that further studies can help assess the need for such storage requirements that may vary across states.

"Apart from grid-level storage requirements, growing deployment of rooftop solar would also necessitate Distribution Energy Storage Systems or the Community Energy Storage Systems to be implemented by the discoms," he added. Satyendra Nath Kalita, Director of Policy and Regulatory Affairs at the All India Discoms Association (AIDA), said the government should avoid prescribing a uniform storage mandate for all DISCOMs, as electricity demand patterns and storage requirements vary across states.

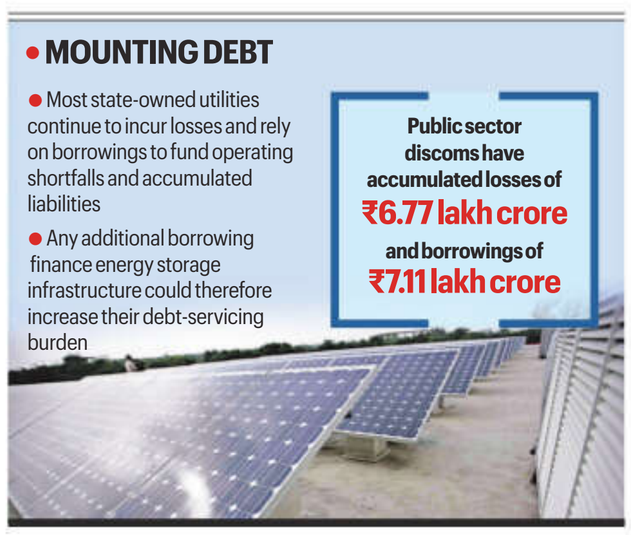
"Requirements are not the same for all discoms, so it should not be a fixed percentage or a blanket requirement. Demand patterns differ from state to state. Any such requirement should be determined after due diligence by the respective State Electricity Regulatory Commissions," he said.

Queries sent to the Ministry of power did not elicit a response till press time. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

MOUNTING DEBT

- Most state-owned utilities continue to incur losses and rely on borrowings to fund operating shortfalls and accumulated liabilities
- Any additional borrowing finance energy storage infrastructure could therefore increase their debt-servicing burden

Public sector discoms have accumulated losses of ₹6.77 lakh crore and borrowings of ₹7.11 lakh crore



DEATH OF 3 WORKERS AT TATA ELECTRONICS HOSUR PLANT

Why Apple's India supply chain challenges are back in focus

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, November 10

THREE CONTRACT workers have died at a Tata Electronics factory in Tamil Nadu's Hosur, which manufactures critical components for Apple's iPhones, bringing renewed scrutiny on the safety and operational challenges facing the American technology giant's rapidly expanding manufacturing ecosystem in India.

The deaths come at a time when Apple has successfully diversified a major portion of its manufacturing away from China, with India now accounting for around a quarter of all iPhones produced globally.

However, the expansion has not been without setbacks. From fires and worker protests to allegations of environmental violations, employment discrimination and a major cybersecurity breach, Apple's contract manufacturers have faced a series of challenges over the last few years.

Why India has become important for Apple

Apple began assembling iPhones in India in 2017, with a focus on older models.

But its manufacturing operations have expanded in recent years, led by the company's efforts to reduce dependence on China amid growing geopolitical tensions and supply chain disruptions, and subsidies offered by the government under its Production Linked Incentive scheme for smartphone manufacturing.

India accounts for roughly 25% of global iPhone production, with its manufacturing ecosystem increasingly handling newer and sophisticated models. Taiwan's Foxconn and Tata Group are Apple's main manufacturing partners in India, with Tata accounting for around 40% of domestic iPhone assembly and Foxconn making up the remainder.

Tata has emerged as a crucial player after acquiring Indian operations of Taiwanese manufacturer Wistron in 2023 and later taking control of Pegatron's Indian iPhone manufacturing business. Its Hosur operations are significant because they manufacture precision-engineered metal casings and back panels used in iPhones, representing an attempt to deepen local value addition rather than merely assembling devices from imported components.

The challenges

The workers' deaths are the latest in a string of incidents that involve Tata's Hosur operations.

In June 2026, a ransomware attack on a Tata Electronics iPhone assembly facility in Hosur resulted in the leaking of over 200,000 files on the dark web. The stolen information included confidential supplier details, component specifications and photographs relating to the then-unreleased iPhone 18 Pro. The breach was concerning because Apple's supply chain operates under strict confidentiality arrangements, with information on unreleased products, suppliers and component designs closely guarded.

Following the incident, Tata restricted internal access to sensitive systems and engaged a global consultant to conduct a forensic investigation, *Reuters* reported.

Around the same time, Tata's Hosur components facility also faced regulatory scrutiny over allegations of groundwater contamination. The Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB) warned the company that its factory could face closure over allegations that wastewater discharged from the facility had contaminated nearby agricultural land and wells. TNPCB had conducted multiple inspections after complaints from local farmers.

However, Tata later said the regulator had accepted its explanations, dropping further action. Disputing its findings, the company said fresh water sample analyses did not indicate contamination and the facility was compliant with applicable environmental standards.

In 2024, Foxconn faced allegations that it had systematically excluded married women from assembly-line jobs at its iPhone factory in Sriperumbudur, Tamil Nadu. A *Reuters* probe prompted scrutiny from Union Labour Ministry and the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC). In January 2025, NHRC criticised labour officials for inadequately investigating the allegations. However, a subsequent government investigation cleared Foxconn of wrongdoing.

Foxconn also instructed its recruitment agents to remove age, gender and marital-status criteria from job advertisements after the controversy.

Earlier, in September 2024, a major fire at Tata's Hosur facility, reportedly originating in an area used to store chemicals, had forced the temporary suspension of iPhone component manufacturing. The incident was significant because the facility was then a key domestic supplier of iPhone back panels.

In September 2023, Taiwan's Pegatron temporarily suspended iPhone assembly at its Chennai facility following a fire. Earlier that year, another Apple supplier, Foxlink, which manufactured iPhone chargers, halted production at its Andhra Pradesh factory after a fire caused part of the building to collapse.

In December 2021, Foxconn's factory near Chennai was shut for over three weeks after around 250 workers fell ill, triggering protests over living conditions and food safety. Apple subsequently found that the facility did not meet its required standards. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Blackstone to acquire 16% stake in IIFL Finance for Rs 5,000 crore

George Mathew
Mumbai, November 10

BLACKSTONE, THE world's largest alternative asset manager, will acquire an approximately 16% stake in IIFL Finance for Rs 5,000 crore as part of a Rs 6,414-crore primary equity infusion into the listed non-banking financial company (NBFC), marking one of the largest private equity investments in an Indian listed NBFC.

The investment is part of a larger capital-raising exercise involving the company's promoters, Nirmal Jain and R Venkataraman, who will invest Rs 1,264 crore, while Anchorage Capital will contribute Rs 150 crore. The entire investment will be infused as fresh capital into the company.

The board of IIFL Finance approved the transaction on Tuesday through a preferential issue.

Blackstone will invest through compulsorily convertible preference shares (CCPS), which will convert into equity shares at Rs 602 apiece within 18 months of allotment. The promoters will subscribe to preferential warrants.

IIFL Finance has a market capitalisation of Rs 26,746 crore.

The capital infusion will substantially strengthen IIFL Finance's balance sheet, raising its capital adequacy ratio from around 17% to approximately 30% on a proforma basis as of September 2026. The stronger capital base is expected to support business expansion, potentially improve credit ratings and reduce borrowing costs over time. For Blackstone, the investment provides an entry into a large retail lending platform in India's fast-growing non-banking finance sector.

IIFL plans to deploy the capital to expand its secured lending businesses, particularly gold finance, which has emerged as a significant segment of the retail credit market.

The company expects to leverage Blackstone's global network and operational expertise in technology, data analytics and artificial intelligence to strengthen its lending operations, improve risk management and deepen co-lending partnerships with banks.

Blackstone representatives are also proposed to join the company's board, which is expected to strengthen governance standards and oversight. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RAISING THE STAKES

THE CAPITAL infusion will strengthen IIFL Finance's balance sheet, raising its capital adequacy ratio from around 17% to approximately 30% on a proforma basis as of September 2026.

THE STRONGER capital base will support business expansion, improve credit ratings and reduce borrowing costs over time.

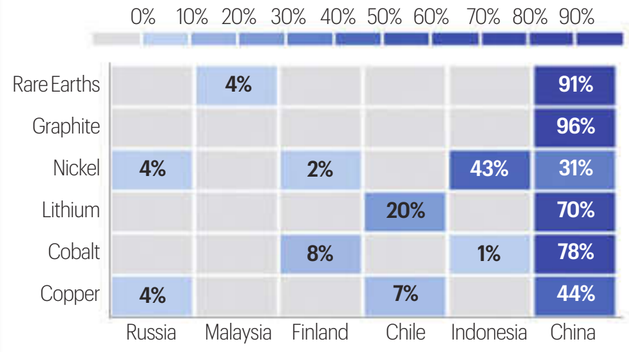
FOR BLACKSTONE, the investment provides an entry into a large retail lending platform in India's fast-growing non-banking finance sector.

China's critical minerals stranglehold

- The battle for natural resources is not new. But in the age of electrification and artificial intelligence, the fight is decidedly one-sided and squarely in favour of China. And while the world's second-largest economy is not home to the required critical minerals, it is overwhelmingly dominant in processing them.



Country share (%) of global refining in each mineral (2024)



- Companies and governments, as per Moody's Ratings, are now more willing to balance costs against the benefits of resilience, as has been the case when it comes to critical minerals and other strategic inputs. Securing them "now comes with a growing price tag" which is putting pressure on profit margins, balance sheets, and public finances.
- "Several developments in 2027 will test that balance, including the review of the US-Mexico-Canada Agreement, maturing export-control regimes covering critical minerals and rare earths, and energy trade routes reshaped by disruption in the Middle East," Moody's said.

SOURCE: MOODY'S RATINGS

Banks seek relief from RBI before rollout of Expected Credit Loss

Christina Titus
Mumbai, November 10

WITH LESS than five months to go before the proposed implementation of the expected credit loss (ECL) framework, banks have approached the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) seeking relief from the requirement to revalue their held-to-maturity (HTM) investment portfolios. The concern is that elevated bond yields could translate into substantial one-time valuation losses and erode capital.

The yield on benchmark 10-year government bond rose to 7.48% in October, driven by higher crude oil prices, rising US yields and expectations of further interest rate hikes. It has since eased to 7.15% on Monday, but remains above the 6.75% recorded at the end of June.

Lenders have sought either a deferment of the framework's implementation for investment portfolios or an alternative accounting treatment that would spare them from recognising mark-to-market losses, people familiar with the discussions told *FE*. They have also questioned the rationale for the proposed change.

The ECL framework, scheduled to come into effect from April 1, 2027, will replace the existing incurred-loss provisioning model with a forward-looking approach to recognising potential credit losses.

Under the proposed framework, banks will have to adopt the effective interest rate method and value their HTM portfolios at fair value as on March 31, 2027. The difference between the existing carrying value and the fair value will be adjusted through reserves, with possible implications for capital.

The fair-value adjustment, however, will be a one-time exercise. Banks will not be required to undertake subsequent mark-to-market valuation of their HTM portfolios. **FE**

Qualcomm begins India layoffs, 1,000 jobs at risk

Poulomi Chatterjee
Bengaluru, November 10

QUALCOMM HAS begun laying off employees in India, with around 1,000 or more jobs potentially at risk as the US-based chipmaker undertakes global workforce restructuring. The first round of job cuts began at its Bengaluru facility Monday, days after the company initiated layoffs in US, with the exercise expected to be carried out in phases across its operations.

People familiar with the matter said global restructuring could affect around 7% of Qualcomm's 52,000-strong workforce. With approximately 20,000 employees in India, the country could account for arou-nd 1,000 job losses or slightly more, based on a similar proportion.

"At a similar ratio, layoffs in India can be estimated at around 1,000 employees or a little higher than that," Pareekh Jain, CEO and lead analyst at EIIRTrend, told *FE*.

Another round of job cuts is expected in January, analysts said. The layoffs are significant given the scale of Qualcomm's engineering and research operations in India, which constitute its largest engineering base outside US. The exercise is broad-based, affecting both senior engineers and recent hires. Some employees who have been asked to leave have reportedly said they received no prior performance feedback, despite the company describing the exercise as performance-driven.

Qualcomm CEO Cristiano Amon had informed employees about the restructuring in an internal memo in October, describing it as a performance-focused reduction. **FE**

Small investors' body to SEBI: Restore Castrol open offer price

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, November 10

THE SMALL Investors' Welfare Association (SIREN) has approached the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), challenging the deduction of Rs 11.50 per share from the enhanced open offer price for Castrol India Ltd, arguing that the adjustment is contrary to the investor-protection provisions of the SEBI Takeover Regulations.

In a representation dated November 9, the association has sought restoration of the open offer price to Rs 210.95 per share from the revised price of Rs 199.45.

It has argued that the deduction towards dividends paid by Castrol India should not be permitted as the total intervening dividend of Rs 11.50 does not exceed the prescribed threshold under Regulation 8(9) of the SEBI Substantial Acquisition of Shares and Takeovers (SAST) Regulations, 2011.

The representation relates to the open offer by Motion JVCo Ltd and persons acting in concert with it. The initial public announcement, dated December 24, 2025, had disclosed an offer price of Rs 194.04 per share, which was subsequently enhanced by 10%, taking it to Rs 210.95.

However, the detailed public statement issued on November 6, 2026, reduced the price by Rs 11.50 towards dividend adjustment, bringing the offer price to Rs 199.45.

SIREN's principal argument is that the three financial years preceding the public announcement should be interpreted with reference to the financial years to which dividends pertain, rather than the calendar dates on which they were actually paid.

Since Castrol India's financial year (FY) follows the calendar year, the relevant three financial years preceding the December 24, 2025 announcement are FY22, FY23 and FY24.

According to the association, dividends attributable to these three years were Rs 6.50, Rs 7.50 and Rs 13 per share, respectively. This works out to an aggregate of Rs 27 and a three-year average of Rs 9 per share. The 150% threshold under the regulations would therefore be Rs 13.50.

Against this threshold, the intervening dividends of Rs 11.50 — comprising a final dividend of Rs 5.25 relating to FY25 and an interim dividend of Rs 6.25 relating to FY26 — do not qualify for deduction, it has argued.

CORNERSTONE INVESTORS INCLUDE GOOGLE, NVIDIA AND AMD

Anthropic sets modest $1 tn IPO valuation target

Reuters
Bengaluru, November 10

ANTHROPIC IS targeting a valuation of up to $1.02 trillion in its landmark US IPO, its filing showed on Tuesday, well short of the previously discussed amount in the latest sign of cooling investor appetite for AI.

The AI lab and some of its investors are aiming to raise up to $64.4 billion by selling 825 million shares in the IPO in an indicative price band of between $70 and $78 per share.

Reuters had exclusively reported on Tuesday details of Anthropic's blockbuster deal. Some prospective investors have questioned whether Anthropic's previously discussed $1.5 trillion valuation was too high, particularly given the company's substantial infrastructure commitments and the recent volatility in AI-related stocks.

At one point this year, investors expected the IPO to take place in October and to seek a valuation as high as $2 trillion. The company is launching the roadshow for a historic share sale that is expected to set a benchmark for the sector, following years of hype that fueled a massive influx of capital into AI companies.

Details of the blockbuster deal were briefly circulated to investment banks before being retracted late on Monday, according to emails seen by *Reuters*.



Anthropic will raise $26 bn via private placement deal. REUTERS

The second half of the year has brought a reckoning for the AI boom, as investors question whether returns will justify the massive spending and mounting debt costs in an elevated interest-rate environment.

Concerns are also rising over the sustainability of the investment cycle, with questions around circular financing arrangements, the risk of infrastructure overcapacity and how quickly companies can turn their AI investments into revenue.

The tech-dominated Nasdaq notched its deepest one-day drop in 19 months on Thursday, wiping out trillions in market value on fears of more AI scrutiny, particularly on data center construction, after Democrats' massive gains in the US midterm elections.

Greater oversight and potential regulatory hurdles could complicate the infrastructure buildout underpinning the AI boom. But Anthropic's growth has so far defied those concerns, propelled by surging demand for its products, particularly its viral Claude models.

Its filing spoke of a vision to "bring forth an age of miracles," even as it warned of existential risks to humanity, laying bare the extraordinary promise and profound uncertainties at the heart of the AI boom.

Anthropic will also raise $26 billion via a separate private placement deal with cornerstone investors including Alphabet's Google, Nvidia, Advanced Micro Devices .

BRIEFLY

Unemployment declines slightly to 5.1% in Jul-Sept

New Delhi: The unemployment rate for persons aged 15 years and above improved marginally to 5.1% in the July-September period from 5.2% a year ago, said the Periodic Labour Force Survey released on Tuesday. As per the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), the unemployment rate (UR) or joblessness rate was 5.4% in the April-June quarter this year. PTI

Adani Group to invest $120 bn over next 5 years

Bengaluru: The Adani Group plans to invest more than $120 billion in capital expenditure over the next five years across its core infrastructure businesses and emerging growth platforms, its executives told *Fortune India* in an interview Tuesday. Adani Group has been expanding aggressively across infrastructure and energy, with investments spanning ports, airports, power, renewables and other sectors. PTI

'Two-member US team visits India for trade talks'

New Delhi: A two-member team of US officials visited India this month for talks on trade and customs facilitation issues, an official said on Tuesday. The official said both sides are in regular touch on the trade pact. India and the US have finalised the framework for the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement in February. However, changes in the tariff landscape have led to further negotiations on the agreement. PTI

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explained@indianexpress.com

• LEGAL

OBC reservation: What determines creamy layer status

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, November 10

THE SUPREME Court on Friday reaffirmed its March judgment which held that the "creamy layer" status of Other Backward Classes (OBCs) cannot be decided solely on the basis of parental income from salary.

Creamy layer is a term used in India's reservation system to describe wealthier, more advanced members of OBCs. Those included in the creamy layer are not entitled to OBC reservation benefits. Here's how the concept of a creamy layer came about, how its criteria was decided and modified, and what the Supreme Court's March verdict changed.

Evolution of the creamy layer criteria

The concept of a creamy layer within the OBCs was introduced following the landmark 1992 Supreme Court ruling in *Indra Sawhney vs Union of India*.

In September 1993, the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) issued an office memorandum (OM) specifying the criteria for identifying persons who fall within the OBC creamy layer and, thus, are not entitled to reservation. These included: persons occupying constitutional posts; Group-A/Class-I officers of All India Services, Central services and state services; Group-B/Class-II services of Centre and state; employees of public sector undertakings (PSUs); Armed Forces officers; professionals and those from trade and industry; property owners; and an income/wealth test.

The OM also excluded income from salary and agricultural land from the income/wealth test.

But a 2004 clarification by the DoPT said the salary income of employees in PSUs and the private sector would indeed be a criterion in cases where "equivalence" of posts in public sector undertakings, banks and public employment had not been determined. If the salaries crossed the prescribed limit for three consecutive years, the children would fall within the creamy layer.

This began to be applied rigorously from the CSE-2015 (corresponding to the 2016 batch).

What the Supreme Court said in March

In March, in a case arising from that 1993 OM, the court held that salary income could not, by itself, be the basis for excluding children of those employed in public sector undertakings and the private sector from OBC reservation benefits. The court also settled the long-pending question of equivalence between PSUs and private sector employees and those in the government sector — saying treating children of PSU and private employees differently from those of government servants in similar posts amounted to "hostile discrimination".

On the 2004 clarification by the DoPT, the SC said a clarificatory letter "cannot introduce a substantive condition that does not exist in the parent policy".

The court then directed the Centre to implement these principles within six months and create supernumerary posts as required for candidates who satisfy the non-creamy layer criteria.

What the Supreme Court said now

The result of CSE 2025 was declared five days before the March verdict. The Centre told the Supreme Court that a retrospective implementation of its ruling would unsettle concluded selections and service allocations, including those made in respect of earlier CSE.

The court observed that the interpretation of the 1993 OM and the 2004 letter and the "rejection of mechanical exclusion based on salary income" were not open for reconsideration and said that miscellaneous applications cannot be used as "a ruse to secure reconsideration of the merits of the judgment".

The court also said the Centre's application proceeded on an "erroneous assumption" that the benefit operated retrospectively. The six-month deadline in the verdict applied to considering the claims of the respondents and was not a general exercise for all recruitment years.

The bench said that all selections, appointments, and roster allotments will follow the 1993 OM as the March verdict interpreted — that is, a clarificatory letter such as the 2004 one cannot override the OM. Where equivalence of posts has not been established, the children of PSU and private-sector employees must be assessed under the income/wealth test which excludes salary income. And income from salary cannot be the sole criterion — the status and category of the parent's post are also essential.

• CLIMATE CHANGE

Why a floundering COP still matters

Little of consequence is expected from this year's COP in Turkey, just like in previous years. Yet, it remains key to seek climate accountability



AMITABH SINHA

THE ANNUAL United Nations Climate Change Conference, or COP31, this year comes amid a troubling reality check.

According to two reports released by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) earlier this year, the window of opportunity to limit global warming to 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels is firmly shut now. The best the world can now hope for, the reports say, is to restrict the temperature rise to 1.7-1.8°C. This is the first time that any scientific assessment of climate change has made such an assertion.

One might have therefore expected the COP31 climate conference, which began in the Turkish city of Antalya on Monday (and runs till November 20), to focus on finding ways to put the world back on track. However, the conference is unlikely to deliver any outcome that can be considered a breakthrough on this front.

The 1.5°C target did not suddenly become unattainable this year. It was always a difficult target, and years of inadequate climate action have finally led scientists to conclude that it can no longer be achieved. No outcome from COP31, however ambitious, can reopen that window of opportunity.

Delinked from reality

In terms of expected outcome and impact, COP31 could turn out to be one of the most inconsequential COPs (Conference of the Parties) in recent years, though not because of any shortcoming of its own.

COPs, in general, have always underperformed. These annual year-ending two-week conferences, which attracted the largest gatherings of global leaders until not so long ago, have only produced low-ambition outcomes. In the last two decades, its most important success has been finalising the 2015 Paris Agreement, which defined the climate targets and framed the broad rules for international climate action.

But COPs have had a poor record in convincing the member countries — virtually the entire world till the US decided to walk out — to do enough to achieve those targets. COPs take decisions only through consensus, and there is no way to force laggard nations to do more.

The result has been a widening gap between what is required to achieve the targets set in the Paris Agreement and the actions actually taken by individual countries. The gap has grown so large that COPs no longer seem interested in even pretending to catch up. Any outcome that enables incremental progress towards reducing greenhouse gas emissions, and prevents further backsliding, is now considered a good outcome.

By this metric, the success of COP31 would rest on being able to build on the decisions taken in past COPs, particularly in Brazil last year, to keep pushing for decarbonisation and energy transition.

Not irrelevant

Despite this poor record, it would be a mistake to conclude that COPs have become entirely irrelevant.

There is no denying that it is this very process of international climate negotiations under the UN framework that has put the world on a path of decarbonisation, however slow the progress might have been. The accelerating adoption of renewable energy, and the thousands of climate actions being taken by a variety of actors around the world, both state and non-state, can also be attributed to this process. Many of these actions also offer a range of collateral benefits, including energy security, poverty reduction, improved livelihoods, pollution reduction, and improved food security.

Climate change has largely disappeared from the agendas of other major global and regional forums, thanks to multiple wars, rapidly evolving technological threats, and new demands for energy use. COPs remain the only major global stage that continues to focus on climate change.

They are still the only forum where developing countries can demand greater accountability from the developed world, which bears the primary responsibility for addressing climate change. Nepal was recently allocated $20 million from the newly-established Loss and Damage Fund for recovery and reconstruction efforts after the devastating flash floods in August. While the allocated sum is only a fraction of what Nepal needs to rebuild after the disaster, there is no other international forum where it could have demanded and received this kind of funding without any strings attached and within a short span of time. There is also a possibility that Nepal could receive more money from the Fund.

That is why countries see merit in continuing with this COP process, despite its threat of irrelevance and possible disintegration, following the withdrawal of the US from the Paris Agreement and the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change.

Reality check

Most countries appear to have reconciled with the reality that not just the 1.5°C, but even the 2°C, target might be breached in the coming decades, unless some really unexpected technology intervention takes place.

The 1.5 degree and 2°C targets were arbitrarily chosen temperature limits with no intrinsic value behind their choice. The climate impacts were evident even at 1.2°C warming, though there is no denying that the severity and frequency of extreme climate events have steadily increased with the continued rise in temperatures.

It could be argued that the temperature targets set in Paris were too ambitious to start with. The actions necessary to achieve them were never consistent with the political and economic realities of the world and the competitive nature of international coexistence. Achieving these goals was predicated heavily on an appeal to the moral force and good conscience of the countries. The concerns of the developing countries, particularly their need for rapid economic growth, were never adequately accounted for.

This tension was evident even when the Paris Agreement was being finalised. The Agreement was hailed as a major breakthrough for climate action. The unflattering reality, however, was that developed nations had succeeded in freeing themselves from the responsibilities placed on them by the 1997 Kyoto Protocol.

In the last few years, countries have increasingly begun to drop the pretence that they are actively pursuing the temperature targets of the Paris Agreement. They are now preparing themselves to deal with the impacts of climate change, rather than chase a temperature target that has never been within reach. At the same time, it is important for the countries to make sure that they give up only targets, not climate action itself.

Gap between plans and reality

COPs have had a poor record in convincing member countries to do enough to achieve climate targets.

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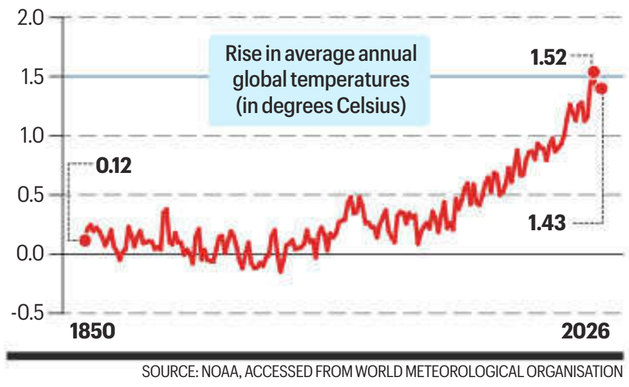
These summits take decisions only through consensus, and there is no way to force laggard nations to do more.

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The result has been a widening gap between what is required to achieve the targets set in the Paris Agreement and the actions actually taken by individual countries.

• A CLIMATE BREACH POINT LOOMS

The world is locked on the course to overshoot the 1.5°C climate target



SOURCE: NOAA, ACCESSED FROM WORLD METEOROLOGICAL ORGANISATION

Antalya agenda: Climate funds, energy transition



EXPERT EXPLAINS

INDU K MURTHY

HEAD OF CLIMATE, ENVIRONMENT AND SUSTAINABILITY SECTOR AT CENTER FOR STUDY OF SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND POLICY

THE 31ST Conference of the Parties (COP31) to the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) began in Turkey's Antalya on Monday.

As the first COP since the US's exit from the Paris Agreement earlier this year, COP31 removes the largest historical emitter from finance conversations, sharpening developing countries' demand that Europe and others fill the gap. Energy security, meanwhile, has taken centre stage. The war on Iran has pushed up oil and gas prices, raising the cost of fuel and food. Supporters of a faster energy transition argue that this shows the risks of fossil-fuel dependence, while importers such as India face more immediate pressure to keep supplies affordable.

India goes to Antalya with a central seat at the table, co-chairing mitigation consultations along with Germany.

The questions that matter are how much finance will actually flow to developing countries, how adaptation will be measured and paid for, and whether mounting pressure on coal and emission targets will respect the principle of "common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities"

What is COP?

A COP is the annual meeting of countries that signed the 1992 UNFCCC. In Antalya, there will be three meetings in focus: COP31, the 21st session of the Conference of Parties serving as the meeting of Parties to the Kyoto Protocol (CMP21), and the 8th session of the Conference of the Parties serving as the meeting of Parties to the 2015 Paris Agreement (CMA8).

The Paris Agreement asks every country to submit a nationally determined contribution (NDC), essentially its own climate plan, every five years, with the shared ambition of holding warming well below 2°C while pursuing efforts to limit it to 1.5°C. Because decisions require consensus, a single country can hold up an agreement.

How is COP31 different from previous COPs?

COP venues rotate among the UN's regional groups, and 2026 was the turn of the "Western European and Others" group to host. Turkey bid with Antalya, and Australia bid with Adelaide, in partnership with Pacific Island nations. The standoff led to an unusual power-sharing deal last year, making COP31 the first summit where one country hosts the meeting while another runs the negotiations.

Turkey is the formal COP31 president and host, responsible for the venue, logistics and the "Action Agenda" of voluntary pledges and initiatives. Australia has "exclusive authority" over formal talks, drafting of texts and steering decisions. This dual leadership model is untested, and questions remain about who would have the final word if there were disagreement in the closing hours.

What's on the table?

COP31 is not expected to produce a landmark treaty text. The real fight is over delivery: mobilising finance, measuring progress and accelerating the energy shift.

In terms of co-chairing consultations, India and Germany must decide on mitigation, as in how to press countries whose 2035 plans fall short of 1.5°C and what "transitioning away from fossil fuels" actually requires. On finance, France and the Philippines will work to build consensus on delivering existing finance commitments. On adaptation, the UK and Sierra Leone must chart a credible path to tripling adaptation finance and make enough headway for the Global Goal on Adaptation (GGA) to be finalised at COP32.

Taking on newer ground, Mexico and Poland must work out how the just transition mechanism will function and what money and technical help it will give affected workers and communities. Palau and Canada handle the ocean, where Pacific Island countries want commitments written into formal decisions.

Two more items will set the summit's tone. Turkey wants countries to pledge to raise electricity's share of global final energy use from about 23% today to 35% by 2035. Further, developing countries, including India, have pushed to include Article 9.1 of the Paris Agreement, the clause that obligates developed countries to provide finance, in the provisional agenda.

What Belém left behind

COP30 in Belém, Brazil, closed with a package called the "Global Mutirão" (meaning, collective effort) and Antalya inherits this "to-do" list. It called for adaptation finance to be at least tripled by 2035, five years later than developing countries had wanted and without a clear baseline.

More broadly, it endorsed the Baku-to-Belém Roadmap to scale climate finance for developing countries to at least $1.3 trillion a year by 2035 from public and private sources, building on the $300 billion-a-year goal agreed at COP29 in Baku (Azerbaijan). It adopted a set of "Belém indicators" to measure progress on the GGA, created new vehicles for delivery, namely a Global Implementation Accelerator and a "Belém Mission to 1.5" to help countries carry out their plans, alongside work on a just transition mechanism.

The most conspicuous gap concerned fossil fuels. More than 80 countries backed a roadmap to move away from oil, coal, and gas, yet the final text left fossil fuels out entirely, referring only to the 2023 Dubai "UAE Consensus". Brazil is now steering a voluntary roadmap process outside the formal talks, and Colombia and the Netherlands have initiated the Santa Marta process — an international, plurilateral climate initiative complementing the COP process launched in Santa Marta, Colombia — in April 2026 to identify pathways for the phase-out.

Ultimately, Antalya will be judged less on headline pledges and more on whether the promises of Paris, Baku, and Belém translate into meaningful action.

• COP31: 5 key challenges

- **THE FIRST** is finance, and whether developed countries put numbers and a timeline behind tripling adaptation finance and give the $1.3-trillion roadmap a monitoring system.
- **THE SECOND** is fossil fuels, and whether the negotiated text will include a transition away from them.
- **THE THIRD** is Turkey's electrification pledge, specifically how many countries sign on to the '35%-by-2035' target.
- **THE FOURTH** is the split presidency itself — the real stress test of a model that future COPs may copy.
- **THE FIFTH** is the Global South bargain, and whether India and other developing countries secure the Article 9.1 discussion and finance reforms in return for engaging on mitigation.

• TECH

The 'key man' risk for Nvidia after Huang spy saga, with Tesla as a case study

Anil Sasi
New Delhi, November 10

NVIDIA CEO Jensen Huang's extramarital affair with an alleged Chinese spy is yet another reminder of a growing concern among big businesses on Wall Street — "the key man risk".

Simply put, it refers to the potential impact of losing a key employee, typically a founder or influential CEO, whose contribution is critical to business success. Some business owners see the company's reliance on them as a badge of honour, and Huang, a key figure in the artificial intelligence revolution, pretty much fits the bill.

A close adviser to US President Donald Trump, Huang has consistently spoken out against regulating the industry so as not to let China gain the upper hand in the AI race. He has campaigned for selling advanced Nvidia chips to China, arguing it would make the country dependent on US technology.

Bernstein analyst Stacy Rasgon warned that the latest revelations "highlight the considerable key man risk that NVIDIA faces", while Mohamed El-Erian, the Rene M Kern Prof of Practice at Wharton, similarly said that it was doubtful if markets had adequately priced this risk in.

Difficult time for Nvidia

The scandal comes at a moment when the AI trade is on shaky ground, with a brutal industry-wide valuation slide underway after the US midterms.

The risks for Nvidia are heightened since the chipmaker increasingly resembles a family firm: Huang's children hold senior executive positions, and he is the larger-than-life brand mascot in a purely business-to-business operation.

If the AI race were a gold rush, Nvidia is currently the one selling most of the shovels. The rise of AI has made Nvidia one of the world's most valuable companies. Nvidia's GPUs, built for gaming consoles but serendipitously proving useful in AI server stacks, have become central to running sophisticated large language models.



Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang. AP

In that sense, Nvidia was seen as relatively insulated from the larger AI monetisation risk that the large language model developers face. But a lot rests on Huang, and the big question mark is whether he will be forced to step down, with the FBI now investigating the case.

The US government is said to have begun surveilling the Chinese operative more than a year ago, when it first believed her employer, the Singapore-registered data centre firm Megaspeed, was illegally smuggling Nvidia's Graphics Processing Units (GPUs) into China. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio reportedly readied a confidential note warning officials about Huang's involvement.

Huang's consistent position on selling Nvidia chips to China likely preceded his meeting with the alleged spy. But his positions will undoubtedly come under fresh scrutiny.

Case of Tesla

Ideally, no business of scale, especially with public shareholders, should be overly reliant on a single person. When a key figure running operations is seen as disproportionately contributing to a company's success, the inherent risks associated with this key man are seen as posing a fundamental threat to the business. If this individual were to suddenly leave, the company could flounder, both operationally and financially.

The key man risk is visible across the US corporate world. Would Tesla perform as well if Elon Musk quit? Or would Meta adapt to Mark Zuckerberg leaving? Systemically important companies are increasingly and overwhelmingly dominated by key men.

It came into stark focus this year when Tesla chief Elon Musk, the world's richest man, bulldozed the automaker's board into approving a record-breaking pay package, possibly worth up to $1 trillion. The Tesla board's counterargument has been that Musk might leave the company otherwise, and it could not afford to lose him.

The episode highlighted how a company seeing one figure as indispensable can then be milked for personal gain. Musk had built a self-propagated assertion that the company simply could not do without him, and has threatened resignations in the past. The payout was predicated on Musk drastically raising the electric car firm's market value over the next decade to $8.5 trillion from under $2 trillion, among other promises.

Unlike Huang's track record at Nvidia, how Musk has run Tesla in recent years does not exactly inspire confidence, with him overpromising and underdelivering.

For instance, Musk promised to deliver driverless taxis in many US cities, secure regulatory clearances in Europe for self-driving software and raise sales by around 30%. Instead, his 'driverless' robotaxis are restricted to just Austin and San Francisco, and have human safety professionals. European regulators have yet to give their approval, while Tesla sales continue to plunge across markets, including China and Germany.

Many investors supported the pay package, including New York-based Baron Capital Management, whose founder Ron Baron termed him "indispensable" to Tesla. Critics include the biggest US public pension fund, CalPERS, and Norway's sovereign wealth fund. Even the Vatican weighed in, admonishing wealth inequality globally and flagging the pay package in particular. "If that is the only thing that has value anymore, then we're in big trouble," Pope Leo said.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,ARCHANABEN UPADHYAY,W/O-ROOPAK GANGA PRASAD UPADHYAYA,R/O-RUDHAI PRATHAM,BSKSHI KA TALAB,LUCKNOW,UTTAR PRADESH-227202,have changed my name to ARCHANA ROOPAK UPADHYAY. 0040888365-4

I, Susitesh Rai, S/o Shri Krishna Nand Rai, resident of 280, Ground Floor, Lotus Villas Society, Sector-I, Greater Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P.-203202, have changed my name from Susitesh Kumar Rai to Susitesh Rai. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Ansh Chopra for all future purposes. 0040888342-1

I,KRISHNA PRASHANT PARJANE,S/O-PRASHANT DATTATRAYA PARJANE,H.NO.325 SECTOR-15 PART-1 NEAR-COMMUNITY-CENTRE GURGAON,HARYANA-122001.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KRISHNA JAIN. 0040888374-1

I,NAVEEN KUMAR,S/O-JAI PAL SINGH,Address-A-002,RAHEJA ATHRAVA,SEC-109, BAJGHERA, GURGAON, HARYANA-122017,have changed my name to NAVEEN KUMAR GAHLAWAT. 0040888364-8

I,Kishor Kumar S/o Kumarsen Goyal R/o 53, Bashant Veiiy,Budh Bihar, Baharampur,Ghaziabad have changed my name to Kishori Lal Goyal. 0040888364-1

I,Parveen,W/o Sharif Ahmed,R/o-4-C DDA Flats Mata Sundri Road,New Delhi-110002,has changed my name to Praveen,for all purpose. 0040888374-3

I,MANARA W/O.SHAN MOHAMMAD R/O.736,BAZAR SUIWALAN, CHITLI QABAR,DELHI-6.HAVE CHANGED/CORRECTED MY NAME FROM MONOWARA KHATUN TO MANARA,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040888364-10

I,Meenu Sharma D/O S C Sharma R/O B-61, Prashant Vihar,Rohini,Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Meenu Agnihotri for all future purposes. 0040888365-8

I,Raghuvir Singh,S/O Ram singh,Add C-9-B,D.D.A JANTA FLATS, RAGHUBIR-NAGAR.WEST DELHI-27,Have changed my name to Raghubir Singh,for all purpose in future 0040888364-3

I,JAI SINGH GAUR,S/O SHAKTI SINGH, R/O S505,VVIP ADDRESSES,RAJ NAGAR EXTENSON, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201017,have changed my name to JAI SINGH. 0040888365-1

I,Mukesh S/o Vishnu Dutt Sharma R/o H.No.B-101, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201011, have changed my name to Mukesh Sharma. 0040888374-5

I, Brajesh Kumar S/o Fakir Chand,R/o- A-2/300, Block-A-2,Nand Nagri,Delhi-110093,have changed my name to Brajesh Kumar Chauhan for all future purposes. 0040888340-1

I,ARSH SINGH,S/O VEER BABRU VAHAN,R/O-A-901,ANTRIKSH GREENS APATMENT,AHINSA-KHAND-2 INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH,have changed my name to ARSH KUMAR SINGH,for all future purpose. 0040888365-10

I,RUBY,W/O-JAVED KHAN,R/O-B-81,FOURTH-FLOOR FLAT.NO-8, THOKAR.NO-7,SHAHEEN-BAGH JAMIA-NAGAR DELHI-110025,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO RUBY PARVEEN,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040888364-5

I,ROOPAKBHAI UPADHYAYA,S/O GANGA PRASAD UPADHYAYA,R/O RUDHAI PRATHAM,BSKSHI KA TALAB,LUCKNOW,UTTAR PRADESH- 227202,have changed my name to ROOPAK GANGAPRASAD UPADHYAYA. 0040888365-3

I,SUMIT GOYEL,S/O,SATY PRAKASH GOYEL,R/O-NYADER GANJ RADHEY LAL JAIPRAKASH OLD-ANAJ MANDI,DADRI-GAUTAM BUDH-NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH-203207,have changed my name to SUMIT GOEL. 0040888365-6

I, KULVINDER SINGH KHIR, S/o Sh.SURJIT SINGH KHIR, R/o-28/5 Ashok-Nagar,Behind Police-Station Tilak-Nagar, New Delhi-110018, hereby declare that my name has been wrongly written as KULVINDER SINGH in 10th-Class Certificate of my daughter namely AVNEET KAUR, whereas my correct & actual-name is KULVINDER SINGH KHIR, which shall be treated as final for all future purposes. 0040888374-7

I,Puja Kumari,D/o-IC/Army No.13969602P Rank NK Name Late.Sripal Singh,R/o-Kutub-Vihar Ph-1,E-Block,Gali.No-36,Goyala-Dairy,New Delhi-110071,have changed my name from Puja Kumari to Pooja,for all purposes vide-Public,Notary-Delhi,affidavit dt-18-08-2026. 0040888365-12

I, Asma W/o Mr. Mohd Nauman R/o House No. 532/4, Ladhha Sarai, Near Qutub Minar, Mehrauli, South Delhi, Delhi-110030 have changed my name from Asma Nauman to Asma for all purposes in future 0040888306-1

I,PARDEEP KUMAR PRAKASH,S/O-PREM PRAKASH,R/O-W E-13, MOHAN-GARDEN,UTTAM NAGAR,Uttam Nagar,PO:D.k Mohan-Garden, DIST:West Delhi-110059,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO Pradeep Kumar. 0040888364-7

I,KAMINI GOYEL,W/O-SUMIT GOEL,R/O-RADHEY LAL JAIPRAKASH OLD-ANAJ MANDI,NYADER-GANJ DADRI GAUTAM BUDH-NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH-203207,have changed my name to KAMINI GOEL. 0040888365-5

I, Mahender Singh Rana,S/o Jeet Singh Rana,R/o-H.No.621, Gali No-1,Shiv Colony, Pall.No-1, Amar Nagar,P.O-Amar Nagar,District-Faridabad, Haryana-121003,have changed my name Mahender Singh to Mahender Singh Rana, for all purposes. 0040888352-1

I,Muhammad Sufiyan,S/o Ali Shan,R/o-3220 Phatak Teliyan Turkman Gate Delhi,has changed my name to Mohammad Sufian,for all purpose. 0040888374-2

I, Mohd Sabir, S/o Mohd Aadil Khan, R/o A/16, Dujana House, Matia Mahal, Jama Masjid, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Mohd Sabir Khan, for all purposes. 0040888299-1

I,JAMILUDDIN,S/O.KHAIRATI,R/O.M-16,DDA-FLATS TURKMAN GATE-ASAF ALI ROAD DELHI-6.HAVE CHANGED/CORRECTED MY NAME,FROM JAMEEL AHMED TO JAMILUDDIN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040888364-9

I,Deepak Kumar S/o Rajendra Sharma,R/o-Flat No.2055,Sector-C,Pocket-2,Vasant Kunj,New Delhi-110070,have change,my name,from Deepak Kumar to Deepak Sharma for,all future purposes. 0040888365-7

I,Indra devdas,S/O Sita ram R/o-129 om nagar mithapur-ext jaitpur,new delhi have Changed My Name to Indradev for all future purposes. 0040888364-2

I,Pankaj Budiraja S/o Prem Kumar R/o NP-43 B Pitampura Delhi-110034.have change my name to Pankaj Budhiraja Permanentely. 0040888374-4

I,BHAVYA MOHAN,D/O-SAMRESH MOHAN,R/O-C-2/707,MILAN VIHAR-APARTMENT, PLOT.NO.72,IP EXTENSION, DELHI-110092,HAVE CHANGED MY SURNAME IS MOHAN AND GIVEN NAME IS BHAVYA. 0040888364-11

I,Elvis Presley Sharon,W/O Harpreet Singh,R/0 DDA-LIG Flat No-635, Pocket-13, Phase-1,Dwarka,Manglapuri, South-West Delhi-110045, Have Changed My Name To Sharon Lazarus. 0040888365-9

I,Gita Devi,W/O Inderdev Das,R/o-129 om nagar mithapur ext jaitpur,new delhi,have Changed My Name to Geeta devi for all future purposes. 0040888364-4

I SARITA GAUR,W/O JAI SINGH,R/O S505, VVIP ADDRESSES,RAJ NAGAR EXTENSON,GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH-201017,have changed my name to SARITA GOND. 0040888365-2

I, Sadeeqa Parveen W/o Aurangzeb Khan R/o I-13, Block-I, Thokar-No.4, Abul-Fazal Enclave-I, Jamia-Nagar, Okhla,New Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Saddeeqa Parveen. 0040888374-6

I,BABRU VAHAN SINGH,S/O-PRATAP SINGH,R/O-A-901,ANTRIKSH GREENS-APATMENT,AHINSA KHAND-2 INDIRAPURAM,GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH,have changed my name to VEER BABRU VAHAN,for all future purposes. 0040888365-11

I,KM POONAM GAUTAM,W/O-SIDHARTH KUMAR,R/O-F-1154,GAUR SIDDHARTHAM SOCIETY SIDHARTH-VIHAR VIJAY-NAGAR GHAZIABAD U.P.201009,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO POONAM GAUTAM,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0040888364-6

I Hitender Kumar S/o Ram Niwas Sharma R/o Bahu Jholri Distt.Jhajjar informs that in my son Yathesth Kumar Jangra passport my name is wrongly mentioned as Hitender instead of Hitender Kumar. That both the name Hitender and Hitender Kumar belongs to one and same person. 0040888365-14

LOST & FOUND

Kamlesh Sharma, LT Laxman Sharma (Husband), RZ-49A, Gali-24, Vashisht Park, Pankha Road, New Delhi-110046. I am the owner/allottee of Plot No. RZ-49A, Gali-24, Vashisht Park, Pankha Road, New Delhi-110046. I have lost the above property original documents, could not be found. If any person found so further no misused please inform above address (Mobile- 9891312398) 0040888316-1

I, Ashish Jain, R/o C-12, Sector 50, Noida, 201301. wish to inform that the buyer agreement for my Plot No. A-7/8, DLF Ankur Vihar has been lost. If anyone finds this document, please contact me at the address mentioned above. 0040888306-2

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page
The Indian EXPRESS JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

RE:- PLOT NO. 114 BLOCK NO. C (C-114) SUSHANT LOK PHASE -1, GURUGRAM, HARYANA hereinafter referred to as SAID PLOT

Notice is hereby given to the general public including banks, financial institutions etc. that my client intend to purchase the said plot from the owners **SANJAY RAJORIA S/O SHRI K.B.RAJORIA AND MRS. UMA RAJORIA W/O SHRI K.B. RAJORIA** both Residents of **B-25, Greater Kailash Enclave-2, New Delhi-110048** (Jointly hereinafter called the Seller).

The seller has informed my client that they are the owners of above said plot by virtue of Sale deed duly executed in their favour by Ansal Properties & Industries Ltd. (Now known as Ansal Properties and Infrastructure Ltd.) 115, Ansal Bhawan, 16, Kasturba Gandhi Marg, New Delhi-110001 duly registered in the office of Sub-Registrar, Gurugram at VASIKA NO. 3461 DATED 05.06.1998 as document No. 3461 Addl. Book No. 1 Vol. No. 5559 on pages 94-98.

The seller further informed my client that the said plot is not mortgaged anywhere and there is no charge or dispute or any litigation pending regarding the said Plot.

Any person including Bank/s, Financial institution/s, relative/s any claim, right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the aforesaid plot is hereby called upon to make the same known in writing with documentary evidence by Registered AD post to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within 15 days of publication of this notice and in the event no response having been received to the notice, the title of the seller to the said plot shall be deemed to be clear of any charge or encumbrances of any nature whatsoever and any subsequent claim shall not bind our client/purchaser, in any manner whatsoever.

AMIT GARG, Advocate
30/192, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar-IV, New Delhi
Em: amitgarg93@yahoo.com
Mobile No. +91-9810175534

EAST COAST RAILWAY

e-Tender Notice No. EPC-CECON IIBBS2026038, Dated : 03.11.2026

NAME OF WORK : CONSTRUCTION OF FLYOVER BETWEEN SIJU AND PARADEEP COACHING YARD TO AVOID SURFACE CROSSING OF TRAINS ALONG WITH CONSTRUCTION OF ADDITIONAL TWO LOOP LINES (R4 & R5) FOR AM / NS SIDING INCLUDING ELECTRIFICATION WORKS AND SHIFTING OF UTILITIES, SIGNALING CABLES AND EQUIPMENT BUT EXCLUDING SIGNALING & TELECOMMUNICATION WORKS.

Approx. Cost of the Work : ₹ 9794.00 Lakh, **EMD :** ₹ 1,95,88,000/-, **Completion Period of the Work :** 730 (Seven hundred thirty) Days.

Tender Closing Date & Time : At 1700 hrs. of 05.01.2027.

No manual offers sent by Post / Courier / Fax or in person shall be accepted against such e-tenders even if these are submitted on firm's letter head and receive in time. All such manual offers shall be considered invalid and shall be rejected summarily without any consideration.

Complete information including e-tender documents of the above e-tender is available in website : **www.ireps.gov.in**

Note : The prospective tenderers are advised to revisit the website 15 (Fifteen) days before the date of closing of tender to note any changes / corrigenda issued for this tender. The tenderers/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate and must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-tendering.

The tenderers should read all instructions to the tenderers carefully and ensure compliance of all instructions.

Chief Administrative Officer (Con)/ Bhubaneswar

PR-242/CJ/26-27

TAMILNADU MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Government of Tamilnadu Undertaking)

No. 417, Pantheon Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008. Phone: 044-2819 1890, 2819 0259
Website: www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in E-Mail: gmdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in, mngrpurdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in

Online Tenders is invited by the Tender Inviting Authority, Tamilnadu Medical Services Corporation Ltd., Chennai – 600008, from the bidders meeting the eligibility criteria indicated in the tender document for the supply of **Emicizumab Injection** to TNMSC Ltd under rate contract system for one year from the date of acceptance of the tender.

Sl. No.	Description	e-Tender Reference	Tender Floating Period	e-Tender Submission Duration	Date and time of online opening of Technical Bids
1.	Online Tender for the supply of **Emicizumab Injection** to TNMSC Limited under rate contract system for one year from the date of acceptance	e-027/M(P)/ EMIZ-INJ/ TNMSC/2026, Dated 11.11.2026	11.11.2026 at 4.00 PM to 26.11.2026 upto 3.00 PM	16.11.2026 at 10.00 AM to 26.11.2026 upto 3.00 PM	26.11.2026 at 4.00 PM

The tender document can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at **https://tntenders.gov.in/**. The tender document can also be downloaded at **www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in** for reference purpose.

Tender Inviting Authority / General Manager (Drugs)

DIPR/3483/Tender/2026

बिहार सरकार

शिक्षा विभाग

आवश्यक सूचना

प्रवेशिकोत्तर छात्रवृत्ति योजना 2026–27 के अन्तर्गत आवेदन आमंत्रित करने के संबंध में।

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि "अनुसूचित जाति प्रवेशिकोत्तर छात्रवृत्ति योजना" एवं "अनुसूचित जनजाति प्रवेशिकोत्तर छात्रवृत्ति योजना", "मुख्यमंत्री अनुसूचित जाति एवं अनुसूचित जनजाति प्रवेशिकोत्तर छात्रवृत्ति योजना" एवं "मुख्यमंत्री पिछड़ा वर्ग एवं अति पिछड़ा वर्ग प्रवेशिकोत्तर छात्रवृत्ति योजना" के अन्तर्गत शैक्षणिक वर्ष 2026–27 हेतु PMS पोर्टल (अनुसूचित जाति एवं अनुसूचित जनजाति वर्ग के छात्र/छात्राओं के लिए https://scstpmsonline.bihar.gov.in, पिछड़ा वर्ग एवं अति पिछडा वर्ग के छात्र/छात्राओं के लिए https://pmsonline.bihar.gov.in एवं संबंधित शैक्षणिक संस्थानो के लिए https://instpmsonline.bihar.gov.in) के माध्यम से ऑनलाईन आवेदन आमंत्रित करने हेतु दिनांक–15.07.2026 से दिनांक–30.09.2026 तक खोला गया था।

शैक्षणिक संस्थानों में विलंब से नामांकन, परीक्षाफल घोषित किए जाने तथा अन्य कारणों से आवेदन करने से वंचित रहने वाले छात्र–छात्राओं के लिए PMS पोर्टल दिनांक– 12.11.2026 से दिनांक–30.11.2026 तक पुनः खोला जा रहा है।

सभी इच्छुक अभ्यर्थी यथाशीघ्र अपने आवेदन का पंजीकरण एवं Finalization करना सुनिश्चित करें।

ऑनलाईन आवेदन करने से संबंधित विस्तृत दिशा–निर्देश PMS पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध है।

निदेशक (माध्यमिक शिक्षा)
बिहार, पटना

PR. No. 015333 (Education) 2026-27

उक्त सूचना **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

अगर मन में हो एच.आई.वी. अथवा यौन जनित रोग से जुड़े सवाल तो तुरन्त 1097 पर करें कॉल।

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 14.12.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 14.12.2026 - DEHRADUN DISTRICT - DEHRADUN-GANDHI ROAD: 4086001729, 4086001786, 4086001836, 4086001841, 4086001859, 4086001865, 4086001918, 4086001936, 4086001958, 4086001960, 4086001988, 4086002044, 4086002048, 4086002136, 4086002182, 4086002226, 4086002236, 4086002237, 4086002245, 4086002289, 4086002343, 4086002355, 4086002362, 4086002366, 4086002367, 4086002393, 4086002430, 4086002433, 4086002437, 4086002438, 4086002450, 4086002478, 4086002516, 4086002535, 4086002543, 4086002546, 4086002580, 4086002609, 4086002633, 4086003418, 4086003419, 4086003420, 4086003425. **VIKAS NAGAR - DEHRADUN:** 4575000014, 4575000027, 4575000048, 4575000098, 4575000142, 4575000172, 4575000194, 4575000217, 4575000237, 4575000288, 4575000290, 4575000310. **Auction Date: 14.12.2026 - HARIDWAR DISTRICT - GANESHPUR -ROORKIE:** 4591000008, 4591000009, 4591000010, 4591000026, 4591000053, 4591000064, 4591000065, 4591000067, 4591000094, 4591000117, 4591000139, 4591000214, 4591000461, 4591000511, 4591000717. **JWALAPUR-HARIDWAR:** 2981002198, 2981002251, 2981002404, 2981002408, 2981002414, 2981002417, 2981002433, 2981002453, 2981002481, 2981002498, 2981002510, 2981002515, 2981002541, 2981002561, 2981002563, 2981002564, 2981002592, 2981002595, 2981002614, 2981002628, 2981002634, 2981002654, 2981002681, 2981002705, 2981002736, 2981002743, 2981002760, 2981002765, 2981002774, 2981002782, 2981002830, 2981002889, 2981003040, 2981003062, 2981003083, 2981003093, 2981003094, 2981003101, 2981003103, 2981003135, 2981003137, 2981003146, 2981003151, 2981003152, 2981003177, 2981003178, 2981003181, 2981003227, 2981003234, 2981003247, 2981003310, 2981003320, 2981003334, 2981003340, 2981003392, 2981003448, 2981003478, 2981003536, 2981003552, 2981003553, 2981003559, 2981003565, 2981003571, 2981003578, 2981003579, 2981003605, 2981003606, 2981003610, 2981003650, 2981004791, 2981004817, 2981004844, 2981004845, 2981004846. **MANGLAUR:** 4605000010, 4605000020, 4605000024, 4605000081. **Auction Date: 14.12.2026 - RISHIKESH DISTRICT - RISHIKESH:** 4566000044, 4566000064, 4566000074, 4566000102, 4566000231, 4566000265, 4566000274, 4566000280, 4566000296, 4566000320. **Auction Date: 14.12.2026 - ROORKEE DISTRICT - RAMNAGAR CHOWK-ROORKEE:** 2827002305, 2827002331, 2827002573, 2827002614, 2827002788, 2827002803, 2827002892, 2827003039, 2827003040, 2827003128, 2827003178, 2827003240, 2827003531, 2827003559, 2827003613, 2827003615, 2827003627, 2827003629, 2827003660, 2827003673, 2827003724, 2827004335, 2827005025, 2827005160, 2827005167.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 24.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at ROORKEE DISTRICT - RAMNAGAR CHOWK-ROORKEE: GROUND FLOOR, HOTEL HARIDEV , 1526, DEHRADUN ROAD, NEARSIDDHARTH HOTEL , ROORKEE, UTTRAKHAND , 247667 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

LABOUR RESOURCES & MIGRANT WORKERS WELFARE DEPARTMENT

Govt. of Bihar

B Wing, 3rd Floor, Niyojan Bhawan,, Near Income Tax Golamber, Patna - 800001
Email ID: **lcbihar@bihar.gov.in**

Notice Inviting Request For Proposal

Labour Resources and Migrant workers Welfare Department invites REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) for "**Selection of System Integrator for Design, Development, Implementation, Operation, and Maintenance of the Child Labour Tracking System (CLTS) for the Department of Labour Resources & Migrant Workers Welfare, Government of Bihar** under a Two-Bid System: Technical and Financial bid from eligible bidders. Please note the following data sheet.

SN	Activity	Date/Time: Duration
1.	Online Sale/Download date of RFP document	**From 10.11.2026, 11:00 Hrs** (https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
2.	Last Date of sending pre-bid queries by e-mail	**Date-17.11.2026 up to 18.00 Hrs**. to email ID: **lcbihar@bihar.gov.in**
3	EMD, Tender Fee and Tender Processing Fee	1) EMD (Refundable): Rs 10,00,000/- (Rupees Ten lakh only) in online form/Bank Guarantee. 2) Tender Fee (Non -refundable): Rs 5900/ - (Rupees Five Thousand and Nine Hundred Only) through online mode only. 3) Tender Processing Fee (Non -refundable): Rs 1180/ - or an amount reflecting on eproc2 portal through online mode only.
4.	Date, Time and Place of Pre-Bid Meeting	**Pre-bid meeting will be held on 18.11.2026 at 3:00 PM** at Manthan Hall, B Wing, 1 st Floor, Niyojan Bhawan, Near Income Tax Golamber, Patna – 800001
5.	Publishing of Pre-Bid queries response	Will be published on best effort basis at e-Proc2 website/Deptt website.
6.	Last Date/Time for download/submission/ uploading of offer/Bid	**Date- 07.12.2026 up to 18.00 Hrs. (https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)**
7.	Date & time for opening of Technical Bid	**On or after 09.12.2026 post 15:00 Hrs. (https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)**
8.	Date and time for Technical Presentation and demonstration.	Date and time for Tech nical Presentation and demonstration shall be communicated later through email only.
9	Method of Selection	Quality & Cost Based Selection (QCBS)
10.	Bid Proposal Validity	180 days from the last date of proposal submission.
11.	Contact details for queries	Email: lcbihar@bihar.gov.in

Note: LRMWWD reserves the right to change the conditions or cancel the tendering process at any stage without assigning any reason thereof. Please visit the portal regularly for the same.

Labour Commissioner Patna, Bihar

PR. No. 015274 (LRD) 2026-27

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

रक्त की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रक्त प्राप्त करें।

JHARKHAND STATE FACULTY DEVELOPMENT ACADEMY

(CIN: U85500JH2025NPL024352)
Regd. Office: - 1st and 2nd Floor, JCSTI Coordination Building, JUT Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum, Ranchi 834101, Jharkhand | Email- jsfda2025@gmail.com

Letter No:- JSFDA/Estb.-02/2025/327 **Ranchi, Dated:-05.11.2026**

Ref PR No: 391162

Extension of the Deputation Notice

In continuation of the Deputation Notice issued vide Letter No. JSFDA/estb-02/2025-264 dated 28-09-2026, applications were invited from eligible candidates for the various deputation based post in the **Jharkhand State Faculty Development Academy (JSFDA).**

It is hereby informed that the last date for submission of applications for the **post of Joint Director is being extended up to 15-11-2026.**

Interested candidates may submit their application in online through the official recruitment portal of JSFDA i.e. recruitment.jsfda.ac.in.

All other terms and conditions mentioned in the original Deputation Notice dated 28-09-2026 shall remain unchanged.

This extension of the deputation notice is being issued with the approval of the competent Authority.

Sd/-
(Sudhir Bara)
Executive Director, JSFDA

PR 393661 Higher Education Directorate(26-27).D

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



INSPECTOR HAZARA RAM 21 BN BSF 21.11.1953 – 11.11.1999



LANCE NAIK JAIBIR SINGH 21 BN BSF 16.05.1965 – 11.11.1999



LANCE NAIK BALWINDER SINGH 21 BN BSF 28.02.1965 – 11.11.1999



LANCE NAIK MILAN PATRA 21 BN BSF 22.11.1965 – 11.11.1999



CONSTABLE MANOHAR LAL 21 BN BSF 01.02.1973 – 11.11.1999



CONSTABLE NIHAL SINGH 21 BN BSF 15.11.1970– 11.11.1999

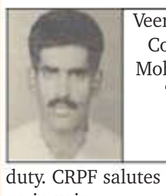
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Inspector Hazara Ram and Lance Naik Jaibir Singh, Lance Naik Balwinder Singh, Lance Naik Milan Patra, Constable Manohar Lal and Constable Nihal Singh on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, They sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Sopore, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



SUB INSPECTOR MAHENDER SINGH, GM 35 BN BSF 15.07.1991 – 11.11.2018

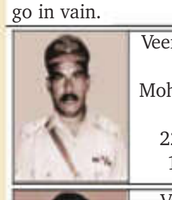
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Sub Inspector Mahender Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, He sustained fatal injuries while fighting Naxals in area of Koyalibeda, Chhattisgarh. He fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with Medal for Gallantry (Posthumously).

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

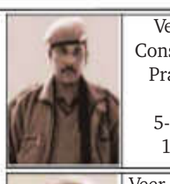


Veer Balidani Constable Mohd. Sadik 74 Bn

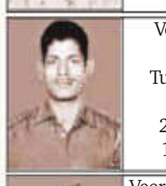
DG and all ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to the supreme sacrifice of Constable Mohd. Sadik (74 Bn). On #ThisDay in 2001, though on leave, he valiantly volunteered to lead an Army team to a terrorist hideout in Poonch, J&K, laying down his life in the line of duty. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Mohd. Ishaq Khan 116 BN 22-1-1951 To 11-11-2002



Veer Balidani Constable /Driver Pradeep Singh 70 BN 5-12-1968 To 11-11-2002



Veer Balidani Constable Tuntun Kumar 116 BN 2-4-1977 To 11-11-2002



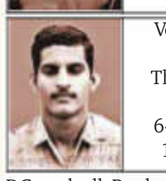
Veer Balidani Head Constable Manohar Mandal 70 BN 5-3-1951 To 11-11-2002



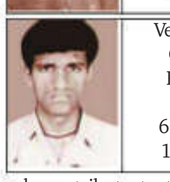
Veer Balidani Head Constable Ingle Sadashiv Laxman 70 BN 1-7-1961 To 11-11-2002



Veer Balidani Constable Balbir Singh 116 BN 2-7-1969 To 11-11-2002

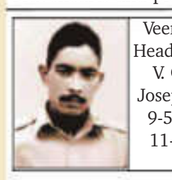


Veer Balidani Constable Thirumallaiah 109 BN 6-10-1967 To 11-11-2002



Veer Balidani Constable Raj Mohd. 109 BN 6-1-1982 To 11-11-2002

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to the eight brave personnel who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries when militants detonated a powerful IED targeting a CRPF convoy in Doda district, J&K on 11 November 2002. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Head Constable V. Climond Joseph 186 Bn 9-5-1971 To 11-11-2013

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable V. Climond Joseph of 186 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while valiantly foiling a Maoist ambush in dist. Dantewada, Chhattisgarh, on 11 November 2013. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

JHARKHAND URJA SANCHARAN NIGAM LIMITED

(CIN No.:U40108JH2013SGC001704)
Regd. Office: 2nd Floor, JUSNL (SLDC) Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi – 02
(E-mail:cetjusnl@gmail.com)

e-TENDER NOTICE

NIT No. – 669/PR/ JUSNL/ 2026-27

E-tender in two parts i.e. Technical (Part-I) and Financial (Part – II) is invited from reputed, capable, experienced and financially sound firm for the following works : -

Name of work	Design, Engineering, Supply of Materials/ Equipments, Erection Testing & Commissioning of 02 nos. 400 kV Line feeder bay and extension of 400 kV Main Bus-I & II at 400/220 kV GSS, PGCIL (Chaibasa) on turnkey basis.
Estimated cost (Rs.)	Rs. 26,78,37,749.00 (including GST)
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 53,56,800.00 On line mode
Completion Period	09 (Nine) Months
e-Tender fee	Rs. 15,000.00 + 18% GST On line mode.
Start Date & Time of Download the Tender Documents	12.11.2026 at 11:00 AM
Start Date and time of upload of BID	12.11.2026 at 11:00 AM
End date and time of upload of BID	03.12.2026 upto 04:00 PM
BID Opening date for technical part	04.12.2026 at 04:00 PM
BID Opening date for price part	Will be communicated
Procurement Officer and address for communication	General Manager, C&M (NWBP), 2nd Floor, JUSNL (SLDC) Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi – 834002

1. e-Tender document and BOQ including terms & conditions, tender specification can be downloaded from website https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in. Any details required in this regard can also be had from the office of the undersigned **(6202162568)** during office hours.
2. The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only.
3. No claim shall be entertained on account of disruption of internet services being used by bidders. Bidders are advised to upload their bids well in advance to avoid last minute technical snag.

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकयतों को 18003456570 (कॉल सेन्टर) पर दर्ज करायें।

Sd/-
General Manager C&M (NWBP)
JUSNL, Ranchi

PR 393647 Jharkhand Urja Sancharan Nigam Ltd (26-27)_D

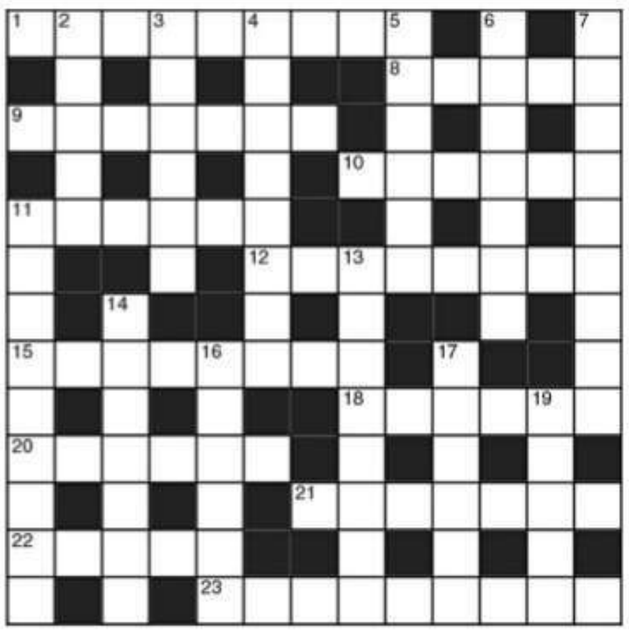
MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 14.12.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 14.12.2026 - BAREILLY DISTRICT - PRIYADARSHANI NAGAR-BAREILLY: 2455002381, 2455002395, 2455002465, 2455002477, 2455002487, 2455002563, 2455002575, 2455002589, 2455002599, 2455002613, 2455002659, 2455002661, 2455002676, 2455002721, 2455002733, 2455002738, 2455002773, 2455002782, 2455002784, 2455002785, 2455002798, 2455002851, 2455002868, 2455002879, 2455002939, 2455002968, 2455002972, 2455002976, 2455003043, 2455003176, 2455003209, 2455003211, 2455003212, 2455003249, 2455003251, 2455003538, 2455003581, 2455003660, 2455003679, 2455003689, 2455003693, 2455003755, 2455003756, 2455004783, 2455004806. **Auction Date: 14.12.2026 - MORADABAD DISTRICT - RAMPUR ROAD-MORADABAD:** 2572000834, 2572001022, 2572001127, 2572001168, 2572002590, 2572002963, 2572003015, 2572003100, 2572003123, 2572003166, 2572003167, 2572003220, 2572003227, 2572003249, 2572003294, 2572003323, 2572003329, 2572003343, 2572003347, 2572003350, 2572003398, 2572003402, 2572003414, 2572003421, 2572003438, 2572003455, 2572003483, 2572003500, 2572003529, 2572003533, 2572003538, 2572003539, 2572003551, 2572003590, 2572003607, 2572003623, 2572003624, 2572003635, 2572003640, 2572003657, 2572003660, 2572003704, 2572003738, 2572003761, 2572003845, 2572003969, 2572004003, 2572004049, 2572004055, 2572004062, 2572004067, 2572004068, 2572004160, 2572004321, 2572004331, 2572004399, 2572004405, 2572004409, 2572004412, 2572004446, 2572004450, 2572004457, 2572004486, 2572004555, 2572004593, 2572004597, 2572004598, 2572004617, 2572004678, 2572004684, 2572004769, 2572004772, 2572004823, 2572004861, 2572004883, 2572004919, 2572004935, 2572004958, 2572005029, 2572005045, 2572005046, 2572005052, 2572005058, 2572005071, 2572005100, 2572005107, 2572005129, 2572005136, 2572005137, 2572005139, 2572005151, 2572005173, 2572005190, 2572005192, 2572005232, 2572005235, 2572005271, 2572005281, 2572005314, 2572005317, 2572005320, 2572005336, 2572005343, 2572005373, 2572007350, 2572007355, 2572007367, 2572007370, 2572007446, 2572007447, 2572007477, 2572007510, 2572007526, 2572007580, 2572007672, 8000892572, 8001402572, 8001412572, 8001512572. **Auction Date: 14.12.2026 - RAMPUR DISTRICT - BILASPUR RAMPUR:** 4415001028, 4415001036, 4415001134, 4415001208, 4415001452, 4415001542, 4415001543. **RAMPUR:** 2732002230, 2732002709, 2732002750, 2732002769, 2732002779, 2732002788, 2732002789, 2732002848, 2732002849, 2732002868, 2732002870, 2732002873, 2732002942, 2732003007, 2732003015, 2732003023, 2732003085,

CROSSWORD 6143



ACROSS

1 Van driver's warning on one side of the building (9)
8 Swiss river heron in distress (5)
9 She'll have flowers left or in hand (7)
10 Aim to be awkward? (6)
11 Seem a very quiet listener (6)
12 Last despite great efforts (5,3)
15 I can head this way for the ranch (8)
18 Almost none start before time (6)
20 Close so ran back to a disturbance (6)
21 Ardent Olympian getting a look in (7)
22 Less in sum perhaps (5)
23 I can act it out providing one plans the moves (9)

DOWN

2 Part of a ship or dock (5)
3 With the organ study over got paid employment (6)
4 When the others fall don't let yourself do so (8)
5 A singer in a trio? (6)
6 Flowers say gone astray (7)
7 Good breeding quality (9)
11 Many cheer the reformation of Satan (9)
13 Wing patterns have changed (8)
14 Making a record — from scratch? (7)
16 Possibly it goes to a selfish type (6)
17 Pungent plant the Italian found in rock climbing (6)
19 The French atmosphere comes from her (5))

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6142 ACROSS: 1 Irksome, 4 Idiot, 7 Lord, 8 Province, 10 Disrespect, 12 Synods, 13 Stacks, 15 Out of order, 18 Breather, 19 Feat, 20 Satyr, 21 Tractor DOWN: 1 Idled, 2 Kerosene, 3 Enrapt, 4 Invocation, 5 Ions, 6 Thermos, 9 Head-hunter, 11 Acid test, 12 Scribes, 14 Moment, 16 Rotor, 17 Gert.

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

That is the greatest fallacy, the wisdom of old men. They do not grow __. They grow ____. Ernest Hemingway (4,.,7)

LEASE



AOPCLU



SCRIP



CERUFW



SOLUTIONS: Easel, Crisp, Cupola, Curfew
ANSWER: That is the greatest fallacy, the wis dom of old men. They do not grow **wise**. They grow **careful**. - Ernest Hemingway

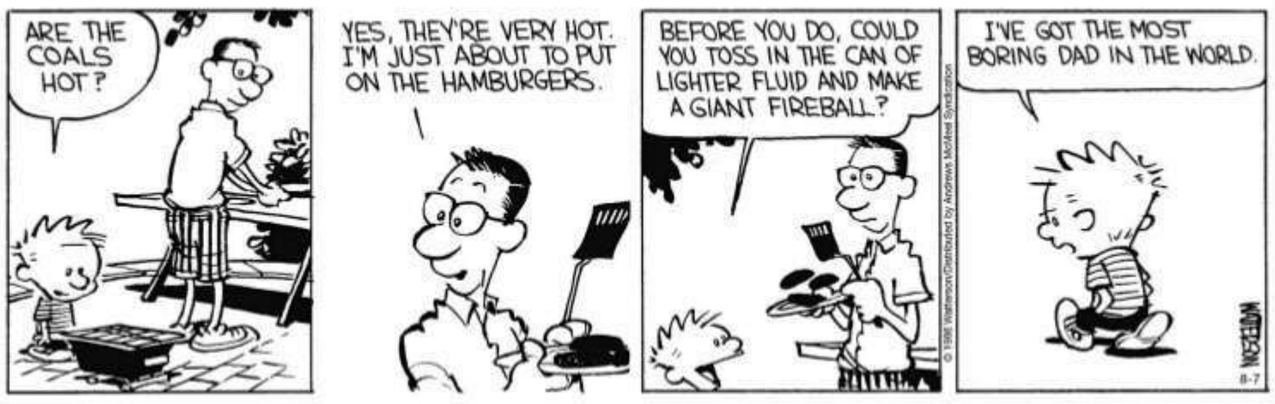
OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6499

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

		8				1		
4		6		3		7		8
	1		2		5		4	
	7	9				4	2	
2								3
	5	3				8	6	
	6		7		3		1	
9		1		4		2		5
		2				3		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6498

5	8	9	4	7	2	3	1	6
3	4	6	1	9	5	8	2	7
1	7	2	6	3	8	5	4	9
8	2	3	7	6	9	4	5	1
6	5	1	3	2	4	9	7	8
7	9	4	5	8	1	2	6	3
4	6	8	2	1	3	7	9	5
9	1	5	8	4	7	6	3	2
2	3	7	9	5	6	1	8	4

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a lovely day to chat with others and enjoy their company. It's also a great day to travel or make travel plans. You want to do something to expand your world. Tonight: Explore and learn.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Remember to get more sleep. Meanwhile, people from your past are back in your world. Discussions about how to share something like an inheritance or jointly held property will go well. It's a good day to ask for a loan. Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Cooperate with others today, even if this means being patient with silly, goofy mistakes at work. Enjoy socialising with friends and children. Tonight: Be friendly and cooperative.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Some of you have experienced old flames being back in your world. Others have been in contact with kids they haven't seen in a while. Relations with co-workers are especially enjoyable today. It's also an excellent day to entertain at home. Tonight: Get better organised.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Romance, the arts, fun social outings and vacations are on the menu today. Make an effort to do something that pleases you. Enjoy socialising. Reach out to others. Everyone is more mellow and easy-going today, including you. Tonight: Play.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): The pace of your days has accelerated recently with a busy schedule of appointments, errands, increased reading and writing and talking to everyone. Today is the perfect day to take it easy and relax at home. Tonight: Relax at home.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Your communication skills are excellent today. Many of you will make money from your ability to communicate through sales, marketing, teaching, acting, writing and editing. Tonight: Talk and learn.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Trust your moneymaking ideas today. If shopping, you will be pleased if you have a chance to buy something pretty for yourself or a loved one. A small gift is a gesture that shows you're thinking about them with affection. Tonight: Check your money.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today the Moon is in your sign dancing nicely with Venus, which increases your appreciation of beauty in the world around you. It's a great day for romance or any kind of socialising with others. Accept invitations to party. Tonight: You win.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Your life has been more popular lately, as some of you have been interacting with younger people, especially people from your past. Relations with authority figures are excellent, even romantic. Today, is the perfect day to rest. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Friendships will be warm and reassuring today. A platonic relationship might become romantic. Do something to enjoy the arts or make travel plans. Get out and socialise. Tonight: Be friendly.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): People notice you today, this is a good thing, as you appear attractive, charming and approachable. Someone might be attracted to you romantically. This is an excellent day for any special gathering, so look your best. Tonight: You're admired.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Bhola Prasad @ Bhola S/o** Kailash Prasad **R/o** H. No. 430, Gali No. 11, Nehru Nagar, Anand Parbat, Delhi Also at Nausha, PS Harnaut, Distt. Nalanda, Bihar has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 11/2012, U/S 302/201/34 IPC, PS Anand Parbat, Central Distt, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bhola Prasad @ Bhola** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Bhola Prasad @ Bhola** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Bhola Prasad @ Bhola** the said accused of **FIR No. 11/2012, U/S 302/201/34 IPC, PS Anand Parbat, Central Distt, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.12.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sandeep Gupta
Joint Registrar (Judicial)
In the High Court of Delhi

DP/16173/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sameer Khan S/o** Kr. Faiyaz Khan **R/o** Flat No. 564, Fifth Floor, Gali No. 14, G Khadda Colony, Jaitpur New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 246/2026, U/S 318(4)/309(4)/3(5) BNS, PS Sarita Vihar, South East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sameer Khan** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sameer Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Sameer Khan** the said accused of **FIR No. 246/2026, U/S 318(4)/309(4)/3(5) BNS, PS Sarita Vihar, South East, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shikha Chahal
Ld. Judicial Magistrate of First Class-05,
South East, Main Court Building,
Court No. 510, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/16182/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(भारत सरकार का उपक्रम) (A Navratna Undertaking of Govt. of India)
NSIC New MDBP Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Ind. Estate (Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110020

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

CONCOR invites E-Tender in Single Packet System of tendering for the following work:-

Tender No.	CON/EP/A-I/CPC, MBD & Barhi/AMC/2026-28/E-103122
Name of Work	Annual Civil Maintenance Contract at ICD Kanpur, ICD Moradabad and MMLP Barhi (2026-28)
Estimated Cost	₹ 106.50 Lakhs
Completion Period	24 months from the 15th day after date of issue of LOA
Earnest Money Deposit	₹ 2,13,000/- (through e-payment)
Cost of Tender Document	NIL
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	₹ 3,540 (inclusive all taxes & duties through e-payment)
Date of sale of Tender (online)	11.11.2026 (15:00 hrs) to 01.12.2026 (upto 17:00 hrs)
Date & Time of submission of Tender (online)	02.12.2026 (upto 17:00 hrs.)
Date & Time of Opening of Tender (online)	03.12.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

For financial eligibility criteria, experience with respect to similar nature of work, etc, please refer to detailed tender notice available on website **www.concorindia.co.in**, but the complete tender document can be downloaded from website **www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL** only. Further, Corrigendum / Addendum to this Tender, if any, will be published on website **www.concorindia.co.in**, **www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL** and **Central Procurement Portal (CPP)** only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same.
General Manager (Engg), Phone No.: 011-41222500

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1.	Name of Work with its location	Replacement of G-Jumper & PG Clamps in GZB-SRE & SPR sections.
2.	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 49,96,730.00/-
3.	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 99,900/-
4.	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	20.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 04.12.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5.	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	04.12.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6.	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 24B-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated 10.11.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3931/26

STORES E-PROCUREMENT

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 08/2026; Dated: 06-11-2026.
E-tenders are invited for the following work:-

Description of works	Tender Quantity	Tender Due Date
SN. 1, Tender No. 02265617		
Vehicle Van	4 Nos	30-11-2026
Annexure-I Integrated PSI Mobile Testing Van with Measuring Instruments & other Accessories.	4 Nos	

NOTE:- For full details of Tender Notice and Tender Documents, **Tenderer may log on to the website (www.ireps.gov.in)** prospective bidder who intend to participate in above tenders are required to log in themselves with the above website and submit their offer electronically, if they are already registered with **IREPS**. In case they are not registered with **IREPS**, they are advised to obtain class-III Digital Signature Certificate from the certifying agencies under Govt. of India IT Act 2000 and participate in the above tender.

Principal Chief Materials Manager/Con/Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
(Construction Organisation)
"Serving Customers with a smile"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

	Name of Work with its location	Replacement of Tower No. 204 of Double Circuit Transmission Line with Monopole in Diwana-Taraori section of DLI-PNP-UMB section.
	Approx. Cost of work	Earnest Money Deposit
	Rs. 60,08,734.31/-	Rs. 1,20,200/-
	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	
	18.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 02.12.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)	
	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	02.12.2026 (15:00 hrs.)
	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 37-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 10.11.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3932/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of Work with its location	Part-F: Provision of feeder wire for enhancement of existing OHE capacity to cater increasing load requirements of GHH/TSS of DLI Division.
2	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 14,75,17,157.71/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 29,50,400/-
4	Pre-Bid Conference Date & Time	20.11.2026 (11.00 hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	23.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 07.12.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
6	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	07.12.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
7	Fund Allocation	Capital (PH-36)
8	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-TENDER No.: 35A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 10.11.2026 3941/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sh. Bhagwati Prasad, S/o. Sh. Jagdish Prasad, R/o. WZ-76B, Gali No.9, Virender Nagar, New Delhi-110058, Also at: WZ-154-D/1A, First Floor Back Side Gali No.5, Virender Nagar, New Delhi-110058** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **Ct. Cases/CC NI Act 17515/2016 U/S 138 NI Act** registered at **P.S. Rajouri Garden, West District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Sh. Bhagwati Prasad** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Sh. Bhagwati Prasad** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sh. Bhagwati Prasad**, accused of **Ct. Cases/CC NI Act 17515/2016 U/S 138 NI Act, P.S Rajouri Garden, West District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.12.2026.**

By Order, Sh. Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act)-04
West District, Room No.04 (Annex-I
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/16069/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sandeep S/o Ashok Kr. R/o E-496, Mangolpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 1165/2019 U/S 394/411/34 IPC, PS Mangolpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Sandeep** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sandeep** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sandeep** of **FIR No. 1165/2019 U/S 394/411/34 IPC, PS Mangolpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **15.02.2027.**

By Order,
Ms. Reetika Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class 05
North-West, Room No. 105
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/16221/OD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Heera Munni Devi, C/o** Ram Iqbal Singh **R/o:** D-300A, Gali No-3, Tripathi Enclave, Prem Nagar-2, Kirari, Delhi **Also at:** Village Madari Chhal, Post Atarsan, PS-Dhurawana, Distt.-Siwan, Bihar, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 1000/18, U/S 323/341/509/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Rohini Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Heera Munni Devi** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Heera Munni Devi** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Heera Munni Devi** the said accused of **FIR No. 1000/18, U/S 323/341/509/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Rohini Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06, (North-West),
Court No.-109, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/16162/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **SUKHJIT SINGH S/o Mukhtiar Singh R/o 91/76, Multani Mohalla, Geeta Colony, Gandhi Nagar, East Delhi-110031** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No./CC No. **510613/2016, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Karol Bagh, Central Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **SUKHJIT SINGH** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **SUKHJIT SINGH** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **SUKHJIT SINGH** of FIR No./CC No. **510613/2016, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Karol Bagh, Central Distt., New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **23.12.2026 at 10:00 AM.**

By Order
Sh. Arvind Tomar
Ld JMFC (NI Act)-07 (Central)
Room No. 507, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/14777/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Surjit Singh, S/o:** Roshan Lal, **R/o:** Jhuggi No. 972, Vishwanath Puri, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 100/2012, U/s 363/366 IPC, P.S.: Jahangirpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Surjit Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Surjit Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Surjit Singh** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 100/2012, U/s 363/366 IPC, P.S.: Jahangirpuri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.12.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 (North)
Room No. 06, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/15793/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF FULLY AUTOMATED IMMUNO HEMATOLOGY ANALYZER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	1,26,00,000/-	www.hmsd.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF FULLY AUTOMATED CHEMILUMINISCENCE (CLIA) ANALYZER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	60,00,000/-	www.hmsd.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF REFRIGERATED CENTRIFUGE ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	2,25,00,000/-	www.hmsd.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50912/HRY

Pak debutants leave Sri Lanka trailing by 320 runs in 1st Test



Saqib Khan took two wickets. AP

Associated Press
Rawalpindi, November 10

PAKISTAN'S DEBUTANTS continued to inspire to leave Sri Lanka trailing by 320 runs with seven first-innings wickets in hand after two days of the first cricket Test on Tuesday.

Fast bowler Saqib Khan, one of the four newcomers, brought the greenish pitch to life with 2-54 as Sri Lanka reached 114-3 before bad light brought an early closure for the second successive day. Nearly 26 overs were not bowled.

Only 67.2 overs were possible on Day 1 when Pakistan reached 281-5 with play continuing in floodlights for almost 45 minutes on both days at Rawalpindi Cricket Stadium.

Pakistan declared at 434-9 midway into the second session on Tuesday after five half-centuries - three to debutants - and a 48.

"There are about 140 chances that have missed the edge and beaten the bat from both sides, so probably says enough that there's a chance of a result," Sri Lanka fielding and spin coach Jordan Gregory said.

"So far Kamindu and DDS have put on a good partnership and we would like to see that partnership progress." Pakistan's most experienced seamer Mohammad Abbas and Saqib hit the right lengths with the new ball and both struck in their second overs to have Sri Lanka reeling at 12-2.

Abbas extracted movement from his off stump line and found the outside edge of Pasindu Sooriyabandara, who was promoted to open the innings in his third test and out for a duck.

Saqib struck off his ninth delivery in test cricket when he squared up the experienced Dinesh Chandimal from a perfect length ball that angled across the right hander and edged the shoulder of the bat to the slips cordon.

Sri Lanka slumped further in the shortened final session when Lahiru Udara, who struck seven fours in his aggressive 42, played a loose drive to Saqib and edged to wicketkeeper Ghazi Ghori only two balls after a reprieve from Mohammad Taha, who grassed a one-handed catch at gully.

Mendis and de Silva survived under floodlights and added 49 runs for their unfinished fourth-wicket stand.

BRIEF SCORES: Pakistan 434/9 declared (Saud Shakeel 93; Tayyab Arif 57; Asitha Fernando 3/107) lead Sri Lanka 114/3 (Lahiru Udara 42, Kamindu Mendis 40 not out; Saqib Khan 2/52) by 320 runs.

> I have a legacy to live up to as he (Virender Sehwag) only likes big hundreds
>
> **AARYAVIR SEHWAG,** VIRENDER SEHWAG'S SON

Sehwag Jr. hits big daddy ton

Aaryavir's 160 off 168 balls set the tone as India colts defeated UAE by 70 runs to book U-19 Asia Cup semifinal berth



Aaryavir Sehwag currently leads the run-scoring charts in U-19 Asia Cup with 252. BCCI/X

Express News Service
Mumbai, November 10

AARYAVIR SEHWAG had shown glimpses of his potential in India's first two matches of the Under-19 Asia Cup, scoring 70 not out against Nepal and 22 against Pakistan. On Tuesday, the Indian opener went a step further, smashing 160 off 168 balls to power India Under-19 to a 70-run win over UAE Under-19 in Al Amerat and secure a place in the semifinal.

The right-hander struck 17 fours and seven sixes in an innings that gathered pace after his century. Sehwag took time to settle against the new ball, with UAE pacer Naseem Khan probing away outside the off stump.

"I wanted to make a big score. I had promised someone to make a big score today and thankfully I made it. And that person is my dad (Virender Sehwag). I told my dad I will get a big hundred. I have a legacy to live up to as he only likes big hundreds," Aaryavir said in the post-match presentation.

He got off the mark in the fourth over, whipping Hadayatullah Khan through mid-wicket for four. That helped him settle, and a couple of overs later, he struck consecutive boundaries off pacer Noorullah Ayobi, charging down the pitch to hit him over mid-wicket and cover.

UAE had opportunities to end his innings early but failed to take them. In the 16th over, while on 41, wicketkeeper Muhammad Saad put down two chances off consecutive deliveries from Ayobi.

Those reprieves proved costly. Sehwag joined hands with VK Vineeth and the pair laid the foundation for a big total. They added 193 runs for the second wicket, with Sehwag bringing up his half-century off 69 balls with a six off Ayobi in the 18th over.

> *The right-hander struck 17 fours and seven sixes in an innings that gathered pace after his century.*

The slow surface made stroke-making difficult, forcing Sehwag and Vineeth to rely on singles and twos to keep the scoreboard moving through the middle overs. Sehwag brought up his century off 131 balls in the 34th over before shifting gears.

"The wicket was turning a little. I started off and decided to play long and bat for 40 odd overs. There were challenges on the wicket. I didn't get bothered about the dot balls, as I knew I would catch up," Aaryavir added.

He began using his feet more freely, launching the spinners over the leg-side and driving over the infield. Left-arm wrist spinner Uddish Suri bore the brunt of his assault in the 37th over, conceding 21 runs as Sehwag struck two fours and two sixes. The opener moved from 100 to 150 in just 29 deliveries.

Saad gave Sehwag another reprieve, on 136, in the 40th over. But Naseem eventually dismissed him in the 45th, with the opener mistiming a pull against a slower, short-of-length delivery and finding Uddish Suri at mid-wicket.

Chasing 310, UAE were steady right through the innings, but never put the foot on the accelerator to trouble the Indians. Ahmed Khudadad top-scored with a run-a-ball 74 and put on 90 runs for the seventh wicket with Ayobi, but the lack of support from the other batsmen meant they fell short in the end. India will face Afghanistan in the semifinal on Thursday.

BRIEF SCORES: India Under-19 309/7 in 50 overs (Aaryavir Sehwag 160, VK Vineeth 67; Naseem Khan 4/48) beat UAE Under-19 239 all out in 50 overs (Ahmed Khudadad 74, Noorullah Ayobi 39; Ishan Sood 4/37) by 70 runs.

Father once sold *chole-kulche*, son now stars for India U-19



Arjun Rajput scored 107 in 85 balls against Pakistan on Sunday. BCCI/X

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, November 10

HOTI RAM Rajput is a massive cricket aficionado. When he was not busy selling chole-kulche on his *rerhi* (roadside cart) outside the DAV College in Jalandhar, the Virender Sehwag fan would spend his leisure playing cricket. Though, he could never harbour the dream of following one of his favourites into the blue. Today, his son Arjun Rajput plays for the same Indian team as Sehwag's son, Aaryavir.

"My financial circumstances were such that I have had to work and earn since a very young age. I am a cricket fan, and loved the Sachin-Sehwag *jodi*, but dreaming of becoming a cricketer was beyond our reach. My concern was to earn so that I could get food on the plate," he tells *The Indian Express* from Jalandhar.

On Sunday, India lost to Pakistan by three wickets in the Under-19 Asia Cup in Oman. Arjun struck 107 from 85 balls on a surface where none of his teammates could find their feet. It was 51.4% of India's 208.

For his coach Vikram Sidhu, it was not an unprecedented innings. "He has played such one-man-army knocks many a time in his career," he tells *The Indian Express*. It began in 2015, when Hoti Ram brought eight-year-old Arjun to Sidhu's previous academy, the Harbhajan Singh Institute of Cricket. Arjun had been inspired by his elder brother Karan, who was by then representing Jalandhar in inter-district age-level tournaments.

"My father's passion for cricket rubbed off on me, so I started playing. Eventually, Arjun also wanted to play after watching me. Things were not great at my home financially, but my father encouraged Arjun to pursue his dream, saying he would manage everything," Karan says.

It was not always manageable. Sidhu says teaching children the basics means repeating yourself many times. With Arjun, "it was always one and done". "We knew he was special. We had high hopes. He would never miss a session, until he stopped coming altogether all of a sudden."

"Kumar sir, another coach in the academy, assumed that his father might not have been able to gather funds for the academy fees. At that point, I decided that I will not be taking a single penny from Arjun. Not only cricket, but his family also struggled with school fees. My academy had a tie-up with a school called the Ivy World School. Their fees is about Rs 6-7 lakh per annum, but I cut a deal with the principal. I told him that I will give him a player who is bound to represent India, but in return, he would have to waive off Arjun's entire fees."

Hoti Ram no longer operates a cart. It has been replaced by a kulche bakery with many bakers on his payroll. "I have never stopped my kids from playing sports; his elder brother also played cricket, while his elder sister, Kiran, plays tennis. *Maine socha main to nahin khel paya, mere bachche khel le* (I thought I couldn't, but let my kids play). There have been many difficulties, but now that I see him playing for India, the hard work makes sense."

Karan, now 27, quit cricket four years ago to aid his ailing father in his work. Family responsibilities never stood in his brother's way. "He was playing for Punjab U-16 at the time. His coaches would tell me that my brother has huge potential. I got convinced when I saw him scoring five consecutive centuries. That was the moment I told myself, 'This boy is built to play for the country.'"

Arjun captained Punjab U-16, Sidhu says, and under him the state won its first-ever U-16 title. There was also a missed trip to Dubai. "Arjun was very excited to go, and we had everything booked for him. But unfortunately, a spelling mistake in the visa made him miss that trip. He was crestfallen, but I told him more opportunities will come his way. A few months later, we went to South Africa. No one could score runs on those wickets, but Arjun won us games single-handedly and ended up getting the Player of the Tournament award."

Hoti Ram could not afford to harbour dreams when he was young. Now, he does. "My dream will truly be fulfilled when my son plays for senior Indian team. We want him to bring home the World Cup."

BRIEFLY



Ishan Kishan (L) and Axar Patel look out of a bus window. CREIMAS

NZ v India ODI at Hamilton abandoned due to rain

THE THIRD One-Day International between India and New Zealand in Hamilton was abandoned due to rain on Tuesday, with the tourists retaining their 2-0 lead in the five-match series. The outcome ended New Zealand's streak of 11 consecutive home ODI series victories since 2019. Rain delayed the start of the match, which was initially reduced to a 40-over contest at toss. India captain Shubman Gill elected to bowl but play could not start and the match was eventually called off following multiple ground inspections by the umpires. Mount Maunganui hosts the last two ODIs on Friday and Sunday. REUTERS

Pant likely to leave for NZ on November 12

INDIA'S TEST team is set to get a boost as wicketkeeper batter Rishabh Pant in all likelihood will get fitness clearance from the BCCI Centre of Excellence and leave for New Zealand on Thursday. "Pant is completely fit. He is undergoing the match simulation drills at the CoE today and tomorrow. Upon successful completion of both rounds, Pant will leave for Wellington," a BCCI source privy to the development told PTI on conditions of anonymity. PTI

Savita makes way for Bansari in ACT Hockey

SAVITA PUNIA is rested from the ACT, replaced by Bansari Solanki in the women's hockey squad. **SQUAD: Goalkeepers:** Bansari Solanki, Bichu Devi Kharibam; **Defenders:** Nikki Pradhan, Jyoti, Jyoti Singh, Sushila Chanu, Pooja Sahoo Lalthantluangi; **Midfielders:** Rutuja Dadaso, Sunelita Toppo, Salima Tete (c), Neha, Sakshi Rana, Baljeeet Kaur, Ishika; **Forwards:** Navneet Kaur, Deepika, Beauty Dungdung, Lalremsiami, Mumtaz Khan. PTI

AFC U17 Asian Cup qualifying campaign begins

INDIA WILL begin their AFC U17 Asian Cup Qualifiers' Group E campaign against Singapore on Wednesday, aiming to secure back-to-back appearances in the continental football tournament. Hosts Malaysia, Palestine and Guam are the other teams in the fray. India will next face Guam, followed by Palestine and then hosts Malaysia in their remaining Group E fixtures. Only the group winner will progress to the AFC U17 Asian Cup. PTI

Treesa-Gayatri pair advances in Japan Open

THE INDIAN women's doubles pair of Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly progressed to the pre-quarterfinals with a straight-game win over home favourites Hinata Suzuki and Nao Yamakita in the opening round of the Kumamoto Masters Japan Super 500 badminton tournament on Tuesday. The Indian combination, which won a bronze at this year's BWF World Championships in New Delhi, prevailed 21-17, 21-14 in 42 minutes in a round-of-32 clash. PTI

Mbappe in good spirits after difficult spell

KYLIAN MBAPPE has put a difficult period behind him and is focused on helping his team ahead of the Nations League, defender Ibrahima Konate said. Mbappe returned to the France squad after missing their last 3 matches through injury, having failed to win the Ballon d'Or award and attracting criticism in China over his comments relating to Mao Zedong. "He's been decisive. He's absolutely vital for us in Madrid." Konate told reporters. REUTERS

PTPA presses player fatigue concerns

THE PROFESSIONAL Tennis Players Association (PTPA) reiterated its criticism of the tennis schedule on Monday, saying world number one Elena Rybakina withdrew from the season-ending WTA Finals as "her body had nothing left to give". "She finishes 2026 with two Grand Slam titles and four titles overall. And still, by the season's final event in November, her body had nothing left to give," the PTPA said in a post on social media. REUTERS

{ SANDPAPERGATE }

Before Cape Town, ball tampering took place at Port Elizabeth: Khawaja

The ball was doing so much that the former Australian opener thought 'even I could reverse-swing this ball'

Express News Service
Mumbai, November 10

USMAN KHAWAJA has lifted the lid on an episode that preceded Australia's infamous 2018 ball-tampering scandal in Cape Town, claiming that sandpaper had also been used on the ball during the second Test against South Africa in Port Elizabeth.

In his autobiography, *Sabr*, Khawaja recalls Cameron Bancroft working on the ball during the interval before Australia took four wickets for 28 runs in the next session. The ball was moving so sharply that, Khawaja writes, he thought, "even I could reverse swing this ball". His verdict on the extent of the movement that afternoon was blunt: "It was ridiculous."

Khawaja's revelations drew sharp reactions from former and current players, with some backing his account, others standing by their earlier statements and several questioning whether the full truth about the scandal will ever emerge.



My opinion hasn't changed: Starc

FAST BOWLER Mitchell Starc stood by the statement issued by the bowling group in 2021, saying his recollection had not changed. Speaking at Fox Cricket's summer launch, Starc said: "My opinion hasn't changed. My recollection hasn't changed from what we said in 2021." He reiterated that the bowlers were unaware of a foreign substance being taken onto the field. "We weren't aware it was taken on the field to be tampered with. We saw it on the big screen (for the first time) in Cape Town," he said.



The truth didn't come out: Clark

FORMER AUSTRALIA captain Michael Clarke called for the truth about Sandpapergate to emerge, saying it had not been properly resolved. Speaking to *2DayFM*, Clarke said: "They can't trust what's real. They don't know the truth until this gets reopened and the truth comes out." He pointed to earlier opportunities to clarify events: "We had the chance in 2018. The truth didn't come out. We had the chance in 2021 when (Bancroft) made those comments." He also questioned why current captain Pat Cummins had not spoken publicly about the allegations.



There is so much more to unpack: Gillespie

FORMER AUSTRALIA fast bowler Jason Gillespie said he found it difficult to believe that only three players knew about the 2018 ball-tampering plan, but stopped short of endorsing Khawaja's claim that the entire team was aware of it. Referring to Khawaja's account of addressing the dressing room, Gillespie said in a video posted by ABC Sports: "He said everyone was in that room. I found that really fascinating." Gillespie added: "There is so much more to unpack here. This ain't going away anytime soon," he added.



'Can't believe bowlers were unaware'

FORMER ENGLAND captain Michael Vaughan questioned how Australia's bowlers could have been unaware of what was being done to the ball. In his Telegraph column, he wrote: "We are all aware of who the ball-shiner is in a cricket side, even on a Sunday afternoon playing friendlies for your club team." He added: "You can't tell me the Australian team did not communicate that or the bowlers were totally unaware of what was being done to the ball." Vaughan argued that players were protecting their reputations.



'Nightmare of Cummins & Co.'

FORMER AUSTRALIA captain Mark Taylor said he was unsure whether the latest revelations would establish who knew about the ball-tampering plan. Speaking on WWOS, he said: "I don't know if you're ever going to find out exactly who knew what, where, and when." Taylor also recalled the umpires' examination of the ball in Cape Town: "Two umpires ... inspected the ball and didn't replace the ball, saying there's nothing to see here." He warned that the controversy would be "a nightmare for Pat Cummins and the team leading into the summer of cricket".



'Some wounds never healed properly'

FORMER AUSTRALIA opener David Warner backed Usman Khawaja's account of the 2018 ball-tampering scandal, calling his revelations accurate. "It's 100 per cent accurate what you've said. Now everyone knows the truth. It's out there." In a separate Instagram caption, he wrote: "I stand with my brother Usman Khawaja," adding that "some wounds never properly healed" and that speaking out took courage, "especially when people would rather you stay silent". Warner was one of the three players sanctioned after the Cape Town Test in 2018.

MOVING AGAINST THE CURRENT

Dhinidhi, the reluctant swimmer who is not shy of winning medals

She once dreaded water, but is now a double medallist at Youth Olympics

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, November 10



Dhinidhi Desinghu won bronze medals in 100m and 200m freestyle. OIS/JONATHAN NACKSTRAND

DHINIDHI DESINGHU wasn't born to swim, but her mind has decided she is going to win big at it. So, a pair of Youth Olympics bronzes have followed at Dakar, Senegal—a first for India at the global stage. Not too shabby for someone who doesn't dig sport much, and admits she is so uncoordinated on land that people might question if she's an 'athlete' at all. So she wouldn't go near a field, and instead, study, or play chess. In the water, she now feels just fine. Maybe, Dhinidhi was born to swim.

It's fairly well known that the Bangalorean grew up scared of water. Both her parents had to get into the pool to persuade her to even go under water - and 30-40 noisy splashers in the pool agitated her sense of independence. But she was competitive.

"Even in first grade, small exams, I would finish quickly and submit the paper. Even drawing, handwriting exams - in my mind if I finished fast, I was a winner. Till someone told me if you don't answer all questions, you fail. Even in the smallest games, if someone finished ahead of me, inside my stomach I would be boiling. I hate losing," she explained in a SAI-facilitated interaction after bronzes in 100 and 200m Freestyle.

Naturally, her first reaction after her hand touched the wall in the 200m race, was disappointment. "They didn't zoom into my face or they'd know. Yes it was PB, everything great, but I wanted either gold or to go under 1:55. It took me days to realise it was a bronze and (I should be happy)," she says.

Choosing swimming where India's history is nothing to speak of, however has helped her dial down on the competitive edginess, given results tend to sober you down.

There is clarity though in how she views the situation and the contradiction inherent in where India stands in the sport, and where she needs to reach. "Having raced with big names, I admire how they know how to race - not overspeed or over-kick in the first 50, etc. But I don't think genetically Indians can't win," she says defiantly. "It's just mentally you have to get there. We have the same two arms, two legs. We are not from another planet. I've never understood why we haven't come close to Europe, China, Japan--or US and Australia to the next level. We should be able to...why not?"

She knows the 'Why not?' acutely. She explains with candour: "We are actually so behind. By not 5-10 years, but 30-40 years. It sounds like an exaggeration when I say it, but it's not." She knows her swim-numbers. "What were World records 30-years back is what we are doing now," she says.

Swimming inflation

"Swimming inflation is a thing"- she crunches the numbers further. "Indians need to improve by 4-5% just to catch up. In women's we are far away. I hope I'm the person who can do that and change that mentality," she states. "For we've never thought we can come back with medals from the Olympics, Asian Games, and the Commonwealth," she says and adds, "But it's not 1 day magic."

The 'A' entry standard for the 200 free for the Los Angeles Olympics is 1:56.43. Dhinidhi reckons an 'A' cut by a female swimmer could catapult swimming into prominence like cricket, badminton, athletics, hockey. "It could be bigger than a Youth Olympics medal." She has the 1:56 scribbled on a white board, behind her "pink, too girly room" door.

South African legend Chad le Clos was in the Senegal gallery, and handed her a pin and told her he would follow her 100m race. "I doubt he actually watched. But he spoke as if he knew me. Or maybe it's just how he talks. I kept that pin in my pocket for both races. It's not always that a legend hands over a pin to you," she recalls.

Dhinidhi briefly missed the life of a teenager, before she realised with clarity that she was different. "Last year changed all that. There's so many girls having a normal childhood - eating whatever they want, doing whatever. School, parties, movies who have 100s of 1000s of friends. But they are not special in any way. I'm one in a billion," she says unabashedly.



"Even in first grade exams, I would finish quickly and submit the paper. Drawing, handwriting exams — in my mind if I finished fast, I was a winner. In the smallest games, if someone finished ahead of me, in my stomach I would be boiling. I hate losing."
DHINIDHI DESINGHU
ON HER COMPETITIVE SPIRIT

She once dreamt of Ivy League, and scores well even without studying 365. "I got 92.7% but wasn't happy," she says. Wanted 96. "I never wanted to stay in India, always wanted to study abroad, because my parents never did. Harvard, Yale, Princeton. The best schools. As years went by I realised it's not easy to get in. And there's better programs for swimming."

Dhinidhi's starts have always been slow, but she finishes well. She was 5th till 75m, then went all-out to bronze. The turns have improved, the 'catch' is better. "Even small improvements of 0.3 or 0.4 medals ate the difference between a medal and not. I'll do everything needed."

INTERVIEW: R VAISHALI

I see Total Chess as training for World Championship: Vaishali

Amit Kamath
Budapest, November 10



R Vaishali will face Ju Wenjun for World C'ship title. FIDE/MICHAL WALUSZA

VAISHALI RAMESHBABU gave a measure of her talent late on Tuesday night by starting her Total Chess pilot event campaign by defeating Hans Niemann in a blitz game. Niemann was part of the seeding process for the tournament that will start in earnest from Wednesday.

In the 24-player field that is assembled in Budapest, Vaishali is among the only two women, along with Bibisara Assaubayeva, in the fray.

Before the start of the blitz section, Vaishali spoke to The Indian Express about her preparations for the upcoming Women's World Chess Championship title fight with reigning champion Ju Wenjun, how her training has been going, how she views the Total Chess pilot tournament and more. *Excerpts:*

It's the first time that you are preparing for a World Championship after doing this twice for the Candidates. How different is the preparation?

We're just thinking about one player every day. The Candidates prep was a lot different; there you have to play seven players in a double round-robin. Here it's just one player in the head-to-head. It's also my first World Championship. I'm also learning a lot of things in the process.

After the Candidates, you had revealed that you are also working with a psychologist. Is that still continuing?

Yeah, of course. She has been helping me a lot in the last couple of years, but I will keep the name private for now.

When you are playing tournaments these days like the Total Chess pilot tournament, as opposed to when you were playing in tournaments before the Candidates, do you always have that World Championship match at the back of your head?

For me, I see this event (Total Chess) also as a training for my World Championship match. I'm going to play a lot of strong players in this event. It's going to be a challenge everyday. In any format it is going to be a challenge, so I just take this as preparation for the match.

At the Total Chess pilot event, there are 22 male players and two female players including you. How much will playing against male players help in terms of preparing you to face one of the strongest female chess players in history (Ju Wenjun)?

Over the last few years, I was also playing in a lot of Grand Prix events, a lot of women's events. So I could not play a lot of Open tournaments like I used to play when I was chasing grandmaster norms, for example. Now I have gotten used to playing all the top women players... I've played many games against most of them. Playing in Open tournaments does definitely push you to the limit. Even if you get a winning position in an Open tournament against a male player, you're tested until the last move. You just know you are not going to get any points easily. They are going to keep the pressure on the board. It's now the same in the women's tournaments as well. But obviously the male players at this event are very strong. It will help me improve faster.

You said your preparation is slightly different for the World C'ship as compared to what you were doing for the Candidates. Can you elaborate?

I think at the end of the day, I have to be in good shape during the tournament. Even if you do some 12-13 hours of training, if your brain is not working well, then there is no point in putting in a lot of hours.

(The writer is in Budapest at the invitation of Total Chess)


नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री

सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार

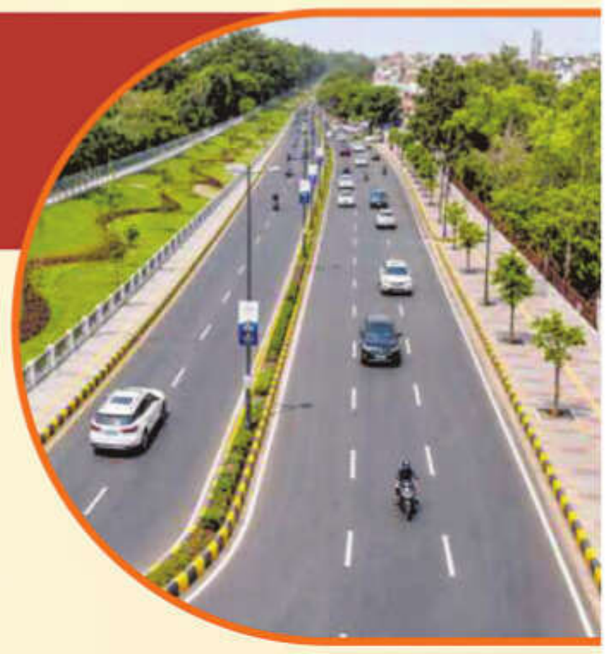
मुनक नहर पर 11 किलोमीटर लंबे
छठ घाट का निर्माण और सड़क के चौड़ीकरण


रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

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रितेश पांडेय

12 नवंबर | दोपहर 1:00 बजे मुनक नहर, शालीमार बाग

आस्था का सम्मान, सुविधाओं का विस्तार

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